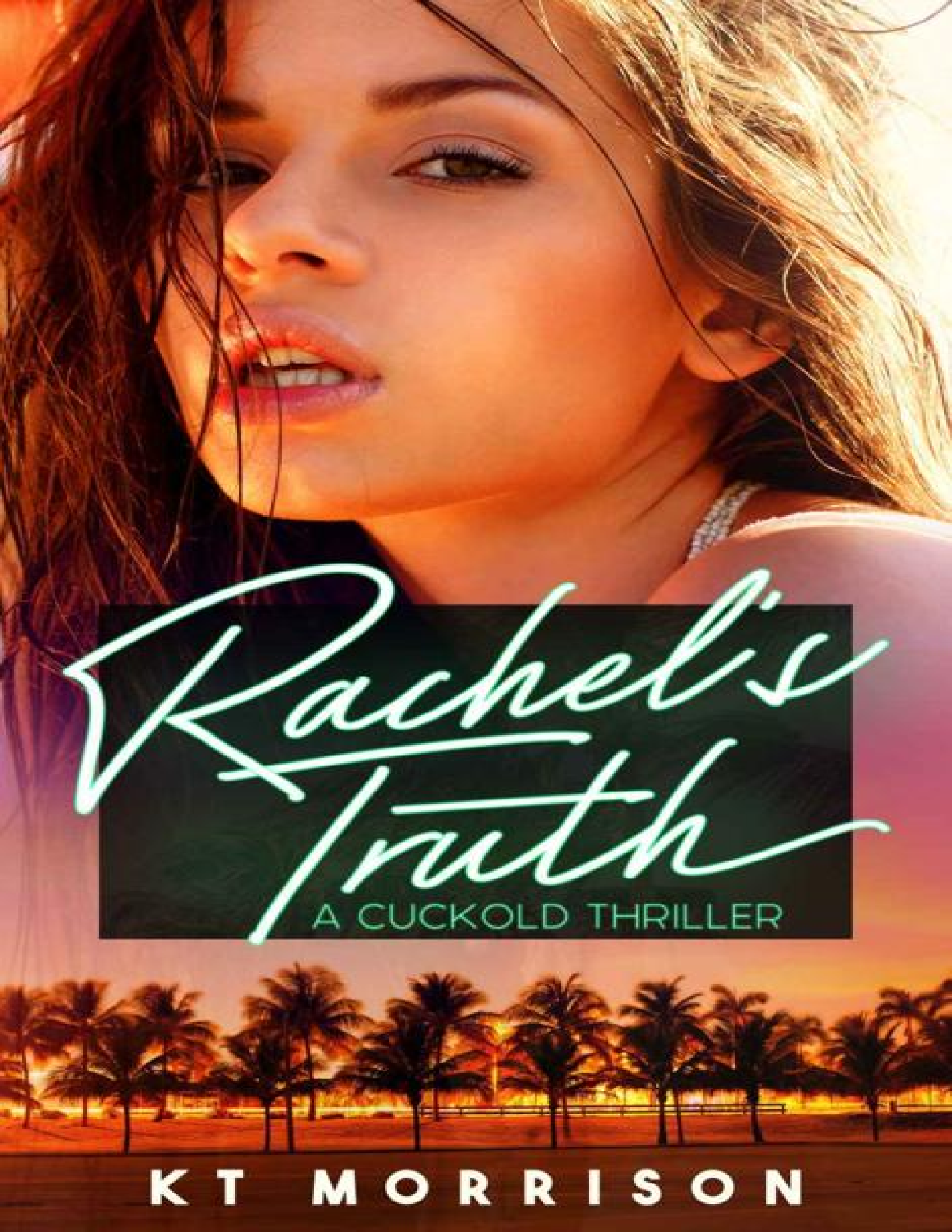




Rachel's Truth

A CUCKOLD THRILLER

KT MORRISON

RACHEL'S TRUTH

A Cuckold Thriller

KT MORRISON

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About the Author

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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Inconceivable

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ANTHOLOGIES

The Taken Anthology

This is a work of fiction. Similarities to real people, places, or events are entirely coincidental.

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All pertinent characters are over the age of eighteen.

RACHEL'S TRUTH

51,000 words

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Written by KT Morrison

Cover by KT Morrison

PART I

Holes

MONDAY, MAY 13

Chapter 1

THE CAR ACCIDENT that gave Rachel her limp was over four years ago, and since the day she left the hospital three months later, she hadn't missed even one of her rehabilitative swim sessions. Three times a week—Mondays and Wednesdays and Fridays—she went to the pool after work from 6 P.M. to 7 P.M. Three years ago it became something they did together as a family—mother, father, and only daughter.

Now Carl was holding his Jessie, drying her hair while they both watched her mom swim what had to be close to her hundredth lap. They were at the Osceola Point community pool, an indoor high metal rafter community center with an Olympic pool divided in swimming lanes. In the swim complex there was also a wading pool for the littlest of children, a wave pool, a hot tub; in the back there was a sauna, and on the other side of the changing rooms there was a gym and a dance center. Three nights a week they came here, and then they would go out for a nice light supper.

Since the accident, Rachel had lost a lot of weight and kept it off. Being lighter, she said, helped her gait. Four years ago she'd been a stressed-out and overworked administrative assistant at a real estate developer's office. She never saw the rich kid in his lifted pickup coming. Speeding, and a little over the alcohol limit, he'd also only had his truck and his license for ten days. And the worst part?—the kid's father had bought it off one of Carl's own lots.

Jessie had been with her in the car, too. It was a miracle that they were both alive, and their daughter, now ten, swore to this day that in the split second before the impact, her mother turned and covered her body with her

own. Their daughter was unscathed. Didn't even lose consciousness. Rachel didn't remember a thing about it. They would tell her later that she was a hero and saved her daughter, but she would just shrug, say she wished she could remember. A humble hero. His hero. But his wife's leg had almost been severed just above the knee. At first the doctors said they would amputate, but she was a fighter and they managed to save it.

So now she stayed light, and she stayed fit, and she quit that job. She always said if she'd had better sleep she might not have wandered into that intersection without seeing the truck coming. He assured her she'd done nothing wrong that day.

When she wanted to work again, he offered her a job at one of the lots. He'd just re-opened the revitalized Ford dealership on Highway 9. She didn't want to work for him, she wanted to bring in her own money, not save his. He said, You don't have to work at all (and she didn't, her salary was a twentieth of what he brought in), and she said it's not just about money. Now she worked two to four days a week doing medical transcription at the very hospital where she'd spent three months recovering, and she was a lot happier. She was busy, but not too busy, not in that crazy high-testosterone office that had all its employees pushing themselves to the limit.

"Look at mommy go," he said as Rachel did a flip-turn at the wall and kicked off again, still strong on the breaststroke even after an hour. She was thirty-one now, more beautiful than ever, and with a whole new outlook on life.

"She's so fast."

He said, "You want to get in the hot tub?"

"Too hot," she said—and he knew that would be the answer but he just liked to tease about it, anyway. They tried to go in once, and their daughter put up a yelling match like she'd been scalded.

He said, "Want to go lift weights with Daddy?"

"I don't want to be big and muscular," she said, leaning back against him, still watching her mother.

"Just kidding, honey. What you want to do for dinner tonight, kiddo?"

"Can we go to the Chinese restaurant?"

"The buffet? That's what you want?"

"Yeah."

“Sure. We’ll ask your mom. Remember, she’s going to go out and visit your Nana tonight so we have to have a quick dinner.”

“I know. Can I go see Nana, too?”

“It’s past your bedtime when you get home then. You can go on the weekend some time.”

“Okay.”

“Who do you think would win in a race, you or your mom?”

“Mom, probably. But I’m getting fast.”

“You are. You’re an excellent swimmer.”

Down in the water, Rachel flip-turned at the far wall, kicked off again, launching a breaststroke across the pool for another lap.

Chapter 2

A HUNDRED LAPS made her sane. It made her leg ache right up into her hip, but she knew it was making her stronger. Every lap made her stronger. And when her leg wasn't aching from effort, when she was idle during the day, the added strength kept the constant pain at bay. She was down to two Oxys a day.

Two Oxys a day, and no more drinking, her other vices gone as well, and these days she liked what she saw in the mirror. At thirty-one she was now in the best shape of her life. She'd never looked better, even when she was a teenager. She'd been a full-figured girl, vivacious, pretty, yeah, but now she was a hundred-and-ten pounds, lean and fit. But she did miss the larger breasts—not that a C cup was bad.

She hoisted herself from the pool, stripped off her goggles and cap, blinking and pulling stray strands of hair back from her face, looking for Carl and Jessie. She saw them there, sitting in the aisle seats waving at her. She waved back.

Fingers running in the leg holes of her swimsuit, she smoothed out water from underneath, making the spandex cling against her tight bod, and went to join them.

Carl came down with Jessie, a towel wrapped around her shoulders like she was cold. He said, "Jessie wants Chinese. You okay with that?"

"Sounds good," she said. "You guys all set?"

Carl said Everybody hit the showers, and she took her daughter's hand to lead her into the women's locker room while her husband went to get himself ready in the men's. When it was quiet in the shower, and it was just

the two of them, mother and daughter, they sang together, but then they were joined by two Asian women and they went quiet again, watching each other and soaping up, and Jessie pretended to keep singing but only mouthed the words, making her laugh. They got dressed and met Carl in the lobby of the community center.

“You’ll meet us at Chan’s?” he asked, taking Jessie’s hand. They had two cars today, Carl coming in from the dealership in the city and her from the north part of the suburbs at the community hospital—after dinner she would have to head inland to visit her mother who was three months now in the nursing home and having trouble adjusting.

“I’ll meet you there,” she said, climbing into her Yukon.

Chapter 3

HE AND JESSIE ate sweet-and-sour chicken balls, probably too many, but hey, they'd just come from exercising. Vegetable fried rice, some beef lo mein, some Mongolian beef that was too spicy, and some breaded chicken cutlets in a lemon sauce—they sampled only the tastiest dishes. Rachel went for a garden salad, and a bunch of chicken strips that she skinned of breading. She had water; he had two Cokes. Jessie drank root beer.

While Jessie was away from the table, he asked Rachel, “How’s your mom doing?”

“Still the same,” she said, eyes turned down.

“Tell her I said hi.”

“I will.”

Jessie was back at the buffet, eyeing the dessert section. Decision made, she put a bowl of Jell-O with whip cream onto her tray. He said, “Jessie wants to visit her grandma. You think we can go on the weekend?”

“All three of us?”

“Yeah. I think we should.”

“Mom would like it.”

“Jessie worries about her.”

“I know. But I worry that Mom won’t remember her.”

“She does. Sometimes.”

“For now. But it’s getting worse.”

He held her hand, rubbed her knuckles with his thumb. “Jessie’s a big girl. She’s getting bigger. She can take it, she needs to know what happens when you get old.”

“You’re right. You’re right, yeah we’ll go. Mom’s fine sometimes. You know, though, last week when I showed up—”

“I know. She didn’t remember you at first...”

Rachel shook her head.

He added: “But she remembered eventually.”

Her mouth went slim, and she nodded. “I know.”

He patted her hand and sat straighter. “What time you going to be home?”

Rachel checked her watch. It was 7:45. “I don’t know. I’ll be there at nine... I’ll stay to ten... probably won’t be home till eleven, maybe eleven-thirty.”

“I’ll wait up.”

She smiled and frowned at him, shaking her head. “No, don’t wait up. It’ll make me feel bad.”

“I got a new book I’m reading.”

“Don’t stay up for me.”

He folded his arms, looked out the front window. Past the red paper lanterns hanging from the ceiling with their long dangling tassels, the twilight sky was a deep blue, with a distinct low swath of periwinkle marked by the big M of the McDonald’s on the other side of the 441. He shrugged. “You can get going if you want. I’ll settle up here. You don’t want a dessert, do you?”

She shook her head no. “I guess maybe I could get going.”

“The earlier you get there, the sooner you’ll be home. You drive safe.”

“Always,” she said. And now Jessie was returning to the table with her green cubes of Jell-O and the stiff puff of whipped cream.

He said, “Jessie, Mom’s going to get going, give her a hug.”

Jessie put her tray on the table, and went over to her mother’s chair, climbing up with her knees in her mom’s lap and hugging her. “You drive safe, Mom.”

“Always, baby.”

“Say hi to Nana for me,” she said. “Tell her I love her.”

“I will. I’ll tell her you’re a big girl. You want to go visit her on the weekend?”

Jessie smiled. “I really do.”

“Okay, sweetheart. Mom will like that. We’ll go on the weekend. Now get off me,” she said, making a pained face and guiding Jessie by her

elbows, “your knees are killing me.”

He said, “Thighs sore from swimming?” making a joke, then the smile fading, remembering what her leg looked like when he raced into the hospital that day.

But Rachel said, “My legs are like steel,” then to Jessie: “But so are your knees,” and tapped Jessie on the nose as she got to her feet again. “I’ll see you in the morning,” she said, then to him, “and don’t you wait up for me.”

Chapter 4

SHE DROVE SOUTH FROM OKEECHOBEE, taking the 78 along the west side of the lake. When she'd passed over the Kissimmee River, the sky still held color, but by the time she was in Lakeport it was black night. Endless flat Florida road rolling ahead now, and the red light twinkle on communication towers beyond the bright swath of her headlights.

In fifteen minutes she'd pass through Moore Haven, go right by the State Prison there, then it was another half hour west to LaBelle where they had Mom in a brand new nursing home facility. *Thanks, Jackie.* Her sister was a pisspot, and always was, a hot-shot Fort Myers real estate agent with a killer attitude who demanded they store Mom at a midway point between their two houses. Luck would have it Port LaBelle Heights opened, and Jackie knew the developers so Mom got one of the first spots. Good luck getting Jackie out for a visit more than twice a month, though. So it was Rachel heading out one or two times a week to sit for an hour with the woman who raised them, each time the still-young widow fading behind those big blue eyes, each time a little less sure of who it was coming through her door.

Halfway to Moore Haven, she had the Yukon at an effortless eighty-miles-an-hour. The drive at night like this made her feel free. It felt good to be behind the wheel, in control, and to have escaped death. Carl got her this tank, and it made her feel indestructible. Yukon, all black, blacked *out*; big wheels, RST package with over four-hundred horsepower. A mere ten-thousand miles on it; a glossy hulk of metal and power.

Only an eighth of a tank of gas left, though. She shook her head, squeezed the wheel.

Knew it was low this morning when she went into work. That was the time she *should* have filled it.

But she didn't.

No, though she swore last Friday she would, this morning she drove right past the gas station and went to work like she hadn't noticed.

And now here she was alone at nighttime, not enough gas to get to LaBelle. She would *have* to stop. Have to stop at nighttime. And there was a station she knew, and though she swore she wouldn't stop there again, she would. In fact, the closer she got to Gus's ramshackle gas station the more her heart raced.

The Yukon slowed. Ahead on the right, a sign read NICODEMUS SUGAR RANCH-PRIVATE, and, the only vehicle on the road, she turned at high speed without indicating and laid her foot on the pedal again.

Carl's gift to her had a *giant* motor and when she teased on the pedal that thing under the hood roared like caged demons.

She blasted through the low sugar cane fields, dead and deserted at night, windows open, listening to the muffled howl of the truck, the ping of gravel in her wheel wells, the screaming buzz of the cicadas.

This sugar ranch road cut across west. Took her out above LaBelle, out into swamp and gator country. This was a private ranch, a huge operation, but they wouldn't stop her, not at night time in this truck. She looked like a Fed. Fuck, she'd love some red and blues on this, something for the dash. Some fuck-you lights to get people out of her way, move aside when they saw her coming. Her foot went down farther, coaxed more speed out of the beast...

Chapter 5

ON THE YUKON'S navigation map, she could see how she was heading northwest now and away from LaBelle. A gentle sort of curve though, one that would eventually link her up with a straight pipe south to meet her mom's nursing home. Out of the sugarcane ranch now, she was on a dusty old Everglade road, complete with gator farms and swamps.

She was approaching Gus's at a cool 55mph, a little fast for the road, but not in her gleaming tank, and she was thinking now she *wasn't* going to stop. She was going to keep going. There was no way she should stop.

But she'd already sealed her fate.

There isn't another gas station before LaBelle and you are on fumes, Rachel, baby. There was a chance—she *could* risk it—but did she want to?

Okay, stop for gas, but don't go in. Stop and get gas and stay in your car.

So now she was slowing, doing the sensible thing. Next Friday when she went to visit mom, she would get gas in the morning before she had to come to LaBelle. She would be prepared with a full tank. There would be no reason to stop. But right now she was in control again. Doing something crazy, but still with a good grip. She liked being in control. She squeezed the wheel, middle finger flicking the indicator to signal that she was indeed going to turn in and stop to get gas at Gus's. But that was all.

Gus's was a general store with two gas pumps out front. A rundown wood-sided shack with a rusted steel roof; the siding was unpainted, gone black with age and weather. Trash and discarded tires and car parts buffeted the perimeter and pathways like gardens. On the walk-up porch an old

toothless man with wild staring eyes sat in a rocking chair. The windows were lit with neon beer signs, and the front door was festooned with ads for cigarettes. Parked up front, in the dirt patch between the pumps and the porch were a dozen motorcycles. Gleaming, expensive looking things; mean, with fat tires and low-slung bodies in bright candy colors. Japanese, maybe Italian, she wasn't sure, but she liked the way they looked.

The Yukon came to a stop by a pump in a cloud of billowing dust. It was a full-service station, and she'd run over the black rubber hose that snaked the driveway, and heard the bell's ding-ding inside the shack. The old man on his rocker raised his hand to wave, and she waved back. He cackled soundlessly.

The attendant came out, a lanky black guy in greasy coveralls with hands thrust in his pockets. He said, "You want it filled," from the other side of the pumps, heading toward the rear of the truck.

"Fill it up, please," she said, then took her purse and put it in her lap. She listened as the gas cap clunked and spun on ratchet teeth, heard it dangle at the side of her vehicle, the attendant yank off the gas gun, and shove the nozzle in her hole. She was flooded with that fresh gas smell, looking in the general store, seeing men in there, all hanging around what used to be a lunch counter, probably. But now she knew they would be drinking beer, all of them hanging around and shooting the shit and bragging, just like last Friday.

She watched her traitorous finger as it hooped around the black door lever, and she urged herself not to open the door. *Stay in the car, Rachel. Just stay in the car. Pay for your gas and then go see your mom...*

A phantom urge to tinkle took hold of her. Was it real? Was it real or was her bladder betraying her now?

Don't go in there, Rachel.

But she pulled the lever, opened the door, nodded to the gas attendant who nodded in return. "I'll pay inside," she said. Just like she did last Friday. Last Friday, that urge to tinkle was not a phantom. Not fake at all. She could have tinkled roadside in the bushes but there were gators everywhere here...

The urge had been so desperate it drove her inside Gus's despite the fear she had. This was rural Florida. This was a black neighborhood. Those were black bikers in the shack. This was a long stretch of road and no one knew where she was. She had a Ruger 22 in her purse, and it made her feel safe

enough she was able to go in ask for the bathroom key and use their facilities.

So now, purse over her shoulder, she adjusted her skirt, straightened her shirt, and made her way to the porch. She said good evening to the old man on the porch, and he tipped his straw hat to her with a finger, nodding, crazy eyes seeing who knew what.

Then she was in, opening the cigarette ad door, setting off the jingle of its bell, walking in and seeing about a dozen young black men turn to watch her. Yes, she was a white woman. Attractive, too, if you didn't mind her limp. Her legs were tan; she'd shaved them this morning. Oiled them, too, after swimming. She was shapely and wore clothes that showed it. She was crazy. Walking into a place like this, bunch of young, hungry men, and she was so appetizing. Their eyes followed her, the room went quiet as she walked to the counter. An older man in his late-fifties standing behind the lunch counter talking to the young ones, walked over to the cashier's spot, said, "Gas?"

"He's filling up right now," she said. "Can I have the key to the bathroom?"

He licked his lower lip and watched her, didn't answer for a few heartbeats and her palms began to sweat.

"Sure can," he said, and he fished under the desk and handed her a key on a long wooden paddle. "I know you know where it is..."

A few of the young men gave low chuckles.

Chapter 6

EYES LOWERED, she held the key at waist level, approached the black men sitting on stools around the counter, feeling their eyes on her, knowing they were watching. Probably in disbelief. Why would this crazy woman come in here? Gotta be the bravest white woman around. All she had to do was tinkle. Probably.

“Excuse me,” she said, in her soft feminine voice as she passed, and then she was beyond them, feeling their eyes burning holes in her back as she went through the narrow doorway between coolers of beer. Then she was in a narrow hallway paneled in dirty fiberboard, unlocking the door marked with the silhouette of a woman on an old plastic shield. She slipped in, locked the door behind her, looked at herself in the mirror. That face looking back at her was crazy. So crazy. So she looked away, before that woman tried convincing her to be good.

She put her purse in the sink, laid the paddle and the key over top, looked at the stalls. There were two, black metal walls and battered doors, a foot-tall gap at the floor. She took the furthest one on the right, closed herself in, used the cuff of her shirt to twist the lock.

The urge to pee was gone, and she closed the toilet lid that had been left up, and sat on the flat seat with her skirt tucked underneath her and her hands on her knees. The inside of the stall had been carved with pen points, knives, keys, or whatever sharp implements could be found to put down all sorts of sayings of the most lewd and lascivious kind. Poems about men who knew what they were doing, limericks about big penises, a phone number for a woman deemed a slut, insults... Who had sexually transmitted

diseases. Naming names. There were drawings, too. Mostly of penises. Penises and people having sex. Crude pictograms...

And on her left, the whole reason she'd come in here.

It was the wall that separated this room from the next. Someone had drawn arrows arranged in a circular pattern toward a ragged hole cut in the dual layers of plaster and chipboard. On the other side was blackness. Somebody had written BIG DICK next to the hole with an arrow, this one more curly than the others, like an eager comma. Someone had written SUCK IT. Somebody else had written FUCK IT.

She stared at the hole and wondered how long she would sit here. Two minutes...? Would that be enough before she left and got back to her real life? She checked her watch. Tapped the side button, found the watch's timer function and set it. Seconds and microseconds began spinning. So, what...?—a hundred and twenty seconds? She would sit here for one hundred and twenty seconds and then she would leave. Pay for gas and get out of here.

And this was the *last* time. On Friday she would get gas before work, and she would drive straight to see her mother.

At the thirty-seven second mark light flooded the hole. Someone on the other side. Her heart was already racing, but now gave a little kick that jolted her. She rubbed her knees, watching the hole.

Sure enough, it was happening. This was why she was here. This was why she cursed herself for being here. This was why she didn't want to be here.

Get out, Rachel! Get out! What is wrong with you?

But she sat forward, scooting her ass to the edge of the toilet seat and waiting, eyes glued to the hole. The light was gone, filled with blackness again, but there was movement...

And now slipping through the hole was the thing that she came here to see again.

On Friday night when she'd come here in the most dire straits, bursting bladder stretched and ready to explode, she'd sat on the toilet and released, then watched in horror as a man slid an enormous penis through that hole and let it dangle in front of her.

Tonight, the same penis. Huge. Frightening. Astounding that this thing was real. It didn't even look fully hard. Not the way it dangled. A black

penis. The hugest thing she'd ever seen. Sliding through the hole then falling to hang against the wall. It was grotesque.

She should run screaming. Should hit it with something. She should kick it. Kick it and scream bloody murder. Take out her .22 and blast it right off his body. It was disgusting. It was disgusting that a man would show it to her. It was disgusting that a man *had* that between his legs. It was inhuman. A barnyard cock.

But she couldn't stop looking at it.

And all weekend she couldn't stop thinking about it. Thinking how it felt in her hand, thinking how it got harder while she played with it. Remembering the hot feel of the semen rolling down her knuckles when she stroked it so much the man came...

Hand out, she tickled her fingers down its length. It was grotesque, but there was something beautiful about it. Something that captivated her. She hefted it. Gripped it where it emerged from the hole. The man had pressed it as far as he could, but there was still some on the other side. *How big was it?* It was two lengths of her hand before the head. She held it in both hands, blood and life pulsing under her fingers.

She squeezed and tugged, felt it grow harder in her grip...

Chapter 7

THE MORE SHE PULLED, the more she tugged and squeezed, the harder the thing grew. Lengthening and thickening to ridiculous proportion. Veins rose against the skin and scurried along its massive size. She stroked with both hands, going up and down, looking at her paleness against its frightening black. She pushed it upright now, straight to the ceiling, feeling its weight, pressing it so its topside mashed against the wall. She braced it there, holding it in place sandwiched between her bare forearms.

It was as big as her forearms from elbow to wrist.

She squirmed her arms against it, felt its hard shape, stroked it again. Eyes closed, using both hands, holding it up, stroking up and down, knowing she was giving whoever owned it pleasure. Loving the feel of it in her hands, loving its size, blackness, and hardness.

Chin pressed to the wall, she took it now, put it up underneath her shirt. Pinned it against the wall with her bare stomach, rolling the flat of her belly against it, feeling it's hard curling iron heat press into the softness of her stomach.

On the other side she heard a faint groan, and the sound triggered one of her own. She groaned too, took it now, stroked it and lifted her skirt. She raised a knee, then touched the huge thing to the inside of her pale thigh.

She stroked it up and down her silky skin, hearing more male groaning on the other side.

“Yeah?” she asked.

A deep rumbling voice on the other side. “You good...”

She gasped, hearing the masculinity in that voice, hearing high testosterone and confidence. She fell to her knees, took the thing in both hands, put the cock head in her mouth. It was warm and supple but firm; it tasted of salt. She could barely get it in her mouth, the full flared shape of him opening her jaw wide. She took it deeper, using her spit to stroke, bobbing up and down, lips stretched to the thinnest ring.

Soon, the man on the other side began pumping into her mouth and she extended fingers through the hole to touch his balls. When she did, she set him off.

The man's urethra swelled, then the opening spread, his cock head flexing in her mouth. Semen shot against the back of her throat in hot, hard pulses and she gagged, pushed herself back with both hands.

Semen still squirted from the thing, sending ropes on her shoulder and down the front of her blouse and she fell to her rump, the huge penis bobbing above her. She scooted farther from the wall on her heels and her hands, kicking back until she banged her head against the stainless steel toilet roll holder.

That huge cock dangled up above her, semen spurting from the tip, dangling in spidery webs and clinging against the wall. She could hear the cock-owner's sounds of grunting ecstasy, his deep-voice male appreciation. Watched then as he pulled back and the huge thing withdrew, fell through to the other side. A black gasket was scissored over to cover the hole.

She retched, coughed, and felt regurgitated Chinese food coil up her esophagus. Over the dinner, she tasted the man's semen; could smell it in her nose. She retched again, getting on hands and knees, thinking she might vomit right on the floor...

But she pulled herself up, yanked the stall door open, stumbled through and fell against the sink. She hoisted her purse out, the paddle clattered behind her, the guts of her bag spilled on the floor but she had the water blasting full, splashing it on her face, cupping her hands and slapping them into her mouth. She rinsed and spat, rinsed and spat, wiped at her mouth with the back of her hand, the whole time avoiding her reflection because she would hate to see what she looked like right now after what she had just done.

Then she was on hands and knees again, using her clawed fingers to shovel the contents of her spilled purse back inside their home, grabbing the paddle key, pinching the purse against her side, making sure it was zippered

and pointing up, yanking open the outer door (afraid to look to the left to see a man emerging from the bathroom, seeing the man who owned that monstrous penis coming out with a smug smile, zipping away his freakish manhood); tears blossomed in her eyes, they swelled against the lids and she pinched her face shut.

She had eighty dollars in her skirt pocket, and she thrust her hand in now, bustling past the seated men at the lunch counter watching her over their shoulders and sneering. The place smelled like beer, and one of the men chuckled. Someone said, “Hey baby, how you like that?” And then they were all laughing at her. Deep frightening laughs. She fell against the counter near the register, knees scratching against wire racks of candy bars, waved her closed fist to the cashier so he could see, threw down eighty dollars to pay for sixty dollars of gas and then ran out, banging the glass door with her shoulder.

The rheumy old man on the porch wheezed, “Good night,” and she didn’t answer him, hustling, the old man cackling, running now with her stumbling, hobbled gait, falling against her tank before she opened the door with a furious heave, threw herself in the driver’s seat.

Then she had the ignition jacked, the Yukon in drive, and she floored it out of there, sending up a shower of gravel behind her.

Chapter 8

RACHEL DIDN'T GET home until late. He'd stayed up reading his book, but when it was eleven-thirty, he shut the table lamp off, lay in the dark staring at the ceiling. When it came to midnight, he would have to start calling for her, see if she was okay. That kept him from sleeping, and it was like that, laying on his back with his arms over the blankets, watching the ceiling, that he finally saw headlights bounce and splash across the high bedroom ceiling, knowing it was Rachel home now. He lay in bed and listened. The garage door opened, heard the Yukon shut off, heard the inside door open into the kitchen. She was down there for a while, doing things in the fridge, pouring herself water. But ten minutes later she was coming up the stairs. She stopped to check in on sleeping Jessie, then came to the bedroom.

In the dark, he said, "How's your mom?"

Her black silhouette said, "You're awake?"

"Apparently," he said with a laugh.

"Mom's fine," she said.

Her tone was enervated, exhausted. He asked her, "Everything all right?"

"Yeah. Fine."

"Doesn't sound all right," he said, leaned over and flicked the table lamp on. She was going into the walk-in closet now, unzipping her skirt and switching the light on. She looked worn out again, and he worried sometimes she didn't sleep enough. He said, "I hope she remembered you."

From inside the closet: "She did, Carl. She remembered."

“Is it something else?”

In the doorway now, she sighed, “Sorry.” Her shoulders drooped and her head hung. She was wearing only her bra and panties, and seeing her like that sparked a lusty interest in him but he didn’t feel the mood from her.

She said, “I lost my wallet.”

Now he was sitting up. “You lost your wallet? Where?”

“If I knew where I lost it, it wouldn’t be lost.”

“Very funny.”

She leaned on the closet door jamb, ran her hair back with one hand. The muscles of her tummy flexed. “I... stopped for gas at this place outside LaBelle. I paid cash, but I brought my purse... must’ve dropped it.”

“You’ll have to cancel your cards.”

“I already did.”

“You did?”

“Yeah,” she said, putting her back to him and rummaging through clothes hanging on the back of the closet door. In the shadowy light like this he admired the taut curves of her pert ass, the way her back muscles squirmed. She was five years younger than him. His brother called her a trophy wife, but it wasn’t like that at all. They had so much in common, so much darkness hidden deep. His eyes drifted down her toned legs, looked at the ragged, torn scar tissue that rung above the right knee. They never talked about the accident anymore, and when they talked about her leg, they called the scar her shark bite.

“Don’t worry about it then.”

“I’m not. It’s just a hassle.”

“It is. What did you lose?”

“All my credit cards, my license, insurance card, practically everything.”

“Any money?”

“Yeah. But I had money in my pocket, too.”

“That was lucky.”

She shrugged. “If it was in my purse, I would’ve noticed my pocketbook was gone when I went to pay.”

“If that’s where you even lost it. What wallet was it?”

“My good one. The Van Gogh.”

“Your Louis Vuitton?”

“Yeah,” she sighed.

“Great.”

“I know,” she said, “it was expensive.”

“At least I know what to get you for Christmas now. Why don’t you come to bed?” He patted her spot next to him.

“Yeah, I’m coming,” she said, pulling down comfy looking clothes from the hooks.

He slid back under the covers, watched her as she undressed in the closet light, folding her lean arms behind her and undoing her bra, shrugging into a light T-shirt. She pulled off her panties, and he got to enjoy her perfect bare ass for a few seconds before she put her legs into a pair of capri pajama pants.

“Your mom’s doing okay there?”

“She was happy tonight,” she said, snapping the elastic waist of her pants. “She consoled me because I was upset about my wallet. Maybe it gave her mind some focus.”

“Get in bed now, I’ll make you feel better.”

She crawled in next to him, lay flat on her stomach with her hands folded up under her chin. He lay on his side and rubbed her back.

She jerked, made a funny face. “You know what? I think I need to shower.”

“Shower? It’s midnight.”

“I just feel dirty,” she said, sitting up quick. “I don’t want to be in bed right now.” She sat up and scooted out of the bed.

“For somebody who was worried about me staying up, you’re certainly keeping me awake now,” he said, watching her pass the closet, headed for the bathroom.

“Sorry, Carl. I am sorry. I’ll try to be quiet.”

“I’m kidding,” he said. “Have a good shower, let yourself soak. Maybe I’ll be awake when you come back to bed...”

Chapter 9

IN THE SHOWER, she stood for nearly fifteen minutes with the hot water scalding her back until she felt like her skin was peeling. She tried to put away the thoughts of what she'd done. It was easy enough to do if she focused on the missing wallet.

She knew where it was.

She'd tossed her purse out of the sink and it toppled upside down and spilled everything out. She'd rifled it all back, but in her haste, missed her wallet. It probably tumbled into the toilet stall.

She couldn't go back to the gas station, so she'd canceled the cards. Didn't discover her wallet was missing until she got to the nursing home, anyway. On the way home, she drove past Gus's, but it was closed. Considered for a moment kicking in the bathroom window and crawling inside but figured a guy like Gus in rural Florida was probably the kind who shoots first and asks questions later. Anyone breaking into his store wasn't likely to be a sassy white soccer mom, and the man would fear the worst and just start blasting before she could explain herself.

She would just get new cards. She would get a new license. But she would definitely miss her Van Gogh wallet though. She loved that wallet. It was ultimately replaceable even if it was expensive. There was something else that wasn't replaceable. Her dignity. What came over her these last five days she would never figure out. Who knows what would make a woman do something so crazy. But she knew she wouldn't do it again. She would never, ever again stop at Gus's station.

With that, she squeaked off the taps, stepped out onto the bathmat and dried herself off. She brushed her teeth for an extra long time. Since that huge penis had ejaculated in her mouth, she'd chewed an entire pack of gum. It was probably a phantom smell, but she could still sense that brine in her nose when she breathed. Light flicked off, she slipped quietly back in bed.

"Hey," Carl said in a mellow voice and she knew what that meant. She turned to face him in the dark. He said, "I'm still waiting up for you."

"I love you," she said.

"I love you, too. Don't worry about a thing. I got your back, we'll get everything replaced."

"I know," she said, putting her hand out and finding the side of his neck, stroking her thumb over his earlobe. He moved in for a kiss and she received him. Soon he was getting over top of her. She whispered, "I just had a shower, Carl."

"I like it when you prepare yourself for me."

"I cleaned myself so you could dirty me?"

"You got it," he said, and pushed his pajama pants down to his knees, over top of her on his elbows with his mouth kissing her neck. She reached down between them and gripped his erection. About a third of the size of the thing she'd been playing with earlier tonight. That thing she couldn't even close her hand around. It was as long as her forearm.

Why did that turn her on so much? She never thought like that before. But as soon as some man slipped that thing through a hole in the wall, it was all she could think about.

She stroked her husband, hand going up and down the second man of the evening, while her other hand pushed her pajama pants down. She rolled over onto her stomach, pushed her rump up.

Carl curled over her back and slid himself inside her. The familiar feel of her husband slipped into her canal, and a horrid thought flashed: what would that other thing feel like? What would a black man's penis as large as her forearm feel like going inside her? She wouldn't even be able to stand it. She would scream.

"I love you," she whispered as he began to push himself in and out.

PART II

Muck Fruit

TUESDAY, MAY 14

Chapter 10

THERE WAS a silhouette of a man through the sheer curtain over one of the front door windows. Two grand, French-looking doors in the center of the foyer that she decorated like pictures she'd seen of old Florida estates—even though hers was what city-folk would call a McMansion—one side shaded now by the strange presence of a visitor in the middle of the day. Unusual because the Magnolia Estates was a gated community, one with a guard hut out front, and there were no solicitors allowed. Visitors were admitted, but Tomesha at the guard hut would call ahead.

Rachel was in the kitchen, staring at a bottle of vodka because that was better than drinking it. The bottle was shoved back in the ice-maker, closed away again in its frigid tomb, and she made her way to the hall, but ducked into the living room and padded to the front window. The man knocked on the glass again as she parted the curtain and peered out the side of the bay window to see who was there.

The site was jarring. A young black man stood on her stoop. He wore leather pants and a leather jacket. Riding leathers, she thought, because they looked padded in places and were run with red piping and corrugated swaths at the hips, knees, elbows, and shoulders. A bad man for sure, she could see it in his face; a mean expression, his cheeks hollow, the jaw a sharp ridged line showing muscle down his neck. His skin was black but shone white on the high spots from the bright sun. A good-looking young man but one that screamed danger. Her eyes wandered to the left, saw now in her driveway the low-slung shiny ninja bike and her stomach rolled over and tightened to a hard ball of cold lead.

Now the man turned and caught her spying, and a powerful urge to turn and flee overwhelmed her. But she was frozen. He turned to face her, expressionless, but nodded his chin.

“What... what do you want?” she asked, her voice loud in the empty house because she’d raised it to be heard through the glass. It was thinned by fear.

The man slipped his hand inside his leather jacket like he reached for a gun in a shoulder holster and her knees went watery, her spine jelly. Her pistol was far away and her hobbled leg would never get her there on time. A thought flashed in that moment: Carl had hired a man to kill her, Carl knew what a piece of shit she was...

The black man withdrew a pocketbook and held it up so she could see.

Soft fabric printed with a Van Gogh painting, black leather trim, gold LV logos. Her pocketbook.

“Oh shit,” she sighed, then loud against the glass: “Sorry, hold on...”

She limped to the door in a hurry, unbolted it, unlocked it, and opened it a foot’s breadth.

The young man still didn’t smile, holding her pocketbook up by his face. There were black tattoos on his black skin. Teardrops near both eyes, an ice cream cone along his jaw, stars on his neck and Gothic designs, a small line of calligraphy spelled out *Jayda Quan* or something like that over one eyebrow.

“You missin’ some?” His voice was so deep she could feel it. It was frightening, dark and gravelly and her thighs trembled. There’d been a flash of gold in the corner of his mouth when he spoke.

“Is that mine?” she asked, her voice airy and useless in comparison.

“Tell you it ain’t mine,” he said, and she wasn’t sure, but she felt like that might’ve been an attempt at humor. And then he said, “And you know where you lost it,” and her blood went cold.

“I’m coming out,” she said, and when he moved aside to give her berth, she stepped out of the air conditioning and into the bright heat. The sun slashed at an angle, catching the clay tile of the overhead awning over the front door. A cool wash of shade protected her, but the sun beat on her bare feet and calves. The space under the awning was still bright, sun reflecting off all the glass ball planters that lined their porch. Sun twinkled off the guy’s diamond earrings; huge studs on the lobes of his small ears. They

stood too close for comfort, her bare feet looking tiny next to his huge, colorful basketball shoes.

She ran her hair behind an ear, turned away because she was afraid to look at him. "I know where I lost it," she said.

The guy didn't say anything, and it made her look up. He still held the pocketbook high, watching her. His eyes were black and showed nothing; the way he held her gaze intimidated her. He sucked his teeth, sniffed, and then his eyes went down her body. One foot crossed over the other protectively.

His mouth was a perfect shape, bowed lips large and practically feminine, but the rest of him grotesquely male. It was killing her not checking out his bulge, see if he were the owner of that big black bathroom Anaconda.

"This for you, Rachel," he said, lowered the pocketbook to present it to her. She was quick to take it.

"Thank you," she said, voice timid, and she reflexively popped it open and began indexing the contents. "I already canceled all my cards," she said.

"Gotta be careful," he said.

She fingered open the billfold and found it empty.

The guy said, "Wasn't no cash when I found it."

"I didn't have any cash," she lied. There'd been almost three hundred dollars.

With the pocketbook in both hands held up against her chest, she regarded him. He watched her coolly like he was studying her. She cleared her throat, said, "You know my name."

"Know where you live, too. How else am I find you?"

"Thank you," she said again. "I just meant... What's *your* name?"

He made a satisfied sort of grunt, said, "Truth."

Softly, she said, "Thank you, Truth."

"Ay, ain't no thing. Just rode an hour to come."

"Oh," she said, frowning, looking back in the house, feeling the AC escaping, a breeze over her calf. "Can I offer you a drink?" She wasn't going to offer a reward, if that's what he was thinking. *Unless he wasn't the one who took the cash...*

"Glass a water," he said.

“Okay,” she said, and now regretted offering, knowing she would invite him in—too polite to suggest he stay on her porch, this wasn’t the 50s anymore, and she wasn’t her mother—and knowing the danger. But she opened the door now for him to let him enter first. She looked across the street to the Watsons’ house, seeing if anyone was witnessing this, not sure if she wanted witnesses or not. She followed him in and closed the door behind.

She told him to come on into the kitchen, and he followed. The guy’s head was moving around, taking in all their possessions, all the neat stuff they had. An uncomfortable squirming began inside her; her guts and her brain.

What the fuck are you doing? This guy was dangerous. He is in your home! He brought your pocketbook because you dropped it on the women’s washroom floor in a gas station you never, ever, should have been in. He might have stuck his monstrous cock through a hole in a bathroom wall. This thug biker walking behind you in your safe, happy home knows your name, knows where you live, and knows your worst secret. It might have been his cock in your mouth. You might know what this man’s semen tastes like...

By the time she got to the kitchen, her breath was coming ragged and scared. Pocketbook tossed to the counter, she opened a high cupboard and brought down a water glass. Her hands were shaking. She ran water in the glass, and her breath snuffed in short, quick pants. Truth moved around near behind her, and awful images flashed to her: him straight-arming a pistol to the back of her head, hand slamming a knife through her heart from behind, or a shopping bag being hooped over her head, him getting her on the ground with his knees on her back as he strangled her and she clawed at the plastic...

When she turned to offer him the water, he was lounged against the kitchen island, arms crossed, one leg over the other, the heel of one expensive-looking sneaker resting on the other’s toe. Between his legs, there was an ample bulge against the leather. The crotch curved out, showing different shapes under the thick, durable material. A penis, a testicle... A sort of formless shape, but proof the guy had a huge penis, and if it were hard, it could have been the one from the glory hole.

She raised her gaze, knew she’d been caught looking. The glass of water was extended, and he took it. Instead of drinking, he placed it to the side on

the island counter.

“Long way I come, bring you your wallet,” he said.

Another request for reward. The money from her wallet was gone, and it was obvious what payment he wanted. The reward this man was looking for was the dewy slit between her legs.

“Um,” she said, her mouth dry, her lips stuck together. Her eyes lowered again to the crotch of his pants, “I... I don’t—”

“You do something for me,” he said.

“What is it?” she asked.

“Come out with me.” He nodded his chin over his shoulder.

“Come out where?”

“It lunchtime, ain’t it?”

“You want me to take you to lunch?”

“Psshh. I take *you* to lunch.”

She chuckled, a funny relief washed up her feet now, making her toes tingle. “You want to take me out to lunch?”

“Let’s go,” he said, easing off the island and sauntering toward the hall.

“Well, I’d have to get ready,” she said to his back.

“No, you don’t. You good,” he said, still walking, not looking back.

“I’m just wearing shorts and a T-shirt,” she said, “I was cleaning.”

“You better be coming,” he said, almost at the door.

Chapter 11

TRUTH HAD PUT his helmet on her, and she watched through the purple tint shade of his visor as they passed the guard hut. Tomesha was there, shining hair pulled back, looking official stuffed in her collared short-sleeve security shirt. The woman watched them pass, trying not to show any opinion, but unable to hide a shifting smirk from her glossy lips. She didn't wave, and neither did Tomesha.

Then they were out of Magnolia Estates, heading into downtown Okeechobee. She felt naked clung to his back. Sure, she had the helmet, but he was covered in leather, and she was vulnerable. T-shirt, no bra, khaki shorts, no shoes, just thong flip-flops. The bike was hot between her legs; her toes felt vulnerable next to the moving wheels and high-powered motor. Truth was hard against her arms. The leather jacket he wore was unzipped, and her hands were on his torso, and she could feel the lean muscle under his T-shirt.

He got the bike onto the 441, and they headed south. As they passed the Walmart Supercenter, she realized she didn't know where they were going.

One minute she's at home, cleaning, the next a stranger is at the door, and with little prompting, she's on the back of his bike and on their way to who-knows-where. It could be a kidnapping. This could be an abduction. Done without a gun or threats, just the lure of some dangerous masculine bad boy energy and a monstrous dick, and she's climbing into a suppositious trunk, putting the duct tape on her own mouth, binding her own hands... Where *were* they going? Not a restaurant in Okeechobee, because now the guy had the bike turning right, east, and even before he

made the turn she knew he would do it... Getting right out of her city, heading south on the 98 now, the bike picking up speed and rocketing down the deep south side of the lake.

She was on the back of a motorcycle, a mom, a wife, middle of the day, holding her arms around a man who without a doubt was dangerous, leaving the safe confines of her house, of the familiar sights of her city. Truth raced the bike down the quiet, two-lane highway that thread through the lowland basin; groves swished by on the left, swampy sections on the right, and the occasional flash of the big, open water of Lake Okeechobee.

She hugged this stranger tight. It felt strangely close—but maybe they'd shared a dark intimacy.

The sun grew hot on her back, and they blasted the highway for a long time, maybe more than a quarter hour, long stretches where they were the only vehicle around, others where they zipped past tourists and truckers, and she didn't mind at all the stares she saw from behind her visor; the looks of concern or displeasure at this white woman in shorts clung to the back of a black biker who was speeding.

After half an hour it was clear where they were going—unless of course he was taking her deep into the Keys. Ahead would be Pahokee, a mostly black city built on muck produce, citrus, and sugar. These days, too, the people here who weren't black were Latino, mostly Mexican immigrants.

And sure enough, in a minute, Truth was slowing, the bike revving high still, the motor anxious for speed, but the scenery passing slower as they came into a developed area, the streets lined now by towering palm trees like it was Rodeo Drive. Only Pahokee was mostly low, flat buildings, bungalows painted in pastel shades; paint often chipping. The squat skyline was marked by a high water tower. The asphalt was sunbaked, bleached light except for the places stained in blotches by oil-leaking vehicles. They passed through the dead main street, past an old barber shop advertising fifteen-dollar haircuts, a place for black men, the barber standing out front in the cool of the shade with his arms crossed over his high-collar white smock. The sign painted in the window was done by hand, maybe his hand, a clumsy scissor looking like the long beak of a prehistoric bird. She looked around Truth's shoulders, taking the place in, a place where Carl would be mad to know she'd visited (are you crazy, Rachel?—yeah, probably).

Truth slowed for a right turn. On the corner was an old movie theater, a grand looking place, a place that once had a heyday, art deco, stucco, every

single surface painted a Pepto-Bismol pink except for the glass of the old ticket window; it and all the other glass boarded up from inside with sheets of chipboard.

Now on a quiet but broad side street she knew would be headed to the lake, they passed an overhead Welcome to Pahokee sign, and on the right, nine, count 'em, *nine*, local churches, Baptist *and* Catholic, each posted together in welcoming unison on an elevated section of rusting chain-link.

Then, as the road rose up a berm, she could see the water...

Chapter 12

AS THEY CAME over the berm's rise, Lake Okeechobee spread out before them in a hazy gray swath. Along the shore was a parking area, empty this time of year and this time of day, about fifty spots ready for tourists and fishermen when the time was right.

Truth brought the bike around, descending to the tiered brick sign that welcomed visitors to the Pahokee stretch of Okeechobee. The lake was vast, looking like a sea, but without that salt air. It was freshwater; the pulsing heart that fed the grassy arteries of the Everglades.

They were behind the town of Pahokee, hidden away from it by a berm that separated the lake from the main streets. Truth's bike passed through the empty parking lot, cool breeze wicking at her legs while the insides of her calves pulsed hot from the purr of the motor. Ahead of them was a long deserted stretch of decaying old road cordoned off by concrete bollards. He wound through a gap there, and they drove for a few minutes at low speed until she saw a small picnic area. A grassy spot with picnic benches, raised up above the lake by a half dozen feet. Beyond it, there was a sandy beach and a heavysset woman standing in water up to her knees, hunched over and attending to a toddler wearing a sun hat. There were more concrete bollards here, and these ones had been tagged by spray paint graffiti. Cars were parked in an uneven disused parking lot. A motor home sat in the grassy section, steamy smoke wavered from a stack in its roof.

Slow, the bike rode onto the grass, and he shut it down. Loud Latin music played from a car's sound system but none of the patrons seemed to mind. The crowd was a mix of black and Latino. Each table had its own

group; one with a heavysset guy, a beanie pulled low, black sunglasses on. He was sitting with two heavy girls, one of them had a tank top that rode high and showed off a tattoo on the small of her wide back. They looked over their shoulders with surly expressions. There were families, too; young guys with pumped up arms and tattoos and two or three women, two or three kids; two sets of older people as well, tough-looking men with salt-and-pepper hair. The black families sat apart from the Latin ones.

Truth got off, waited for her to follow. She pulled the helmet away, smelled spicy, oily Latin food, sauces and hot stuff, cheese and frying meat. “What is this place?”

“We come here for lunch.”

“I know,” she said. “Are you going to treat me?”

For the first time, he seemed to smile, but didn’t really commit to it. There was a softening of his hard expression. He said, “You be a good girl and I treat you right.”

And now *she* was coy, meeting his gaze and running the tip of her tongue casually across her upper lip in the middle to one corner. “I’m a good girl.”

She got off the bike, looked around for where to put the helmet, didn’t know what to do and looked at Truth. He was no help, just staring at her. She said, “What do I do, put the helmet on the bike?”

He took it from her, plopped it down on the seat, pressing it firm like he was hoping it would stay there by sticking.

She asked, “This place is okay?” It was a stupid question. Typical white woman wanting to know if the food was safe. *Like what’s this place’s rating, is it an A?*

But this eatery didn’t have health inspectors, she didn’t think. There was no sign. It was just an old beige Winnebago with a faded brown stripe on the side with its waving W pattern up by the door. The side had been converted to a food counter, a long wide-open window, and inside there was a man and a woman in their forties maybe, the man with sleeves rolled up his tattoo-covered forearms; the woman had a beautiful but serious face. She was heavy, but done up to the nines. Hair in glossy ringlets, big hoop earrings and bright red lipstick.

“Okay?” Truth said.

What she meant: was it dangerous? She gave him a bashful sort of half-smile and worried brows.

He looked her up and down, said, "You be okay."

"You gotta watch out for me," she said, slipping four fingers into each of her front pockets and chewing on her lower lip now. She was afraid to look around and make eye contact with someone who would realize right away this dumb white soccer mom should not be here.

Truth didn't answer, began walking and so she followed. Up the grass, she walked behind him, eyes lowered and accidentally focused on Truth's slim hips. He had a good-looking rump tucked into that leather. It did this flexing thing as he walked, and she was okay with watching it.

He stopped, said, "You good, you go sit there at the table." There was a patio table for two, a tall one with barstools set at it. Next to it was a picnic table, the one with the heavysset guy with the low beanie and the two big girls. The guy was watching Truth from behind his black sunglasses. Truth didn't like it apparently, and he stared at the guy. There was a tense moment that lasted way too long where their two faces were turned to each other, nobody saying anything. Truth's face was fierce and hard. Her stomach lit up with butterflies and she suddenly could picture both of them popping out guns, trying to blast each other. But that was just silly white woman thinking, or at least she hoped.

After a moment that lasted forever, Truth finally said, "You good, player?"

The man shrugged, raised his palms. Truth tilted his head to the side, and it showed a tattoo on his neck. A skull with its mouth open in a howl; it wore a royal crown and there were two handguns crossed below like pirate sabers.

Now the heavysset guy raised both palms higher in a totally *We good* kind of gesture. The woman with the tattoo on her back, saw Truth's neck tattoo, and her eyebrows raised as she turned back and hunched over. The three of them got close over the table and talked in quiet conspiracy.

Truth said, "Go on," and waved with one finger for her to sit at the patio table he'd indicated.

Truth walked to the motor home, she went along timidly, putting her flip-flops up on the bottom rail of the bar stool and sitting with her legs together. She ventured a look over at the picnic table, said, "Hey," to the girls sitting with the guy in the beanie. Friendly, nonthreatening. They didn't answer, and in fact, they looked like they were hurrying up now. Tossing back the food from their waxed paper, knocking back drinks.

She folded her forearms together and watched them as they bundled up their belongings, threw out their trash. She avoided looking at the other tables, but could sense them all peering her way. The three people left the picnic table, got in their Jeep, the one playing the music, started up and turned the music down. Then they were gone.

Chapter 13

TRUTH RETURNED HOLDING a low cardboard box with two waxed paper bundles, a Coke cup with a straw, another Coke in the other hand. He sat across from her, climbing up on the barstool, setting the food down, taking off his leather jacket. The T-shirt he wore was a V-neck, and it clung to him. He wasn't jacked, but he was lean and every muscle stood out in sharp pronouncement. Black tattoos scrawled up his black arms. He had rings, an expensive-looking watch, jewelry, too. He pushed one of the wrappers toward her.

"What is it?"

"Burrito."

"Beef?" she said and began unwrapping.

"What? You vegetarian?"

"No," she said, "I like meat." The bizarre and dirty sounding phrase hung in the air, and she didn't pull it back.

She unwrapped the gingham check wax paper and revealed a folded over corn tortilla leaking oily sauce, heaped with meat and cheese and vegetables. It was kind of perfect. The sun was hot, the temperature nice, and a cool breeze came in off Lake Okeechobee. It was hazy out on the water, gray, kind of like there was a storm coming though there was none in the forecast. She tried the burrito, and it was really fucking good. "Oh shit," she said. "Why do I go to Taco Madness?"

"Pahokee long way to come for a good burrito," he said, taking a bite of his own, "You stuck with that suburb shit."

They ate quietly for a moment, and the bizarreness of the situation was unrolling like a never-ending carpet kicked down a hill. How did she know this guy again? Oh, the worst thing you could imagine. That's how. She lost her wallet, the guy returns it. Takes her out to lunch. Takes her where? A hidden spot in one of the more intimidating parts of Okeechobee, at least for some pampered white princess from a gated community. Now they were sitting here trying to make small talk, and the guy didn't want to make small talk.

She took a sip of her Coke. They continued eating in silence. It was nice now with the car stereo gone, though she still heard quiet Latin music coming from inside the Winnebago. They were washing dishes in there, clanging and banging things, the hiss of water on a hot skillet.

She said finally, "Thanks again, you know, for bringing my wallet." It was dumb because it was something they couldn't get past. The obvious question was: did you like your blow job? But she wasn't going to say that. Maybe it wasn't even him. But then again, she'd seen his bulge.

He didn't respond to her thank you, wiping his mouth with a napkin, those good-looking plump lips working around as he chewed. When he was done, he said, "Why you limp?"

She made a funny exhale and rolled her eyes. She sniffed, said, "Polio."

Now for the second time she was introduced to a lighter Truth. He finally smiled, a little more committed this time, showing off maybe the whitest set of teeth she'd ever seen. There was a flash of gold there again on his left side. In the light now, she could see the tattoos on his face a lot clearer. She wondered who Jayda Quan was. Truth said, "Ay, my grandpa had polio, he got your limp. Ain't no kids got polio these days. What you, a hunnerd years old?"

She said, "No, I know. I guess I was trying to be funny. Polio's not funny. Sorry about your grandfather."

He didn't say anything, folded his arms together and watched her.

She wiped her mouth, said, "Car accident. But I don't want to talk about it."

He looked under the table, his hand coming out to touch her knee. She flinched, put her legs tighter together. With his thumb he shoved up her shorts leg and revealed her scar.

"Shark bite," she whispered, watching his long black thumb stroke over the raised tissue patchwork.

"She look like it," he said, studying her scar. Then abruptly, changing the subject, he sat up again, saying, "What your man do?"

"My husband?" She got shy, suddenly closing off, hunching forward and glancing around. She ran a thumb back and forth over her gold necklace, letting the pendant tickle at her collarbone. "Cars."

"He do cars?"

"Dealership."

Truth said, "*Dealerships*."

"Yeah. He has a few. You know that?"

"Rachel Webster, married to Carl Webster of Webster Automotive."

"That's us," she said. "And what do you do?"

He chuckled, flexed his arms a little as he got close to the center of the table. "Make paper."

"That's money?..."

"Buy and sell game."

"Oh yeah?" She was going to be ditzy and cute, ask him if it was on eBay he made his buy and sell money. It could be left unsaid how he made money. Instead, she smiled slyly, said, "You make enough money, you come all this way to give a woman her wallet you could sell online for a grand and a half."

"Long time since I snatched a woman's wallet. I do, it gotta be worth *ten-Gs*."

"Good thing mine's so cheap, then."

He nodded, made a sneer again, studying her. "You should take better care your things." Now his face was closer to her, and the smile was gone. That feeling of intimidation came across her.

Some of the families had packed up, and the ones that were left had their backs to them. He was silent for a long time, doing it on purpose to make her uncomfortable. She looked down at her balled up wax paper.

She said, "I know where I lost it."

He said, "I know where I found it."

Without turning her eyes up to look at him, she said, "Was that you on the other side?"

He was quiet, and she peeked up at him through her brows.

A slow smile returned, mostly to one side. He said, "Other side of what?"

"Do you know what I'm talking about or not?" she said.

He didn't answer, like he was waiting for more. She moved her eyes up and met his fully. In the bright light like this they weren't so black and scary. They were actually a good-looking set of eyes. Hazel, maybe little bits of gold in there too. She looked away again, overwhelmed with shame.

Truth shifted on his seat, leaned a little closer, put his hand over her wrist. It was strangely intimate, and she wanted to snatch her arm back but didn't. She looked around to see if they were being watched, feeling anxious. He ran his thumb over her wrist bone, and pulled her arms unfolded, led her hand down to his thigh, placed it high up. The leather was hot under her skin, baked by the sun. She leaned forward, her eyes darting around, afraid she was going to be seen. She crawled her fingers to that bulge between his legs. She got a grip on it, squeezing ample male flesh under the heavy material.

He said, "You think it was me?"

"I think it was you," she whispered.

Chapter 14

SHE CARESSED the leather bulge a little, then felt like she was pushing her luck. Hand sliding his sun-hot thigh, she sat back, intertwining her fingers over the balled up wax paper. She leaned forward, without using her hands, took a long drink on the straw and smirking.

While she did that, Truth leaned back on his stool, shifting to one side so he could get a hand into the tight pocket of his leather pants and withdraw a screw-top vial. He opened it, set the black plastic lid down, tilted up the vial and from it drew out two lines of white powder. A blue elastic hugged a short straw to the side of the vial, and he unwound it, set the straw next to the lines. He said, "You crazy, ain't you?"

"No," she said, frowning.

Now he smiled, said, "Okay... sure you ain't."

She looked around to see if she were being watched. A breeze picked up, and she instinctively cupped her hand next to the two short dashes of white powder. She asked, "Is it coke?"

"Try it and see," he said.

She looked over her shoulder again, saw nothing but the black family left, hunched over and having a good time with their food. The window of the Winnebago was vacant, the two people she imagined were husband and wife still cleaning up inside. The woman was still down at the beach with a toddler. She had a huge tattoo that looked like paisley from this distance, spread from her hipbone to her knee even though she had to be fifty.

A smile spread on her own face she couldn't help. Was embarrassed by it; she covered her face with her hands, but kept her eyes on Truth. Then,

moving quick, before that wind could pick up and stir the two little dashes, she lowered to the table, took the straw, tilted her chin and awkwardly snorted up one of the lines. It was coke. It was good coke.

She drew back, snorting loudly, rubbing the sides of her nose with the finger pads of both hands. Then she tweaked on her nose, watched as Truth snorted up the remaining line. He cleared his throat, said, "Yeah, Rachel likes to party."

She sniffed again then rubbed her thighs. She clarified: "Rachel *used* to like to party."

"Rachel used to have a lot of fun?"

"Rachel used to have *all* the fun."

He drew her hand down again, led it between his legs. This time she was less reluctant, only giving a short glance around. She caressed the bulge, did it in ways she thought might give him pleasure. He watched her, their eyes looking into each other while she did. He said, "Go back to your place, get more comfortable."

She smiled again, said, "I'm not going to cheat on my husband."

"I guess you don't think using your mouth is cheating."

She got the nerve to stare in his eyes, show him a little defiance. Only, one second doing it and she could feel herself submitting to him; seeing in his eyes she shouldn't dare.

He said, "I come out all this way bring you your wallet, buy you lunch. What you think I do that for?"

"We'd have to be quick," she said in a purr, keeping it hypothetical.

When he only stared at her with masculine confidence, she said, "Where?"

"Your bed."

She let the coy smile on her face fade. "I'm not cheating on my husband."

Truth cocked his head. "You like sucking it."

She was feeling bold again, the coke working some magic on all her fears and anxieties. She said, "Fuck you, Truth," but sexy, with sultry eyes as she caressed his cock. The thing under the leather was growing. She did want to feel it. She caressed it some more, defining the shapes now. Clearly could tell what was penis, what was testicle. The part that was penis was growing like a curled butcher's sausage rising up against the leather. It was massive, even only semi-hard it was the biggest thing she'd ever felt. It

curved down between his legs and she wanted to free it, but couldn't do it here. She said, "You want a blow job?"

"I want whatever you're offering."

She wiggled her nose, tasted coke at the back of her throat. "I'm offering a blow job," she said, and couldn't believe the words came out of her. "We can go in the bushes."

"I ain't fifteen. We going to your bedroom."

"Sure."

He asked, "We all set here?"

"I don't want any dessert," she said.

"Cept this," he said, somehow flexing his cock and lifting his thigh a little.

"Except this," she said, patting it. "Let's go."

Chapter 15

CLUNG TO HIS BACK, doing what she swore had to be a hundred miles an hour, they rocketed northward up the 98. Ten minutes north now of Pahokee, something anfractuious was working in her stomach, twisting her up like she'd never felt before. One wrong move right now—if this bike swerved for a possum—she would be a fifty-foot northward blood-smear up the 98.

Now they picked up more speed, the bike roaring louder, heat flickering against her ankles. She clutched herself tighter to him, one hand locked like iron across the opposite wrist. There was a freight truck ahead, two loads on the back, she saw it on the horizon and then seconds later they were passing, zipping by while it rumbled on the right side.

As they passed, Truth hunkered down, gripped the handles tight, thumb on throttle, his arms going hard, and his body following suit. She could feel his stomach tightening underneath her arms, could feel how hard and mean his body was.

When they were past the truck, still going too fast, she found something else... Leaning forward pushed her down onto the seat. This high-powered bike had a motor that produced a hum that could be felt through every bit of its frame. With her arms squeezed around this lean and dangerous man with a huge dick, her pussycat mashed down and her clit buzzed with the bike's vibration.

Pressed to him, she sucked her tummy in tight and angled her pelvis forward. The bike's drone buzzed through her sexual core, lit up her clit like a struck match head. She tightened her thighs and humped the seat.

Now her hands had opened, wrist crossed over, feeling the muscles of his chest underneath the leather. Wind zipped over her skin, grains of sand kicking up, slashing at her feet and knees. She dug her nails in, let them run down, felt the ridges of his muscular chest, his hard ribs and stomach. Hands crossed over again, she found the top edge of his leather pants, fingers slipping in. The bike went faster, the motor's hum picking up the vibrations between her legs.

Now her mouth was open in the helmet, the sound of her gasping loud in her ears. Her breaths came faster as she slipped her right hand now deeper into his pants, down the center, below his navel, feeling the scratch of his pubic hair through her fingers. The flesh of his cock was hot and gummy. She curled her grip over him, the heap of his genitals way too big for her hand. She squeezed him, found his balls. They were big; she was gentle with them. His thick cock grew firm against the heel of her hand, making the fit very tight. But she forced her hand to open, circling a grip near the end of it, her thumb finding the flared ridge of his cock head, curling underneath, stroking that big thing under its chin.

She caressed him, closed her eyes, thought of what it was like seeing the massive thing in her hand come through that hole in the wall. How awful. How perfect.

Thighs flexed tighter, she tightened her pelvic floor, scooted forward and backward, pumping her hips against his ass and rolling her clit down on the hard vibrations of the bike.

She cried out a deafening sound in the helmet, small, desperate shrieks as she orgasmed at over a hundred miles an hour.

Chapter 16

THE STEREO WAS alive with a bluetooth connection to Jessie's iPod, meaning he was listening to the mellow, mildly suggestive crooning of some boy-band she was hot on. She was bopping around in the passenger seat, being cute (and, he was sure, also amused by annoying him though he pretended he didn't care), her ponytail swishing as she flicked her head, then, mouthing along, she held out straight a wagging *Oh, no, you don't, boyfriend!* finger. Anyone in another car would think she was a kook. And she was.

They were in a trade-in Camaro SS he wanted to try out. A convertible with the top down, one-year-old with not even ten-thousand miles on the odo, crawling along Harlowe, indicator on for Magnolia Estates. Jessie waved dual enthusiastic hands at the guards as they paused to wait for the barrier arm to lift. Tomesha gave them a wary look, then a nod and half-smile. He nodded in return, passed into their gated community.

They wound through the curving roads that divided the luxury homes, turning onto theirs, making the sharp right to turn in past the high hedgerows that shielded their Spanish Colonial mansion. There was a motorbike in their circular brick driveway, a woman with a black helmet on, a black guy in leather.

Jessie leaned forward, said, "Who's that?"

"I don't know," he said. "Is it Mom?"

The woman looked like Rachel, but what would she be doing riding on a motorcycle with a guy like that? The woman wore flip-flops, shorts, a T-

shirt. Clearly no bra. But even before she turned and removed the helmet he knew it was her—the posture, the knees, hands, her telltale scar...

Rachel shook her hair out, helmet held at her chest, gave him a weak smile.

“It’s Mom,” Jessie sang in a cautious tune, turning off her iPod and collecting her book bag from between her feet.

“Hi, Jessie,” Rachel said, giving a happy wave.

But Jessie was watching the man on the bike. He dismounted now, his black face in a scowl; there were obvious tattoos on his neck and on his face. The kind of guy who made your testicles climb up inside your body. What the fuck was he doing with Rachel?

His daughter whispered, “Who is that guy?”

“I don’t know, Jessie,” he said, “Why don’t you run along into the house for me.”

They both got out of the Camaro but Jessie stood in her academy uniform, book bag over her shoulder and watching her mother and the black guy with concern.

The black man came around the bike to stand near Rachel, and he felt a sudden mean protectiveness wash over him. Sun gleamed off stones in the man’s ears, and the muscles flexed on his jaws as he shot a fierce look Carl’s way.

With his daughter and wife there, the things he cared about, he was bold. With a steady voice, he said, “Who’s your friend?” His own brow lowered, and while he wouldn’t make eye contact with the guy, he matched the man’s confident expression.

Rachel registered his distress, raised her eyebrows and looked like she struggled to answer. Her mouth was open, but all she managed was a thin croak. Then, with a sort of embarrassed unease, she said, “Carl, this is Truth. He brought me my wallet. He found it at the gas station.”

“Oh shit,” he sighed. Of fucking course, what were you thinking? Prickly embarrassment tingled all over his back and scalp and he was filled with remorse. He was going to be all over the news tomorrow for thinking racist thoughts, for fuck sake. But it wasn’t that. He wouldn’t be happy finding his wife on the back of any man’s motorcycle...

“Shit, shit, sorry... Truth, is it?... Truth, sorry, thanks a lot, man, that’s really great.”

He felt like such a heel. He closed the distance, coming out front of the Camaro to shake the guy's hand. Truth lifted his arm with languid cool, kind of slouched back now, hip touching his motorcycle's handlebar. They were about the same height, but the guy had that hard look to him Carl's comforts wouldn't allow, younger, too, younger than Rachel even, maybe mid-twenties. His handshake was soft; like he couldn't be bothered to rise to the masculine challenge of the hand-grasping ritual.

"Well, hey, why don't you come inside?" It was a move to prove to himself he was a good guy despite his knee-jerk reaction that this guy was a thug. But, shit, the guy could return a wallet and still be a thug. And, wait, what the fuck was Rachel doing on the back of his bike?

"Sure, man" the guy said finally, his voice a deep gravel-rumble that startled him. "Heard I was too late, she cancel her cards already."

"She did?" he said, looking surprised. Rachel gave him a weird expression because she'd already told him that. He said, "She'll be glad to have it back, though, she loved that wallet..."

Chapter 17

TRUTH TOOK him up on the offer of coming inside and now he was nervous again, standing in his home, in the foyer, with this dangerous-looking man. Jessie had gone on down the hall and was in the kitchen using the landline.

The silence was weird, weirder than seeing a guy like Truth in his house. He said to Rachel, "You were on his bike?"

"Oh," she said, rubbing her arm. "Yeah, we went out... I took him to lunch for... for, like, a thank you."

"That was nice," he said, smiling now, satisfied with the answer. That made sense. "Where did you guys go for lunch?"

Rachel said, "I took him to this place he wanted to go to, down by the beach... Down in Pahokee."

"Oh, yeah? All the way down there?" He could picture his wife now in her soft cotton things, clinging to this black man, racing down the 98, the black man giving her a thrill her boring old husband couldn't give her. He bet the guy opened the bike up, too, showing off. He grew uneasy. "Pahokee? Isn't it dangerous there?"

"No, it ain't," Truth said.

Carl said, "I think it is for me," trying to keep it light.

Truth said, "Wasn't you takin' her?"

"I know."

"She safe with me."

He shifted weight from one foot to another, unnerved by Truth's humorless response. It was hard to formulate a comeback, but he was lucky

Jessie was returning from the kitchen. He said to her, "Hey, isn't it nice this man returned your mother's wallet?"

Jessie said, "It is, yeah, thank you. That was really nice of you, sir."

Truth did a chin nod, said, "Wasn't nothing."

It was quiet again, and even Rachel seemed troubled now, she made to say something but closed her mouth.

Jessie turned to him, said, "Can I go to Meadow's place? Her Dad's going to take her to the arcade."

"Arcade?" he said. "You mean the casino."

"No. Well, yeah. But they have the kids' part. Please?..."

Rachel said, "Without your dinner?"

Jessie huffed. "Mom, we'll eat there."

"Pizza or something," he said.

"Vegetarian pizza," Jessie said, like that made it a better option.

Then in that low rumble: "Go on visit with your friends."

They all turned to Truth, standing there with that grim expression telling their daughter what she could do.

Jessie didn't miss a beat, spinning to shoot him a: "See, Dad."

Rachel said, "Go change. I'll call Meadow's mother."

"I can go?"

"I'll call Meadow's mother. Long as you're not home late and you do your homework before school tomorrow..."

"I will," she said over her shoulder as she darted up the stairs.

Rachel sighed, and he wasn't sure but thought it was relief. He knew the feeling. It would be better if Jessie was out of the house.

Now Rachel gave a weary smile, said, "Does anyone want a drink?"

Chapter 18

THE WORRY WORKED THROUGH HER. When Carl came home with Jessie like that every nerve in her jangled and buzzed. But what did she expect coming home at this after-school time? The blow job she'd offered Truth was more fantasy than reality. Maybe even just a way to get the guy to take her home. If she hadn't played along with him, he might've abandoned her in Pahokee. The orgasm on the bike, though, that was for fucking real. Sorry—*two* orgasms, thank you. The guy's massive black cock in her hand, the bike's buzz on her clit...? She got hers today, now all she had to do was get Truth out of here, and she swore she'd never darken Gus's bathroom stall door again.

The fact Truth would suggest their daughter's schedule was a little alarming, but all the more reason to go with the flow and get Jessie out of the house. And, soon after, her big-dick-dangler, too. The guy was probably sore he wasn't going to get his dick sucked like he thought, but that window closed. Her husband was home, and Truth had to be returning to his Everglades gas station.

Truth said, "You offering a drink?"

She said, "Yeah. What can I get you?"

"Vodka and some juice," he said, eyeballing Carl.

Carl looked to her and she could see his mind going a mile a minute. *Who is this guy, how is he in our home...?* But Carl was the one who said to come inside for a drink, and, yeah, it surprised her. Carl and Jessie getting out of the convertible, she was thinking she'd slap Truth on the back, say *Thanks again!* and encourage him to get going. And Truth, if he had a brain

in his head, would have just said, *Yup, glad you got your wallet, Mrs. Webster*, and raced off. In his mind he'd probably think he'd drop by tomorrow when Carl was out—housewife offering up a blow job probably wasn't fussy about the date. Now the guy knew she was game, knew where she lived, what was to stop him from showing up a couple times a week looking to get that baseball bat spit-polished?...

Coming in the house for a drink was unexpected. She said, "Carl, you want one?"

Carl's eyes were down, and at first it looked like he was deep in thought the way his brow was lowered, making those knits usually brought during tax season, but it wasn't reverie or concentration, her husband was looking between Truth's legs. Sure enough, the bulge in his leather pants was pronounced; a real basket, a multi-humped bulge in pants that most men wouldn't make a bump in. "Sure, hon," he said absently, brow relaxing and looking up at her. "Beer."

It was a relief to leave them, go into the kitchen and put some space between her and Truth and escape that awkward tension. Vodka pulled from the freezer, she poured Truth a short one in a glass with some orange juice. A glance over her shoulder showed Carl leading Truth out of the hall and down the step into the living room. She pulled a beer out of the fridge for Carl and went to join them.

They were seated in the living room, Carl taking the midway spot on the Spice Islands wicker sofa, Truth taking the matching chair, slumped in it, sneaker up on his knee. Neither of them were talking, and it made her wonder if they'd just stared at each other for the whole time she was getting drinks. But Carl said now, "Hey, Truth said you lost your wallet in the bathroom."

"Yeah," she said, passing the vodka drink to Truth, "I told you that's where I thought I lost it."

"Not the bathroom," he said, taking the beer she offered.

Truth said behind her, "You ain't havin' nothing?"

She glanced over her shoulder, Truth watching her, head cocked, holding the drink she'd prepared on the heel of his sneaker. "Not thirsty," she said, then back to Carl, "The gas station. I told you I thought I lost it there."

Carl nodded, sipped his beer, said, "He says the station's up north of LaBelle, says it's—"

“I know,” she said, voice defensive, “I took the scenic route, it’s hardly even out of the way.”

“Girl like the ‘Glades,” Truth said.

Carl studied her, then looked across at Truth. She shot another look over her shoulder at the guy, this one her best *Stay out of it*.

Truth made a slow production of setting his feet down, leaning forward and placing his untouched drink on the glass coffee table top, easing back into the chair looking comfortable and at home, knees out wide. He patted his thigh. “Whyn’t you have a seat, Rachel?”

She whisked a look at Carl, who was equally bewildered, but both of them frightened about what to do. She pivoted and tucked herself to sit next to her husband, unable to keep at bay a disgusted sound she made by clucking her tongue. Now it was her and Carl staring at Truth looking like he didn’t give a shit. “You ain’t gon’ come sit on my leg?”

She made an offended face, waiting for Carl to lose his shit, hopefully defend her honor, but she couldn’t turn to face him, instead shooting her insulted expression only at Truth, who patted his leg again like he was encouraging her to come and join him. “Your leg?” she scoffed.

Carl stiffened. “What’s happening here?”

“I’m not even sure,” she said, continuing the disgusted vein.

Truth raised his eyebrows, kept his lids low and sleepy. “I like your wife,” he said, “girl give good head.”

Carl spat a quiet, “What?”

Extremities gone dead and cold, she jumped up, fighting the woozy, drunken feeling that wanted her to collapse face first through the table’s glass, had to inch one foot forward so she wouldn’t fall. She was firm: “You’re disgusting. I think you need to leave right now.”

Truth didn’t budge, regarding her like this was the reaction he suspected.

Carl cracked his beer bottle down, stood by her side, saying, “I don’t know what your deal is, but it’s time to go, Truth. Don’t make me call the cops.”

Truth said, “Call the cops? What you do that for? You the one invite me into your home.”

Carl stabbed a finger at him. “But you’re insinuating things...”

“I ain’t insinuating anything, Carl. I’m telling you the truth how it is.”

She said, “I don’t know what the fuck you’re even talking about, but it’s definitely time for you to leave. Just leave.”

Truth was bemused by them now, making her furious, fucking with her, and his head rocked back as if he were cackling interiorly. He put up his palms, the whole time his eyes not leaving Carl. He said to him, “Ay, you don’t want to know about it...”

Carl said, “You’re scaring my wife, and I want you out of my house.”

Truth set his big hands on the points of his knees. “All right. I’m going. I walk out that door you ain’t never going to know what I’m talking about.”

“Good,” she said, crossing her arms and scowling. “Thanks for bringing my wallet but get out of here and don’t ever come back.”

Chapter 19

THIS ARROGANT THUG got up out of the wicker chair, sauntering along to the front hall with swagger, adjusting his leather jacket as he went. He and Rachel followed.

At the door, Truth didn't even pause, turn back to glower balefully or offer up some threat or insult them, he just walked out quiet and confident like he had later appointments on his mind.

He slumped, relieved, not knowing what to do when the guy had said that about his wife, knowing how threatening that was, how the guy could beat the shit out of him most likely, and probably was packing a pistol. His guns were all upstairs, his Python in the glove compartment of his Tundra parked back at the GMC lot. Right now his neck swelled with renewed blood flow from his pounding heart. He actually felt light-headed. He breathed through his nose in long, full drags, arms crossed and expression mean.

Rachel went to the door and locked it, peeked out past the curtain to see what Truth was doing. At last, she said, "He's going," over top of the high buzzing sound of that sport bike in low gear.

"What the fuck was that, Rachel?" he spat, mad still and happy to have someone he could take it out on.

"I have no idea, Carl, I swear, that just freaked me out." In the moment before she crossed her arms over her chest he could see the swollen bulbs of her nipples through her cotton tank. She returned to stand near him, eyes turned up the stairwell, thinking of Jessie.

"Why did he do that? Why did he say that?"

“He seemed so nice earlier. When he showed up—”

“What did he say to you?”

She shrugged her shoulders high, eyes wide and staring with distress and unknowing. She said, “He was nothing but nice at lunch. We went and bought the burritos just like he was talking about.” She shook her head now, staring at a spot on the floor somewhere behind him. Quieter now: “He came here, and I didn’t want to let him in the house, but he insinuated something about a reward. And when I didn’t know what to offer him, he said I could buy him lunch, so I went with him. He seemed so nice, Carl.” She looked upset and bothered, her cheeks rosy.

“So what do you think? He was casing the house?”

“No,” she said sullenly. “I just think he’s weird.”

“Great, you lose your wallet and a weirdo finds it.”

“Sorry,” she mumbled.

“It’s not your fault. But how am I going to sleep tonight?”

“How am *I* going to sleep?”

They were both silent for a long time, him looking at her and thinking about what the guy said. And she knew what he was thinking. *Girl give good head*. Said that was the truth. What does that mean? *I mean, the words were clear, but how could he mean that?* How would he know something like that?

He said, “Where was this gas station?”

“In the bush. Past halfway between here and LaBelle.”

“Was it like an Esso? Like a big place?”

“No. Kinda small. Kind of scary.”

“And you didn’t notice him there?”

“No. There were some other guys there like that. I didn’t see him.”

“Guys like what?”

“You know... Black guys. Black guys that ride motorcycles.”

“Why would you stop there for gas?”

“I needed gas,” she said, mad she had to state the obvious.

“Why would you drive out all that way without a full tank?”

“I just wasn’t thinking, Carl,” she said with venom.

“I’m not needling you. But places like that are dangerous. And look at this, the danger followed you home.”

She sighed and rubbed her neck. “He’s not dangerous.”

“Bullshit that guy’s not dangerous. He takes you down to Pahokee and says you’re safe with him? What does that mean?... It means that he’s more dangerous than the neighborhood.”

“It’s just bravado. And Pahokee was nice, it wasn’t how I thought.”

He laughed. “The guy’s scary.”

“I think it’s fine, Carl. Don’t worry about it.”

He looked in her pleading eyes, trying to smooth this over and it just made him more angry. “Why the fuck did you get on his bike and let him take you there? It’s fucking insane to me, Rachel.”

“I know,” she said, finally conceding something. “I didn’t want him in the house, so I go out on the porch. He gives me my wallet and I want to offer a reward. He doesn’t want a reward, but he says I can take him out for lunch. It seemed safe, and like I said, he was nice. And it beats letting him in the house, and it gets us away from here... but I assume we’ll go into Okeechobee, but once I’m on the bike, there’s nothing I can do, next thing we’re on the 98 and—”

“Headed to Pahokee.”

She nodded, gave an uneven smile. “I’m an idiot, Carl. Okay? Is that what you want to hear? I’ll admit it. I wasn’t thinking...”

He grimaced, rubbed his forehead. She *was* an idiot. It was stupid. He was so disappointed in her. A young, kind of good-looking black man shows up on his motorcycle and the mother of his kid gets on it...? Like, what on earth was she thinking? And the worst thought he had, he was afraid to consider, but here it came anyway... It looked like the guy stuffed a half dozen socks in his underwear. It made him uncomfortable to consider that. Rachel seeing that huge sexual lump and it becoming a factor in her decision to ride off with him on a motorcycle. A sudden image came to him of her arms around him on the bike, her hands drifting low to give it a squeeze and find out if it was real. He grunted, grimaced. She was looking at him. He said, “You still have your pistol?”

“Of course.”

“You didn’t lose it, too?”

She rolled her head around on her shoulders. “I would tell you if I did. I’m not gonna lose my gun and have it out there for anyone else.”

Their eyes met, and Rachel did that submissive thing he liked. Where she surrendered to him his argument, anything for him to be happy. But Truth’s words still ran around in his head like an echo in a damp cave. *Girl*

give good head. That didn't come from nowhere, he feared. There had to be more going on than he knew, but it was impossible to think this guy brought her a wallet she lost and she thanked him by sucking his cock. That was stupid.

She said, "Why are you looking at me like that?"

"Like what?"

"I don't know. I don't like it."

"I can't stop thinking about this. It's fucking crazy, Rachel."

"I told you it's nothing to worry about."

"Rachel, he told me you give good head. What the fuck is that?"

She threw her hands up. "I don't know, Carl... What do you think—you think I gave him head?"

He screwed his face up. "Don't even say that."

"You're the one insinuating it..."

Now *his* hands tossed up. "*He's* the one insinuating it, Rachel. *I'm* just pointing out that *he* insinuated it."

"He's just trying to get under your skin."

"But why?"

"I don't know. Guy like that, who knows? Maybe he thinks it's funny."

"What's funny about saying that?"

"Guy like that comes here into this nice neighborhood, sees our big fancy house... he was nice all afternoon, I swear, he meets you and he gets weird. He doesn't like you for some reason, Mr. Big Shot Business Man with his fancy house and cars in his gated community... and the worst thing he can think of is to insinuate that your wife has done something with him."

"Did you?"

He watched her mouth drop, and regretted being forward, but it was an insurmountable thing Truth said, one he couldn't get around or over.

The muscles in her jaw jumped, and she tightened her crossed arms. "Did I what?"

Quieter: "Do something?..."

It dropped his stomach seeing the look of hurt on her face. "How could you even say that?"

He gave her a steady but warm and caring gaze, said, "I just wanted to hear you say it."

"How would you see that happening, Carl? What scenario is there where I end up like that..." she gestured with her hands like there was a

dead mouse at her feet or something else she wouldn't want to touch, "with someone like that?..."

"He brought your wallet back, and he's a pretty masculine guy, not unattractive, you go out for lunch and then the next thing—"

"You've got to be kidding me."

All he could think of was the guy's sex appeal, his big bulge, being young and aggressive, owning a motorcycle... But it was crazy. He showed his palms in surrender, shrugged an apology. "I know. I'm sorry..."

PART III

Jayda

WEDNESDAY, MAY 15

Chapter 20

RACHEL SLEPT face down in their marital bed, her hair tossed around the pillows printed with vibrant palm fronds, arms folded, lips pouted. He'd been awake since five in the morning, mostly staring at the ceiling and trying not to think about a man named Truth. But it was useless.

Now he was showered, dressed in his suit and tie; the sun was up, coming in the tall windows and dropping a glowing rectangle of morning summer light across his beautiful, younger wife.

One day eleven years ago, this sultry-faced brunette chick came in with her older sister looking to buy her first car. She was twenty; he was twenty-five, the sales manager of the Ford dealership back then, his dad still alive and running the show. Cindy, his top salesperson, was back at the original Ford then just starting out, brings the offer into his office and he looks out to see these two hot girls sitting at her desk. "Send 'em in," he told Cindy, and the two are at *his* desk then, and he's showing them the charm, letting them know he was the big shot, acting back then like he already was the owner, his dad with one foot out the door. These girls are giving him the charm back, flirting, and he realizes it's an act; they're out-salesmanning him. Fucking Rachel with her vivacious young body, the hottest girl he'd ever met, flicking her hair and giving him these eyes that he swore were telling him if he knocked the price down she'd get under the desk and suck him dry. He did it, too. Knocked the price down, gave Rachel and her sister Jackie pretty close to the deal they wanted. And of course, there was no blow job. But he got her number. A month later they had dinner. Two months later he was fucking her. That was that. A year later she had a baby

they were going to name Jessie rounding out that stomach, a ring on her finger, and she was picking out the big house she wanted when he finally stepped into Big Carl Webster Sr.'s shoes. She traded up; he had her in a Mustang convertible, the Shelby GT, light years better than the Fiesta she and her sister came in for that day.

She was perfect, but the girl—now a woman—came with problems. A wild streak. He'd never seen it firsthand, not for real, but her sister was always acting like she had to be kept on a short leash, alluding to hopes young Rachel wouldn't revert to her old ways. Jackie was a fan of steady-hand Carl Webster, but in the way like she got relief now, like Rachel was finally someone else's responsibility. The way it was with her sister was like she handed the keys to him, he drove Rachel off the lot, and Rachel's sister dusted her hands, turned her back. Buyer beware. And Rachel only had a one-year warranty.

It wasn't like she didn't love him. She did. That was no lie, and it wasn't salesmanship. It was something in her that he couldn't put a finger on. In a way, it was what first attracted him to her, sitting across from his desk. That allure, that sexual promise. The idea that she might suck your dick for money. What was so hot about that? What kind of guy would marry a girl so wanton? Party girls were meant for parties, not for weddings.

Taming her was exciting. And how do you tame a tiger? You keep it happy. *Cars, cash, purses, vacations, whatever you want, Rachel. Be home when I get home, you can flirt but you're mine. You want a job? Will that make you happy?...*

Then came the doubts.

Her sister hooked her up with a Tampa-Fort Myers developer, Hal Harbor, and Rachel went to work for him and his team. A roster of alpha males who liked to party. Every late night she spent out was cold dread in his stomach. Each morning he'd be in the laundry hamper looking for semen in her panties. She was drinking a lot, he knew that. Sometimes coming in at three in the morning, then up at seven and off to work again. And she was twenty-seven, smoking hot, dressing in tight and revealing clothes he paid for, putting her goods in all those guys' faces. It had been an electric time, one of twisting torture, yet somehow it was a moment in his memory that shone brighter than others. There was some of that stress, that jealous anxiety, he missed.

Now it was back.

Chapter 21

THREE TRANSPORT TRUCKS were coming in today from Alabama loaded with thirty brand-new vehicles from the factory. One truck was going to the south end Toyota dealership, the other two were coming here, up north at the GMC-Chevy. So he was killing time, catching up on paperwork and generally twiddling his thumbs. Right now he was down in the garage bay, hanging out with the mechanics. There was a cute one that Lonnie hired, a Mexican girl with neck tattoos, about five-foot-one. There was something fun about talking to her, seeing her in her coveralls with all these men. She held her own, and Lonnie said she was probably the best new mechanic they had. And she was funny, and she was taking his mind off his wife.

She was saying, “So Reggie’s tellin’ me,” she looked around, smiled, then continued quieter: “that the computer board has the wrong mileage on it. He can’t figure out what’s up. Slappin’ the keyboard, huffin’ and puffin’. He’s walking back and forth from the car back to the board, he gets me a look at it. I say, ‘Whyn’t you look where it’s plugged in?’”

“What do you mean?”

“Was plugged into a different car.” She laughed hard, held her stomach. “Carlos’d plugged it in to this Canyon, but he set the laptop down on the Sierra. Then Reggie comes to take over. One little thing like that, Reggie can’t figure it out.”

“Maybe I should fire him.”

“Hey, don’t you do that, I have to work here, they don’t want me being no snitch. He’s a good mechanic, it was just funny...”

“I’m just joshing you. I’ve known him a long time, he might make you scratch your head every once in a while, but the guy knows what he’s doing.”

“Hey, you got that right, he know what he’s doing. He just funny. And old...” She set her empty coffee cup down, said now, “I gotta get back to work for the boss come ‘round.”

“I know, I heard he’s a real asshole,” he said and winked.

She swished away, just about as feminine as a person could be in an all-male place like this. He was pretty sure her name was Avril or something like that. He’d have to look it up.

Then, the second she was gone, his stomach started to get that funny feeling again. He could picture Rachel the way she was sleeping this morning. Looking so innocent. That’s the way it’d been before, back four years ago now. Everything looked good on the surface, but you sure didn’t want to scratch at it too much and get a peek under the paint. That’s where you found out it was rusted all to shit.

He hefted himself off the lounge chair he was leaning on, strolled out through the waiting area where the customers were watching the sports channel, went through sales up to the second floor to close himself in his office. He checked his watch; the trucks should be here soon. Jesus, if he could only keep himself busy with something good.

He decided to check emails, brought his computer to life, eased back in his leather office chair and looked at the screen. Three new emails, and he went through them in order. The first two were straightforward bank and accountant stuff and took a couple minutes, the third one was from an ominous scrambled email name, OmEgA47995, and when he opened it, he expected it to be spam. But what he read brought his office chair close. He rested his elbows on the desk and read it over three times.

Told you she give good head. I nut in her
mouth. Think I’m lying? Text me.

What followed was a string of numbers to text OmEgA’s phone.

That guy, Truth. He knew it was him.

He was chewing the inside of his lips, frowning and staring holes into his computer. *I nut in her mouth*. What was that? Does he mean he *came* in her mouth?

“God dammit,” he sighed, sat back in his chair, put his hands on his hips and dug his fingertips into his stomach muscles.

What the fuck? What the fucking fuck? What was all this about? He had to be wary, the guy’d been all through his house, knew all the stuff they had. This was some sort of scam. Some sort of way to get money out of him, and he just knew it.

Well fuck that, if you didn’t play along it ended there.

So he wheeled himself back from his desk, spun the chair around twice, stood up. He crossed over to the wide windows looking down over the lineups of brand-new vehicles out on the lot. Arms crossed, he squinted into the sunlight. Windshields sparkled at him, and he checked his watch again for the eightieth time. *When were those fucking trucks getting here?...*

But now all he could think about were those days four years ago when he had suspicions. Back before the accident, when he thought Rachel was keeping things from him. He was still chewing the inside of his cheek. *When were the fucking trucks getting here?...* But now he was going back to his desk, sitting down. The email still open, he read the text number off the screen, fished his phone out of his pocket and texted.

Carl: the fuck you talking about?

Set the tone. You don’t fuck with Carl Webster. He wasn’t a chump.

Chapter 22

HE WAITED, the whole time wishing he just stayed by the window and pushed it out of his mind. Because now it was like he was possessed by it. Staring at the phone, looking at his dumb blank screen, waiting for it to come back to life. *Email me back, you chicken shit motherfucker. What's the goddamn scam?*

Right when he was looking at, the screen came alive to a slow dim glow. A little green emblem showed him he'd received a text. He opened it.

OmEgA: The fuck I'm talking about? I told you I know your wife give good head and you act like I'm a asshole

He chuckled with venom and disgust, lips pursed mean and tight.

Carl: what's your game? What's the scam here?

Half a minute later, the guy responded.

OmEgA: Ain't no scam. I don't want your money. You keep it

There was nothing to go on here. What was he supposed to do, just argue with this guy all day? *No, you're lying....No, I'm telling the truth....you're a liar....I ain't...*

This was bullshit. He tossed his phone onto his desk where it clattered and wobbled, but before it came to rest, he saw the screen glow again. He snatched it back. Another text. He swiped it open. There were no words this time, instead just the black square of a video waiting to be watched, a white right-pointing triangle arrow ready to press and initiate play.

His hands were sweating, and he looked at that white arrow like it was a poisonous pill. *Just dump this guy. Just tell him to go fuck himself. You got a business to run.*

He rubbed at his nose, did a funny little sniff, then pressed the arrow.

The small square came to moving life, and he tapped it to go full screen, then turned his phone landscape. The video was shot from above, like a security camera at the top of a wall. The setting looked like the inside of a public bathroom. At first he thought it was black and white but now he could see the colors were just dim. Black walls, white toilet. Gray wall on the left side. Everything banged up, shabby-looking, graffiti everywhere.

Beyond the top of the stall door he could see the main bathroom door open. There was somebody coming in, could see the top of their head moving. A head of chestnut hair. A few seconds later the stall door opened. A woman came in, and he swore it was Rachel.

Now he was frowning. He brought the phone closer to his face and looked intently. She didn't do anything other than turn around and sit down. Was it Rachel? *Yeah, it looked like it.* She was wearing what she wore just the other night. Skirt and top, and that familiar handbag—it *looked* like one of hers. What the fuck?

Nothing happened, the woman was just sitting on the toilet, and he wondered what that was the fucking point of this whole thing. Then her head lifted, and it cocked to the side. She was looking at the wall. He could see now amidst all the scribbling on the gray wall there was a darker spot. Maybe like there was a hole cut in it. Was she looking at the hole?

He brought the phone a little closer, studying what she might be looking at. And then right before his eyes, something protruded through the hole. Long and thick; like a baton. It came out straight, then flopped down.

“Jesus Christ,” he said. A fucking penis. A huge ass black penis. It couldn't even be real. “Oh my God,” he said, sitting back down in his chair, every nerve alive in his body. His scalp tingled, his stomach was rolling over. *What the hell was this?*

The penis just hung there, and the woman who he swore was Rachel stared at it. *Oh my God, Rachel, what the hell?*

The woman scooted forward, like she wanted to get a better look at it, then the video went still. He cursed, shook his phone like somehow it would shake the video loose. At the bottom a readout showed there were 0.00 seconds remaining. *That was all there was?*

“My God,” he said, and set his phone down carefully. He kicked back his chair, but bent forward resting his forehead on the lip of his desk, hair touching the keyboard. His stomach ached, his heart was racing. Hands clutched between his legs, he gripped a growing, traitorous erection.

What happened? What did Rachel do? Did she suck his cock? I mean, that’s what the guy was saying... Did Truth put his penis through a hole in the wall and... what did his wife do?...

“Oh, come on,” he said now, sitting up. He looked at the still image still there, big black penis dangling, his wife looking at it, sitting forward like she was interested. “No way...”

He waited for Truth to text again, wanted to strangle his phone now. He jumped forward and snatched the office phone off its cradle, eyes still glued to his phone’s screen. He dialed the first five numbers of Rachel’s number and stopped. What was he going to do? Ask his wife what she did when the big cock came through the hole? *Yeah, why not?* She would deny it. *I didn’t do anything. I got out of there, Carl...* Would he believe her? *Of course.* She drove out there to see her mother. She stopped at a gas station. *Rachel wouldn’t suck a strange cock, would she?*

His phone dinged with an incoming text.

Grabbed quickly, he swiped it awake.

OmEgA: Want to see the rest?

Chapter 23

GOD DAMMIT, here he was thinking nobody could get him, and now this guy had him. Yeah, he *had* to know. He had to fucking know what happened next. A million things went through his mind, a million responses... *Of course I want to know, you fucking idiot....show me what she did...*

But here was the scam. Here's where Truth got him...

It was a video where Rachel did nothing. Here's the first half, let the husband pay to see the second half. How much was he going to have to pay to see his wife slap at that thing, scream bloody murder and run out of there? How many thousand dollars? How stupid was this guy? The amount would dictate. Half a million dollars, he would laugh his ass off. But he probably did have a number. What was his number? Before he texted, he settled on \$5,000. He would pay this asshole \$5,000 to know what his wife did.

Now, though he felt confident, his stomach still did that funny thing, his cock was hard as a brick, and his breath came a little funny. A little too quick for his liking. He loosened his tie. *All right, you huckster, yeah, I want another video.* He texted.

Carl: I want to see the next video

Right away the way the guy got back.

OmEgA: you sure you want to see it?

Carl: I'm sure I want to see it

OmEgA: how sure?

He growled in his throat. Here comes the scam.

Carl: how long we going to play this game for?

OmEgA: You decide

Carl: Just tell me what it's gonna cost me. I'm not a fucking dummy

OmEgA: I know you're smart

There was a long dreadful pause that raced his heart as he watched his phone and squeezed it hard in his grip. At last, he got back.

OmEgA: OK no more fucking around. Look out your window down on the sales floor

Now he was frantic. Hadn't expected this. He scooted his chair back, went to the L-shaped corner where one side looked out on the lined up cars on the dealership lot, the other side looked down on the air-conditioned sales floor. He pulled the cord to angle the blinds open. Down on their marble tile sales floor there were a dozen 2019 vehicles. Salespeople moved in and out, snagging customers as they came in. He studied faces looking for someone he knew. Maybe a black guy in motorcycle leathers. Nothing stood out. Below him, Cindy was sitting with a young woman who had a baby on her lap.

He texted.

Carl: all right, I'm looking

OmEgA: See a woman there pretty ass Vietnamese girl?

He looked around again. The woman with the baby was Asian. She was pretty, all done up with tight jeans on her big booty, wearing a slender tank top that showed off her baseball sized breasts. She had oversized hoop earrings, shining hair pulled back like a Latina.

Carl: I see somebody like that

OmEgA: You prove your loyalty to me

He chuckled.

Carl: I'm not loyal to you

OmEgA: Then we thru

He texted right back.

Carl: prove it how?

OmEgA: baby mama down there need new wheels. She want a truck like your wife

Carl: The Yukon

OmEgA: with the RST package

Carl: she better have 70 grand

OmEgA: that's where we going to meet in the middle

Carl: what's that mean?

OmEgA: Told you it wasn't a scam. U and me in business together, I ain't asking for free. You give her wholesale

Fuck that. *Wholesale?* No way. He texted back.

Carl: I could tell you wholesale's anything

OmEgA: I find out you lying our business relationship is over

Carl: we don't have a business relationship

OmEgA: have a good day

"Fucking asshole," he said. He wasn't getting involved with drug dealers or fucking hitmen or whatever this guy was. He could stuff it.

He made his way back to the desk, trying to push all this nonsense out of his mind. *What the fuck did you get yourself into, Rachel?*

Tossed in his chair, he spun himself around in circles with his heels, fingers tented together under his chin in a Machiavellian pose. "God dammit," he sighed, and clutched his erection right through his pants. *The fuck was this about?* Try as he might, he couldn't push that video out of his head. What did she do, what did she do, what did she do? Did she suck it? That was the hook, wasn't it? Truth put it in his head that she sucked it, sends him a video where he of course believes the next part is her sucking it, and now the guy wants wholesale on a truck.

"Fuck you," he said aloud to the room.

But then, what was wholesale? It wouldn't be a dollar out of his pocket. Five minutes ago he was thinking he would pay \$5,000 to see the rest of the video, this guy was offering it for free. He would lose the potential income on that RST, but what was that? Chair kicked back, he hustled to his door, then he was quick-stepping down the stairs to the sales floor. The Asian girl was leaving, making her way between two pickup trucks, almost at the door. She had a wide, high and round butt and a narrow waist, sexy little shoulders curved out with muscle. Her little baby peeped over her shoulder at him. Kid had Asian eyes and an Afro.

"Hey, ma'am, hold up there," he said.

She paused, turning and looking at him with drowsy eyes. “Yeah?” she said, her eyes flicking on him like he was nothing.

He put his hands in his pockets trying to hide the tent in the front. He said, “You were interested in the Yukon?”

“So?”

“You couldn’t make a deal?”

She made a sucking sound with her teeth. Her lips were so glossy they looked oiled. On her neck was a tattoo of four pit-bull faces like a doggy Mt. Rushmore. “You askin’ too much.”

“Why don’t you come on back with me to the sales desk. You were talking to Cindy, weren’t you?” He was putting on the old sales charm.

She wasn’t buying it. “Bitch say it cost me seventy grand.”

“But we can work something out,” he said, all smiles. “Come on, come on back to the table. Don’t you know how we negotiate?” He said it light, even laughing, but the girl didn’t smile and he worried he’d offended her. And he was stupid—he was the one who was getting bent over here, Truth had the upper hand on this deal.

Of course, *he* was getting what he was looking for, too. And that’s what would keep him sane here.

He got ahead of the woman who was following him reluctantly. He stood beside Cindy as the woman with the baby took her time coming back to the table. He got down low to Cindy, said, “Do me a favor, okay? This one’s on me. You get your commission on full price, but I want you to give this woman a deal.”

Cindy said, “She’s got a foul mouth on her, Carl.”

“She’s a friend of a friend, all right? Would you give me that?”

“Fine,” she said. “How much?”

“Give her wholesale.”

“Wholesale, Carl? Jesus Christ, is this your mistress?” He frowned at her, and she jerked her head back. She said, “I’m kidding.”

“Just do it for me, okay? I’ll cover your commission, don’t you worry.”

The woman was there now, standing with a surly expression, baby cocked on her hip. He said, “Ma’am,” and extended his hand, “I’m Carl Webster of Webster Motors, you were talking to Cindy, and I think the two of you are going to find yourselves happy today. I don’t want people walking out of my dealership without smiles on their faces and keys in their hands...”

Chapter 24

BACK IN HIS OFFICE, he peered down to the sales floor, one of the blinds tweaked down with a thumb, watching Truth's baby mama dealing with Cindy.

"Come on, you cock head, what are you waiting for? You waiting till she takes delivery? Where's my goddamn video?... Jesus," he said, letting the blind snap back, crossed to his desk and falling into his chair.

He wasn't out anything. So what if the guy didn't send the video, it wasn't the end of the world. Rachel didn't do anything, anyway. He owed Cindy some commission, but he could handle that. It was less than five grand, so basically this was a steal.

Unless Truth didn't send the video.

"Come on, you piece of shit," he said, spitting each word with precise pronouncement, and strangling his phone as if it was the guy's neck. *Just send the goddamn—*

A text arrived.

"Okay, okay," he said, hunkering down in his chair, preparing himself. He opened it, it was from Truth. Just another black square with a white arrow. The rest of the video...

A double-rap on his metal door frame, and a loud, deep voice had him jerking upright in his chair. Fucking Mel standing in the doorway—he should have closed his fucking door—saying, "Knock, knock, fucker."

His skin was pulsing with electric tingles and his heart raced. "Jesus Christ, Mel, what's wrong with you?"

“Touchy touchy,” Mel said, his general manager’s eyes going sly now. “What are you doing, watching porn in the middle of the day?”

“No, you asshole, I was lost in thought.”

“Well chop-chop, the Vettes are here! The Vettes are here!” He raised his fist in medieval pronouncement.

“The Vettes? How about my trucks?”

“Yeah, they’re not at Toyota yet, but we got the two GM pulling in the lot right now, right out front. Come on, buddy,” he said and clapped his hands, rubbed them together like he was trying to start a fire. *The new model Vettes had arrived. Great fucking timing.*

“Yeah, okay. I gotta deal with something. Be down in a minute.”

“When you hear burning rubber, Carl,” he said, “that’s me.” He smiled, winked, rapped on the doorframe again and left.

Carl jumped out of his chair, rushed across the room, closed his office door quietly. He locked it. The front of his pants were humped out with an unexplainable rock-hard erection. *What the fuck was that about?*

He moved to the windows that led out to the yard, two double-decker tractor trailers pulled in and heading to the back discharge area by the garages, both loaded with new vehicles. All blinds closed, he darkened his office.

Just a couple minutes, guys, just gotta watch what my wife does when she sees a big black cock come through a hole in the wall.

He had himself chuckling as he sat down, but his mouth was dry, his upper lip was sweaty. Phone open again, he looked at the black square with the white triangle. “Let’s do this,” he said, and tapped it.

Same thing again, making it full screen, turning it to landscape... Now he could see the girl who was most likely Rachel sitting forward on the toilet seat, the hugest dick in the world struck through a hole in the wall. This would be where she got out of there. His wife, if she were to find herself in the bathroom faced with a penis coming through the wall, would not suck it. No way, Truth, or OmEgA, whatever your fucking name is. Good, very good, you got your truck at wholesale...

“All right, Rachel, show me how good you are.”

He watched in horror as she reached a hand to it, seemed to drag her fingertips down its length and cup the crown with the points of her fingers. “Oh no,” he gasped and grabbed his cock through his pants. “Rachel...”

Yeah, she was caressing it. She liked it.

“Okay, she’s curious. Probably doesn’t think it’s real. Look at that thing...”

Now she was gripping it, holding it, it looked like she was stroking it. “Oh shit,” he said, and a stitch tightened in his side. He winced, held his breath, squinted his eyes and watched the screen through narrowed vision. “Don’t, Rachel, don’t...”

But she did. Putting her hands all over it. Studying it, liking it, testing its weight, and god dammit, now she was standing up... his fucking wife was sticking that thing up underneath her shirt and squashing her tummy against it. He watched her lean legs flex as she humped her stomach against the thing. God, now she was lifting her leg, oh no, she was going to put it inside her...

He watched his wife hump herself, a leg up, the heel of her shoe on the toilet seat. He couldn’t see that cock but it was between her legs right now. His was *throbbing* between his own legs. It was her. It was really her. The hair, the purse. But now the shoes. Those were her shoes. He couldn’t see her face, but it was her. *Unless it wasn’t*. “It’s not you, Rachel,” he whispered, “It’s not, it can’t be...”

Oh God, now she was on her knees. That head of glossy brown hair began to bob. She’d put the thing in her mouth. The guy was right. The guy was right, Rachel sucked him. He *nutt*ed in her mouth, that means he came in her mouth. “Oh God,” he moaned. *No, it can’t be...*

Her head bobbed for a long time, that hair swinging back and forth, and he was stroking himself over his pants.

“Oh Jesus,” he said, unable to handle this. He unzipped himself, brought out his steely hard dick. There was semen everywhere, silvery strands all over the inside of his underwear and pants, and soon as he touched himself it was rolling over his knuckles. He stroked himself hard and fast, his mind rolling like a careless tumbleweed into a forest fire.

The touch of his hand on himself obliterated him. His eyes were fluttering, pleasure somehow took hold of him despite the horror playing out on the screen. Watched now as Rachel fell back. He could see brief little flickers of pixelated white he was sure was the guy’s semen. He’d come on her chest. In her mouth, too probably. *I nutted in her mouth*. That was why she fell back.

“Fuck,” he shouted, feeling his stomach turn to iron. There was an intense worm drive of pleasure tickling from the tip of his dick all the way

up and reaching like octopus tentacles to squeeze at his brain. “Oh God, oh God, oh God,” he chanted, watching now as that huge dick swung back and forth stiffly, still dropping twinkles of light that must be spurting semen, and his wife *scrambled*, got on her hands and knees on a dirty bathroom floor and *scrambled* out of there.

He ejaculated.

An explosion under the lip of his desk that got him jumping in his office chair, bucking and grunting, making choking sounds. Pure pleasure launched from him. Dirty, awful pleasure. The most awful feelings inspired inside him, but somehow wound up in the softest fabric, cuddled in luxurious mink. He groaned as he twisted in his chair, semen still pulsing from him, imagining how on earth his wife found herself like that, imagining how on earth she could do that.

“Oh fuck, Rachel,” he panted, he was still coming.

The intercom on his desk: “The Vettes are here! The Vettes are here!”

“Ha, ah, fuck,” he grunted, squeezed himself. He was going to need a whole roll of paper towel. He leaned down and looked under his desk at the slick, dribbling stalactites he left. He kicked himself back and looked at his pants. He’d launched so far he didn’t have a drop on him. “Wow,” he said, impressed, and opened a drawer to find something to clean himself with. There was a bottle of Early Times, and he brought it out too. He couldn’t clean himself with that, but maybe he could wipe his mind a little.

Chapter 25

LIGHTS STILL OFF, he picked up the office phone again, this time dialing all the numbers that would get him his wife. She picked up on the third ring, sounding happy.

“Hey, Carl...”

“Hi, baby,” he said.

“What’s up?”

“Where are you right now?”

“Where am I? I’m at work.”

“At the hospital?”

“Do I have another job?”

A grim thought. Who knew? Maybe she did. Did he ever see her at the hospital? Maybe she shook her tush at the Booty Corral, his sweet young wife with a cowboy hat on, giving lap dances and jerking off redneck shit-kickers in the private rooms. Maybe if they gave her enough, she might even blow them. A dozen big cowboy cocks in her mouth four days a week for a hundred bucks a time. And now his erection was back. Wildcat Rachel peeking out from the tamed kitty cat eyes, his little house-cat he kept pampered in his home. What was so arousing about that? Why did that make him hard? And why-oh-why was he transported to those tortuous months before her accident? He’d sat at this very desk with the business card of a West Palm private detective, trying to find the power to call. He’d thought about what the dick would find. Could picture a manila envelope with a dozen surveillance photos, glossy, black and white, taken through the blinds of Hal Harbor’s Tampa mansion. His wife, his fucking baby Rachel

framed between the spiked fronds of palm shrubs, Hal's meaty hands unclasping her bra....Rachel on her knees between Hal's open legs, pulling free from his zipper a monster much like what protruded through that gas station glory hole, only Hal's much paler....Rachel sucking him off, Hal's sausage fingers woven through her tangled hair....Rachel on all fours, taking his cock and loving it....close up of Rachel's ecstatic expression: it's lust, it's passion, it's surprise that sex could feel so good, because Lordy, Carl provided all else but between the sheets...?...Hal working her in every position till they both dripped sweat, he couldn't hear them 'cause it was just photos, yet he could *hear* them, the growling, the panting, the shrieks as Hal's big cock forced a too-large orgasm out of his wife. There were no sounds, there weren't even photos. He never even called the private eye because he'd jerked off at his desk just like today. Five days later tragedy struck, anyway. But he had his Rachel back.

"Do you have another job?"

There was a long pause, the swishing microphone sound as his wife got more comfortable wherever she was. Or moved somewhere private because she was at work and she didn't want anyone else hearing this strange conversation. "I don't know what you mean, Carl. Another job?" She was quieter now.

"I'm kidding," he said, manufacturing a lightness in his tone.

"I don't get the joke."

Now he had a sudden clear image. He was being had. Rachel was in on the scam. Rachel and Truth were going to fleece him. Or worse. One night he'd come home and someone would be waiting for him in his garage, some skinny gangbanger in a hoodie stepping out from behind his bass boat and putting eight shots in him right through his Tundra's window, his gun useless in the glove box. Right now she was in Truth's bed, the two of them naked, both of them tangled in sheets and the room smelled like Rachel's battered little pussy hanging stretched open and satisfied in a way she'd never felt. He stroked his cock a little.

"What's your other job, Rachel?... Being my baby."

"I am your baby," she laughed. Truth was probably laughing, too, both of them snickering at Rachel's dip-shit husband. "But that was the lamest joke ever."

"Ah, I'm distracted at work. The new Vettes just came in."

"Mel shitting his pants?"

“He’s probably halfway to the Keys in one by now.” Truth and Rachel would fake her kidnapping, that would be it. A million dollars to get her back, don’t call the Feds. Meanwhile the whole time he’s at the bank moving money around, trying to raise a mil in cash, his slut wife is bent over a custom Ducati, screaming Truth’s name as he rabbit fucks her with a cock the size of a baseball bat.

“Mel loves his sports cars,” she laughed.

How well do you know Mel, Rachel, you suck his cock, too?

“He does,” he agreed.

“So what you calling for?”

His iPhone lit up. A text from Truth.

OmEgA: u watch that shit? see what I’m saying?

“Making plans for this evening.” He just couldn’t be face to face with her tonight. Couldn’t look in her eyes and not reveal the awful hurt inside him. And there was more to Truth’s game, he knew there was.

Carl: I saw

Rachel said, “What do you want to do?”

“I’m going to be here late,” he said, eyes turned down and waiting for a response from Truth.

“Oh okay, so we won’t go swimming together?”

His phone lit up again.

OmEgA: lot more where that come from

His heart sank, his stomach pushing down with its sinking weight.

Carl: did you fuck her?

“Carl...?”

“No, sorry, it’s busy here. Can you pick up Jessie from the academy?”

“Sure. What about dinner?”

He watched his phone. "I'll eat here."

"Me and Jessie on our own?"

"Girls' night," he said.

A text from Truth.

OmEgA: not yet but I'm gonna

He exhaled, a tension forcing his brow down, a heavy weight slumping his shoulders.

"Don't forget I'm going to go see my mom."

Perfect. "You'll be home late?"

"Midnight, probably."

With your snatch yawned out from Truth's massive manhood. You going to have a double limp now? "Straight there, Rachel, I mean it."

"Trust me, Carl, I'm sticking to the main roads from now on. Last place you'll find me is up that way."

His phone glowed again.

OmEgA: gonna get her knees up in her ears, fuck her good

His heart pounded. "Drop Jessie at Meadow's after swimming. I'll pick her up there when I'm coming home."

"Maybe I'll bring Meadow along for a swim and some dinner."

"That's a good idea," he said.

OmEgA: bet you want to see that shit live and in person, don't you?

"Fuck you," he hissed and tossed his phone across his desk.

"Fuck me?"

"Not you, Rachel, got a million things going on here."

"You sound distracted."

"You don't even know."

"I'll miss you at swimming," she said.

"Friday, baby. Say hi to your mom."

"I will. I love you, Carl. I'll see you in the morning."

“I’ll see you in the morning. I love you, too, baby...”

Chapter 26

ALL AFTERNOON he ignored what had transpired. Tried to push it out of his mind.

But there was no way to forget. It twisted at him. Awful, conflicted feelings. Anger. Anger at his wife. Betrayed. Sympathetic somehow. His poor wife not being able to help herself, getting turned on by the sight of a sexy horse cock, going too far and getting herself in trouble. What must have happened was she lost her wallet in that bathroom during the mad scramble to get out of there after the thing unexpectedly maybe went off in her mouth. That's when the shame hit her. Boom, next day the guy shows up with her wallet and now he's in his poor wife's life. Maybe she was scared. Part of him figured it serves her right. Part of him wanted to protect her. But then, hey now, she went off on the guy's motorcycle yesterday, that's a fact. She knew that was the guy with the donkey dick and she went off with him. God, there was that awful betrayal again. And that hurt so bad. What was she up to?

Worst of all was a sliver imbedded in all that hurt. A thrilling little spike stuck in all that hurt that somehow enlivened it to erotic levels. Bad Rachel. Old Jackie passing off to him her devil of a sister. How bad was Rachel? Bad enough her mother had wiped her own mind to escape the trauma? And how bad could she get? That was a glimpse today on that phone screen. A gift from Truth. Sure, a video of your wife putting another man's penis in her mouth hardly seemed like a gift, but here it was and he couldn't deny it: Bad Rachel turned him on.

“Excuse me, guys,” he said to Mel and Cindy, standing out under the fluttering pennants at the front of the lot while the mechanics went over a Sebring orange Corvette where everyone driving by could take a look and get excited. “Gotta make a call...”

Then he was trotting across the lot back to the sales floor, trying not to sprint, then dashing up the stairs and closing himself into his office. His phone still lay where he’d chunked it, and he picked it up, swiped it alive. No new texts, but the last one still ticked across his screen.

OmEgA: bet you want to see that shit live and in person, don’t you?

His hands were too sweaty to work, and he took turns wiping each one on his pant leg. When he was ready, he took a steady breath, typed in return...

Carl: when?

PART IV

High Caliber

THURSDAY, MAY 16

Chapter 27

ON FRIDAYS she worked from home. Two days a week she worked at the hospital doing transcription and filing, sometimes three, lying low in a small workspace of five other women older than her, keeping her hands busy. Fridays she could do private transcription for a few of the doctors.

She was up early in the morning (Carl already out early without even a hello), waking Jessie out of bed, cooking her breakfast, and instead of getting her on the bus for the academy, Fridays she liked to drive Jessie. It was an extra fifteen minutes she got to spend with her daughter, time she could catch up with her on what her friends were up to, and the current gossip and little-girl-backstabbing that was going on. It was only going to get worse because she noticed Jessie was already beginning to mention boys.

In casual sweats with her hair back in a ponytail, she drove Jessie to the academy and dropped her off with a kiss on the cheek and a pat on the bottom as she jumped out of the truck. Then she stopped at Starbucks, got herself a Guatemalan with almond milk and stevia, came back home and, still in her sweats, sat at the kitchen table and did her work. She went for three hours straight, glancing up at the door a few times in case a well-hung stranger darkened it—relieved when he didn’t—and then she was done for the day. She sat at the kitchen table unwinding her hair from its tail, smoothing it back over and over, pushing away all the bad thoughts that were coming at her.

Last night she was a good girl. The thing with Gus’s was over. It had got real scary, real fast. The fact that Truth might show up at the door any

minute meant that things had got out of control. So it was easy last night to stick to the correct route, head out with a tank full of gas, and go and sit with her mom. The young-old girl was in good spirits last night, but there were a few times she suspected Mom's memory had faded and she was humoring this strange woman in her bedroom. Other times, though, she'd been with it.

Night time would have been a terrible time to go to Gus's. But during the day when it was light, perhaps she could pay one more final visit to put this thing to rest. Maybe she would give Truth some money, tell him, *Look, it was embarrassing that I did that thing, and that I lost my wallet, and it was nice of you to bring it to me. Here's a hundred and no hard feelings. What? Oh yeah, the blow job—no can do, partner; that was a one-time offer; and you ruined it when you tried intimidating my family.* And that was what Truth had done, too. Sent shock-waves through her life over some dumb bathroom encounter. That made her mad. And she should be mad. What happens at Gus's, stays at Gus's should be like a motto that was honored. A guy shouldn't say those things to your husband when you were kind enough to put his cock in your mouth. How was she going to function, thinking this guy would fuck with her and Carl, maybe show up and try to force her to honor the hummer she offered? How long was she going to have to sit in her own house worried about that guy out there and what his intentions might be?

She swore she would never go *there* again, but she realized now she had to. It might be easier to sit back and wait to see if Truth ever showed up again, but that would be crazy. Why live in fear like that? She would have to go there and confront him. Tell him to stay out of her life.

Next thing she knew she was upstairs in the shower, giving herself a good scrubbing, doing her hair, blow drying it. Putting on makeup, too, just to drive out into the middle of nowhere. Just to tell a man to stay the fuck out of her life.

Tahoe roaring on the 90, she headed in-land to the southwest, watching the urban become suburban, then grow quiet and rural, and then she cut through the sugar ranch, blacked out Tahoe making all the workers scramble because they thought she might be I.C.E.

As she got closer to Gus's, she began to lose her nerve. What was she going to do? Stop in there, demand that she talk to him? Him and all those guys, all of them on their bikes. She was just some dumb white housewife

from the suburbs who didn't amount to anything, who was she to tell him what to do? At least that's what he would think. But she had to tell him to respect her. Don't hurt her, and especially don't hurt her husband. But most of all, stay out of my life because I would kill for my daughter.

For fifteen minutes, she sat in the air-conditioned cabin of the truck, pulled over on a gravel shoulder, a swampy section on the right-hand side. Up ahead she could see the turn in for Gus's station. After fifteen more minutes, she gathered some nerve.

She put the truck in drive, let her foot off the brake and the engine pulled her inexorably toward the station...

Chapter 28

HE WATCHED the video again before lunch, monitor angled away from the door in case somebody would come in. That would be the worst thing you could imagine—someone coming in and seeing that awful display on the screen. But if it was so awful, why did *he* want to watch it again? What was it doing to his insides? Truth had sent him a video showing his beloved wife on her knees in a dirty bathroom in the middle of the Everglades using her mouth on him. Just the mere thought of that video, the thought of its existence, sent a spike of pleasure right through him. Right from his penis, all the way up into his heart, into his brain where it spread in electric tangles. Why would he *want* to see that? But it was undeniable. It was all he could think of since yesterday afternoon. That and the offer to come by the house at 2 P.M. today and see what would happen. Truth claimed he would have sex with Rachel in their own home today. What kind of game was that? Was it some kind of ploy? Was he out to rob him? Take his money? Kidnap her? Kidnap him? It made no sense. What kind of man would make a suggestion like that? *Come by the house and watch me fuck your wife.* Wouldn't he expect the husband to come home with a shotgun? Expect to have a hole put in his chest the size of a baseball?

If he went home, what if he found a ransom note? If he went home, what if he found her tied up, a house full of scary bikers just like Truth waiting for Carl to get there, knocking him over the head? One of them would take him out to the drive-through cash machine, make him withdraw all his money, meanwhile the rest of them would be back at the house taking their turns with Rachel. Shouldn't he call the police right now?...

Somehow, in Truth's tone, he didn't think it was anything like that. But what kind of man was he to come to accept it? To want to go back to his house and watch through the window to see what would happen. What kind of man was sitting at his desk at the office in his dealership and playing the video again? He was erect already, his cock hard and steely, tenting out the front of his suit. He shifted himself closer, putting his legs into the knee hole of the desk, hiding himself should anyone come in. He unzipped and withdrew his erection.

On the monitor, the video played, the horror magnified compared to the small screen on his phone. There was his wife entering a dirty bathroom stall in a dirty gas station, a shit-hole place somewhere between here and LaBelle in the middle of the Everglades. Why would she even go in there? It was a stupid question because he knew the answer. As he gently handled his cock, the answer presented itself: Rachel, sitting on the toilet seat, hands on her knees, and there coming through a hole in the wall, the hugest penis he'd ever seen. An absolute monster. Pushing through the hole then dangling down, swinging gently from side to side. An absolutely enormous black thing. She was waiting to see it come through the hole. His wife wasn't tinkling. She was waiting, sitting on the closed toilet seat like she knew it would come.

He stroked while he watched his wife move to it, take it up in her hands and study it. She pleasured it. She pleasured another man's penis. She ended up worshipping it. Sticking it up under her shirt, lifting her skirt and rubbing it against the inside of her thighs. His legs were shaking by the time Rachel put her mouth on it. He watched her head bob up and down, watched her pretty hair tumble around. He couldn't see the monstrous penis anymore, but he knew what was happening.

Then almost simultaneously, Truth—the likely owner of that huge penis—ejaculated in Rachel's mouth and he ejaculated as well, closing his hand around the end of his cock and bucking where he sat, squinting and jumping in his seat, and watching as his wife jumped up, hurried out of the stall with a mouthful of another man's load. He saw her fling her purse away, watched her put her head in the sink...

He shut the video off, opened a drawer and withdrew five tufts of tissue. He cleaned himself, heart racing, absolutely pounding. He wasn't going to call the cops; he wasn't going to do anything. Nothing crazy at least. But of

course, going home and watching another man try to have sex with your wife was crazy, wasn't it?

Chapter 29

YUKON PULLED up on the road-side of the gas pumps, she toggled the side window down. She watched the doorway, the ding-ding echo of the rubber strip still in her ears. The now-familiar attendant came out wiping his hands on a rag then tucking it into the sleeve of his beaten coveralls. Her ancient, toothless friend wasn't on the porch today, no one out there at all, but parked out front and gleaming in the sunshine were a dozen motorcycles. The owners would be inside.

The attendant made his way from under the covered porch into the sunshine, moving languidly, sauntering. He came near the window, and she said, "Fill it up, please." He said Yup, waved, then she watched in the side mirror as he opened her gas, plugged the hole with the filler nozzle.

Elbow on the doorsill, she watched the gas station, and at all those motorcycles, but could see nothing inside Gus's. Nothing past the cigarette ads and the beer signs, no movement. Of course, she wouldn't be able to see them if they were all sitting at the lunch counter. She should go in but she swore she never would again. The gas lever clunked, and he gave it a few more good pumps. Hung up the nozzle then, came around to the window.

"Ay, you only need five dollars."

"Sorry," she said.

"Nothing to me."

She opened her wallet, the tall black man standing next to her open window watching as she flipped through her billfold. She gave him ten dollars, said, "No change."

The attendant nodded but didn't say thanks. Before he turned to go, she said, "Is Truth in there?"

He stopped, came closer to the window again leaned his arms on the sill peering into the open space out front of her truck. He said, "Truth who?"

"I don't know his last name. I lost my wallet, and he brought it back to me. His name is Truth."

"What you want him for?"

"I want to talk to him."

His hands came to his mouth and moved his toothpick from one side to the other. "You gonna come in today?"

"I'm not coming in. Is he in there?... Truth, I mean..."

"Want me go look?"

"Would you?"

"What you want me tell him?"

In a low voice, she said, "Can you ask him to come out, please?"

She'd already tipped him five, now she pulled out another ten and put it near his hand. His long black fingers enveloped it, curled it into his palm.

"I see if he 'round."

"Thank you," she said, but he was already turning and heading back into the station. She started the Yukon now, a sudden fear working through her. Maybe she'd have to floor it to get out of here. Maybe do it before Truth even showed up. That's what she *should* do. Deep down she knew she had to tell him to knock it off. To stay out of her life. So she sat there with the truck idling, watching the general store. It was almost a full two minutes before the door opened again. Now she saw him. Truth. Stepping out onto the porch, squinting for a moment, smiling. In leathers again, new ones. Black and red seemed to be his style, but these were a different pattern. Same high-top sneakers, leather pants bunched around his ankles, padded at the knees and at the crotch. He wore a tight white T-shirt underneath the leather jacket. He came to the edge of the patio, leaned on the support at the top of the stairs. He was half in shade, half in light; from the waist down sun dappled on his motorcycle pants. She stared at him, waiting for him to approach.

Truth did nothing, putting a hand in the pocket of his pants, watching her. She watched him back, gave him no expression. After another long drawn-out moment, she motioned with her hand for him to come.

He smiled wider. He motioned with his hand for her to come *his* way. She rolled her eyes, gave him an exasperated slouch that she hoped read across the twenty feet that kept them separated.

He did nothing and then she did nothing. She motioned again, waving her hand toward her for him to come so she could speak to him. And he did the same thing again, motioning for her to come and join him in the station. She shook her head no, wanted to give him the finger, but instead did her window up. She put the truck in drive, took a foot off the brake and pulled toward the exit.

He smiled the whole way, though she only watched him from her periphery. She turned right to head back home, no cars coming she pulled out and brought the truck up to speed feeling better about leaving, but feeling terrible that nothing had been settled.

Chapter 30

SHE NEVER SAW HIM COMING. She was doing seventy, letting it all rush past her windows, stereo cranked with Christina Aguilera screaming in her ears. Then there was an insect drone, and a black rocket shot past her driver-side had to be going over a hundred. Black motorcycle, rider slung over the wasp shape. She knew it was Truth, could see the red flashing on his bike and the red flashing on his leathers.

He raced past, drone of the motorcycle heard for a moment over top of her blaring stereo then going quiet, the shape of him becoming a dot in the distance. Toying with her.

She could play that game, she thought, putting her Prada loafer down on the accelerator, watching the revs go up as the huge motor roared to life. Stereo turned louder, she watched the needle rise from seventy to eighty to ninety then to one-hundred.

Soon that motorcycle shape was getting larger in her windshield. Pedal squeezed down further, she came right up behind him, could see his helmet flicking left and right as he watched in his mirrors. She got close behind, matching his speed, both of them doing 130 miles an hour now on an open stretch of sunbaked highway. She got so close she couldn't even see the rear faring of his motorcycle. He began brake-checking her. Popping his lights on and off, and he got her at first, making her back off, but soon she was right back on his ass, hugging his rear wheel like a real psycho bitch. It made her feel so good.

She gripped the steering wheel tight and her heart pounded in her rib cage. She didn't care what happened. Didn't care about consequences at all.

She'd taken three oxys already today, and despite the pervasive tearing feel in her leg; she felt really, *really* good.

Up ahead on the right there was a rural road, and Truth geared down the bike, no lights coming on but his speed slowing. She took her foot off the accelerator, coasted behind him. With the foot off, the tension leaving her body, some normalcy began to flood her again and worry about what she was doing. She wiped at her face.

Truth's right indicator went on, and he took the turn fast, swooping ninety degrees with the motorcycle almost sideways, laying flat. She came in behind him, both of them slowing down without using their brakes, going a few miles before Truth pulled off to the side of the road on a wide shoulder that fell down an embankment to a swamp framed by trees.

Pulled in behind him, she locked all her doors with the windows up, watching what he would do. Then felt stupid, leaving the Yukon running instead, and kicking her door open. She jumped down onto the dirt road, stomped toward his motorcycle. He was taking his helmet off and turning to look over his shoulder when she shouted, "What the fuck is wrong with you?" and punched his arm. He didn't even flinch, looked at her like she was a curiosity. She stepped back, stood with her arms folded. She scowled.

He smirked. "Ay, what's your problem?"

"What's *my* problem? What's *your* fucking problem? Why did you say all that shit to my husband? We had a nice day, we had a nice time and then you pull that shit."

"You get a divorce?"

She stepped forward and punched him again, this time harder, but ended up tweaking her wrist, pulling her hand back and grimacing.

He said, "You best stop hitting me."

Now she wound her hand around on the end of her arm, wincing, then rubbed her knuckles. She said, "I don't want a divorce. Don't even say that. That's why I came here. To tell you to knock it off. What do you want? You want money? How much?"

He put the kickstand down on his bike with the toe of his sneaker, hoisted himself off lightly, staring at her. He folded his arms as if he was mimicking the way she stood. He said, "I ain't want your money."

"How much?"

"Ay, I want your money, I'd a sold all your credit cards, had you cleaned out. I'd a had four dudes in your house last night, you and your husband

hogtied, we have your bank codes, we clean you out. Probably put two in your heads, do you like that.”

She stared at him incredulous. Fight or flight; flight flickering at her telling her to run back to the Yukon and close herself in.

He smiled now, reading the horror on her face. He said, “What’s wrong with you? I ain’t gonna do that, I’m just playing. Wouldn’t waste my time for that.”

“Why would you even say it?”

“Just to get that look on your face.”

“That’s cruel.”

“I wouldn’t hurt you,” he said. “Couldn’t hurt you at all.” And then, amused by a thought, added: “Though it might hurt at first.”

“Hurt at first what?... Oh,” she said, realizing. *His size*. “Well, you can forget that now.”

“I ain’t gonna forget it. Neither are you.”

“It’s your fault. You ruined it.”

“I ain’t ruined nothing. In fact, I’m making it okay.”

“No, you’re not. You fucked it up like I said. I would have done something with you yesterday. Now it’ll never happen.”

“Never’s a long time, Rachel,” he said, unzipping his jacket, leaning back to sit on his motorcycle. She watched the thing between his legs make a bulge against the leather. He said, “What changed?”

She said, “What do you think changed? You practically told my husband. Now he knows...”

“You think he knows?”

“He’s suspicious. But he *knows*. I think deep down he *knows*.”

“He don’t trust you?”

“He loves me,” she said, which wasn’t the real answer.

That made him smile, and he said, “Ay, that’s right. He loves you. What he do when I said what I said?”

“What do you mean?”

“How he react?”

“He told you to leave.”

“*You* told me to leave.”

“*He* told you to leave, too.”

“Just backing you up...”

“Right,” she said, leering, “right, I see where this is going. Like he wants to watch me do that.”

“Do what?”

“Suck your dick,” she laughed.

He nodded, smiling and studying her. The bright sun put luster on his black skin. “You a bad girl, ain’t you?”

“No,” she said.

“Yeah, you are.”

“No, I’m not,” she said, showing him her severe face.

“Ay, I *know* you are. You know I know. Don’t lie to yourself. Show yourself some respect.”

“I respect myself.”

“You think you do, but you only gonna respect yourself when you true.”

“I *am* truthful.”

“That’s it, keep lying.”

“Such an asshole,” she muttered.

“That the best you can muster?”

She stabbed the air with her hands, saying, “What? What do you want me to do?”

“Tell me how you really feel.”

The smug look on his face was making her furious. “I *told* you. I want you to leave me and my husband alone.”

“Hey, you say you want me leave you alone, you here in my face, try run me down, try run me over. You’re the one’s dangerous, not me.”

“It’s your fault,” she murmured, tightening her crossed arms.

“What, I bring it out in you?”

She looked away, following a pelican moving across the sky up over the tree line. She couldn’t help smiling. “Yes,” she said.

He said, “Come here.”

“No way,” she said, “I gotta go.”

“I ain’t keepin’ you. Go if you want. But I know you want to come over here, so just do it.”

Now she looked back at the grill of the Yukon, sunlight sparkling off the paint. Arms still folded, she sighed, took two steps forward until they were standing in front of one another. She looked away for a long while, but soon her eyes moved to his stomach, winding their way up then to meet his gaze.

He said, “Come a little closer.”

She shuffled her feet until they were between his sneakers. She said, "What?..."

He put his hand out, she stared at it. Looked at the size of his big pale palm, the cuff of his pristine leather jacket where it ended just above his tattooed wrist. She put her hand out, and he closed his hand over it, tugged, and she fell against him. Her hands were inside his open jacket, feeling his hard body underneath the cotton T-shirt. He was warm, alive, and she dug her nails into him. He kissed under her ear, and she moaned, writhed her body against his.

Now she was feeling his body, moving her jaw so he could kiss it, letting his lips find hers. She locked her mouth with his, kissed him, felt the damp coolness of his plump lips, felt the slither of his tongue against hers. Her hands moved on his muscle, slipping under the leather, feeling his chest and shoulders, coming down his sides, feeling how slim and tight his body was. Her wrist bumped something hard. It was in his belt, around his rump. She ran her hand over its shape, could feel the butt of a pistol.

She broke the kiss, stepped back. Her purse was in the Yukon. Her pistol was in the Yukon.

She said, "You got a gun?"

He stared at her. "You afraid of guns?"

Chapter 31

SHE SAID, “No, I’m really comfortable with guns,” and gave him a steely eye.

He sniffed, opened the flap of his leather jacket like a gunfighter, slipped out a nickel-plated pistol from his waistband and pointed it at her feet.

She stepped back. “Don’t,” she said.

He cocked his head, flipped the gun around by the trigger guard, presented the grip in her direction.

She said, “What do you want me to do?”

“Take it.”

“Take your gun?”

“Say you’re comfortable with guns.”

“I am.”

“Show me how you shoot, girl.”

She looked at the gun, to his eyes, to the gun and back to his eyes again. She said, “I told you I’m comfortable with guns.”

“Show me,” he said and wagged it at her.

She stepped forward, slipped her hand around the grip of his gun, said, “It’s big.”

“You got small hands.”

“I do,” she said, holding the grip, finger over the guard, her other hand cradling the barrel. She said, “1945?”

“Colt,” he said. “Yeah. Delta Elite.”

“Never fired one.”

“Go on then, show me,” he said, looking over her shoulder into the swamp.

She breathed heavy, staring at him, let her arms hang down at her side, the pistol touching her knee. She said, “What do you want me to shoot at?”

He eased off the bike now, turned to regard the swamp. There was a willow tree that stood out amongst the cypress, trunk paler, framed by two low cedars. Pointing, he said, “You hit that trunk?”

“Yeah, I can hit that trunk.”

“Show me.

“I’ll show you,” she said, stepping past him to the edge of the shoulder where the embankment fell down to the water. She raised the big pistol up, spread her legs in a shooter stance, braced the grip in hand and leveled the sight. She exhaled, held, pulled the trigger. The gun bucked hard. She was prepared for it, both hands coming up above her head. She stepped back, and couldn’t help laughing. “Holy shit,” she exclaimed.

“Got some kick do she?”

“Holy shit,” she said again, heart pounding, “that does have some kick.” Now she panted, stepping forward again peering at the tree. She said, “Did I get it?”

“Girl, you got it,” he said. “Do it again.”

“Wow,” she laughed, switching the gun to her other hand and shaking her arm out. “I never shot a .45.”

“It’s 10mm, got more kick.”

“That’s awesome,” she said, put the gun back in her shooting hand. She was smiling now, on the verge of laughing. She eyed the tree trunk again, saying, “If I had my .22 I swear I could put five in it all at once.”

“Go on do it again.”

“Yeah, yeah,” she said, licking her lips, getting into a shooter stance. She fired off one, prepared for the kick, controlling it, bringing the gun down again and pulling the trigger, blasting away. It wasn’t rapid fire, but she shot off four rounds, each of them kicking up dust on the willow tree about twenty yards down the slope.

When she was done now, she was really laughing. “Oh my God,” she said. “What a fucking *rush*.” She looked over her shoulder to see Truth’s reaction. He was smiling, hands on his hips.

He said, “Girl, you hot as shit. I never seen nothing hotter.”

She winked, poked a hip out with her hand on her waist, held the pistol up like she was Annie Oakley and blew away imaginary smoke from the barrel. "Hot as shit, huh?"

He stepped to her, took the gun out of her hand with both of his, skin warm against hers. He checked the gun, then looked her over again as he slipped it back into his waistband. He said, "You one crazy white woman."

"You're right," she said, "I am."

He sneered, proud of himself how he showed her he was right.

"I am," she said now, staring at him. "And you're a thug that sticks his giant dick through holes in bathroom walls."

He smirked, let his eyes wander up and down her. He said, "First time I did that."

"You don't do that for *all* the girls?"

"Ay, not many girls brave enough come in there. Place used to be hoppin', and back in the day things maybe were a little different. My pop said was a dance joint when he was a young'un. Gus's ain't what it used to be..."

"So you did it just for me?"

"I saw you come in, knew what you was looking for."

"Aha," she said dryly, imitating him now with her eyes going up and down his body. "So it was love at first sight."

"You tell me. You the one that's in love."

"I'm not in love."

"Sure you ain't," he said, and stared at her.

"Well, whatever," she said, trying to get the upper hand again. "I'm going home now. Hear me? Going back to my house, and you better not follow me if you know what's good for you."

"Uh-huh," he hummed.

"Uh-huh," she said, doing the eye thing again, going from his fancy high-top sneakers, up his leather pants, over his bulge, to his face and back down again. "*If* you know what's good for you," she said, turned on her heel, hands in the pockets of her skirt, walking as casually as she could with the hitch in her gait, her one hip rotating higher on the left-hand side as she sauntered back to the Yukon wishing she didn't have a limp at all.

Door propped open, she chanced another look. He was still standing where she left him with his hands in the pockets of his leather pants, staring back at her. She said nothing, climbed into the driver seat and closed the

door behind her. Then she was pulling a U-turn, going around a hundred-and-eighty degrees on that quiet rural road and heading back to the highway with her eyes on the rearview mirror.

PART V

Windows

Chapter 32

HE WAS in a brand-new Sierra pickup, dealer plates hung from the tailgate latch by straps, the yellow plate in its acetate sleeve. The motor was on and the air-conditioning was running. He was about twenty-five yards past his driveway, pulled over on the right-hand side and watching in the mirrors. He'd chosen the new Sierra because this one came with blacked-out windows, and he didn't want the neighbors wondering why Carl was parked out front of their house watching his own driveway.

Was any of this real? How sure was he that woman in the video was even Rachel? I mean, it was very convincing. It looked like her, the same clothes, but he never saw her face that well. Could this be some elaborate ruse? Some blackmail scheme? Could Truth have had a woman dress up like his wife? But then there was the hitch in the woman's crawl as she scrambled from the stall to the sink. Someone Truth hired wouldn't know to do that. It was Rachel. It just was.

His hands were sweating, and he rubbed them on the knees of his suit pants. This was impossible. And what was more impossible was despite the rage and the hurt, he didn't confront her. Not only did he not confront her, now he was parked out front of his house waiting for her to show up with Truth, and he was ninety-five percent sure that he was going to go to the windows and watch what happened. What *would* happen? The worst thing imaginable. The thing he would've thought he'd never want to see. Yet he *wanted* to see it. It was crazy.

He'd been sitting here now for twenty-five minutes. It was 1:45. 2 P.M. was like the gunslinger's high noon. He was still here when he should be

getting out of Dodge.

He licked his lips, seeing a wink of sunlight as a car came down from the opposite end of the crescent. And yes, it was the Tahoe. It was Rachel. He was sure of it. Now he could see the truck approaching, sunlight glaring off the window for a moment then going blank and he could see inside—he'd swear there was only one person in there—then the glare was back again and he had to squint.

The Tahoe slowed, indicated, turned into their driveway and pulled up to the garage door. He watched movement in the cabin, wondered where Truth was. Hiding in the back seat? Why would he hide?

Then he could see on the far side the driver door opening, sunlight splashing on his wife's chestnut hair as she turned, and it swayed as she slammed the door closed. She stood on the far side of the Tahoe like she was looking for something and then he realized... She was waiting for Truth. She was standing there on the other side of the Tahoe looking down the street from where she came. This was real. She was waiting for him...

But a few minutes went by before she was wandering out to the front of the vehicle, pausing, turning and looking back. Still no sign of her lover, and he could see her expression with its furrowed brow. She was walking again, purse slung over one shoulder limping along to the walkway up to the front of the house. She paused once more, leaned backward to take one last look down the street to see if he was coming. No sign of him still, now she walked to the front door with the keys in her hand and let herself in.

How'd it been arranged? How was it arranged between them that she would be expecting him? What had Truth been sending *her*? Did he tell her about the video? Was that part of the game? He didn't think so...

So now he sat with the air blasting on his face, feeling the chill of its breeze across his sweat-damp skin. It wasn't hot, but the stress and the anticipation were killing him. His heart was racing and his breath came more rapid. He squeezed his knees and rubbed his thighs, eyes in the mirror down the end of the road.

Chapter 33

BY THE WINDOW in the dining room, she stood looking out because of its view far down their street. She had one knee on the bench that sat in the bay window, figuring she was pretty well-hidden from the outside by the sheer curtains. She watched neighbors move in and out of their houses, a landscaper with a lawnmower across the street going up and down in even tracks. A car came down from the end of Harlow, but it turned into a driveway four down from her. Mrs. Glickman. Probably out for her shopping.

Did he get the message? Or did she even send a message?...

The message she sent was for him to stay away. That was the message she wanted to deliver. She had no idea why she was expecting him to follow. Why she felt a certain disappointment that he hadn't. He was doing what she told him. Doing what she wanted.

She sighed now, ran her hands through her hair a few times, squinted her eyes and shook her head. Good. Stay away.

She slunk away from the window, went to the hall, pried off her loafers with her toes and walked upstairs barefoot. She should have a shower. When Carl got home, he would probably smell cordite on her clothing. She needed to get changed, get showered, get ready for Jessie coming home from school. She stood in the walk-in closet by the standing up mirror, shaking her hands out now, looking at her reflection and laughing.

"You are one crazy white woman," she said, and it sounded strange in the enclosed space. But it was true. She was always crazy.

Now she took off her things, got completely naked, turning in the dim light of the closet and admiring the changes in her body. Seeing the fit curve of her rump, going right around to see how tight and taut her ass was. She hefted her own breasts, liked the feel. Sure, four years ago she had some nice D cups, but this whole package was a much better vehicle to be riding around in. The airbags in this one still did the trick, and she had a lot more horsepower now.

She opened the drawer, looking to get the things to change into after she showered, then bundled up her gun smoke clothes, threw them in a hamper ready to take down to laundry.

But now instead of pulling out cotton panties, she was pulling out lacy ones. Silk things Carl bought for their anniversary about two years ago, or maybe it was Valentine's. Sexy, delicate, expensive. She held them up and admired them, pulled out the matching bra. She lay the things flat on the dresser top, ran her hands over them.

Then she was slipping into them, putting her legs through the holes, doing the bra up at the front and spinning it around and putting her arms through the straps, lifting her girls and settling them into the cups. Now she was admiring herself again in the mirror, wondering what the hell she was doing. She went into the bathroom, looked at the shower stall but knew she wouldn't run the water just yet. Instead she was opening her feminine drawer, the one that was just for her but that wasn't makeup or hair products. Canesten, her pills, her vibrator, and some assorted tubes and bottles of lubricant. She took the big one, the one with the pump top. Water-based, cherry-scented; it was her favorite.

She went into the bedroom, stood by the side of the bed, looking out at the street below. She set the vibrator down on the nightstand, the pump bottle too, gave it a half-push and squirted out a dollop of clear gel onto two fingertips. The front of her panties pushed out with one thumb, she ran those two fingers up and down, feeling herself. Feeling how wet she already was. She ran over the shapes of her petals, teased her opening, slipped her middle finger inside up just until the first knuckle then ran back and did circuits around her clitoral hood. Her stomach did that drop away thing, and her knees dipped a little.

She went to the window, stood there again in just her lingerie watching down the street and wondering why Truth didn't follow her.

Chapter 34

WITH HIS EYES on his rearview, watching his own driveway and the far end of the crescent he didn't even notice the motorcycle come up from the front. Couldn't hear its motor over the sound of his pumping air conditioner until it was right in front of him. Then he was scrambling, jumping in his seat and rubbing the back of his twisted neck.

In idle, the man on the motorcycle walked the bike up to the window and tapped on the glass. Carl toggled it down. He looked at the helmet, but saw only his own reflection in its mirror-like visor. Then the guy lifted it, and he saw that frightening but handsome face, saw the tip of a tattoo cross his black cheek.

Truth said, "See you made it."

"How'd do know it was me in here?... Tinted windows?"

"Shit, man, you got dealer plates. Dealer plates and you sitting here nosed out from your own driveway."

"Is it obvious?"

"Ay, man, either it you or the F.B.I. Why the F.B.I. be looking at your house?"

"Fine."

"How you like the video?"

"I didn't."

"But you here."

"Yeah, I'm here."

Truth looked toward the house, nodding. He said, "You did good by my baby mama."

“Is that really your baby mama?”

“She what I say she is.”

“Okay.”

“You did good, so I sent the video. You want to see *this*?—because it’s going to happen...”

He flexed his grip on the steering wheel until it squeaked in his grip. “I don’t want to see it.”

“You don’t have to watch.”

“But it’s going to happen.”

“It’s going to happen, player.”

He sat silent for a moment with Truth just watching the side of his face. “I want to see,” he said finally.

“I know you do.” Now he leaned an elbow on the sill, face and helmet filling up the whole open window. “You like it, don’t you?”

“No, I don’t.”

“Sooner you admit it, sooner we all gonna have a lot more fun.”

“What do you mean we’re going to have more fun?”

“All of us gonna be happy.”

He sighed, curled his grip on the Sierra’s wheel. “I hate this.”

“That’s all right. Be weird if you didn’t. But I know you still want it.”

“I do.” His voice was reduced to a husky, dry whisper.

“You gonna be cool?”

“I’m going to be cool.”

“Hey, man, look at me...”

Carl moved his eyes to meet the guy’s gaze.

Truth said, “Minute you stop being cool, this can be your worst nightmare, believe that.”

“I believe it,” he said.

“Good. ‘Cause it’s true.”

“Hey,” he said abruptly, sensing Truth was about to leave.

“What?”

“Be good to her. Don’t hurt her.”

“Ay, man, that up to her. Not you.”

“Please be nice to her,” he said.

Truth closed his visor over without saying anything, rapped leather glove knuckles on the door sill, leaned forward and let the throttle out on the bike, going toward the driveway in first gear.

Chapter 35

AT THE KITCHEN SINK, she stood in just panties and bra, eyes out the kitchen window, bottle of Tito's on the counter, frosted from the freezer. She rolled a shot glass on its side around on the marble surface, feeling the hard curved shape under the pads of her fingers. Then, without any sound picking up her ears, she turned, anticipating something, a ghoulish sort of creeping feeling up her back. She looked around behind her, down the hall to the front door, saw a shape coming up to the doorstep. First thought she had was to run upstairs because she was just standing here in her lingerie. It was Carl, coming home early, and how would she explain her state! What kind of husband wanted to come home unexpectedly and find his wife in the kitchen wearing lingerie, taking shots of icy vodka by herself. She even took a step forward, ready to dart up the stairs to the second floor—but saw now the silhouette had a motorcycle helmet tucked under one arm.

“Holy shit,” she whispered, and was instantly digging her thumbs into the waistband of her panties, straightening them, running her fingertips over her mound to feel if she'd dampened right through them. She took a few more tentative steps down the hall, slipping her hand into the bra and hefting her breasts so they sat more upright.

Now she was near the glass, looking through the sheer curtains, seeing it was Truth standing there in his leathers with his helmet, looking back toward the street. What would her neighbors think seeing a man like that standing on her doorstep, seeing his motorcycle parked in the driveway? Dangerous looking man, a black one, standing on her stoop about to knock

on the door. Would they call the cops? When the cops came, how would they find the two of them?

She cleared her throat, undid the latches, moved the chain lock to the side, opened the door a foot and a half, stood bent over in the gap so he could see one breast in her lacy bra. She said, "I thought I told you you shouldn't come here if you knew what was good for you..."

He smiled, said, "What about what's good for you?"

"And what's that? What's good for me?"

He shot a hip out, smiled again enough she could see his bright white teeth and a flash of gold.

Chapter 36

WITH HIS HAND on the door lever, Carl watched through the rearview fifty yards down the street to his front door. Truth standing on the stoop, the door opening. He couldn't see Rachel, but who else would answer? Truth stood there, and the two of them were talking. He chewed on the inside of his cheek as he wondered what was going to happen. And he wondered what he wanted to have happen. Truth shifted from foot to foot, putting a hand out onto the wall next to the door, underneath the house number, leaning casually. Still talking.

Now Carl licked his lips. Watched intently. She let him in; she was crazy.

Who was this guy? They don't know a single thing about him, but here she is letting him in their home. One thing for sure that they did know was that Truth was dangerous. You wouldn't let somebody like that into your house.

But now he saw Truth, looking around behind him, watching the neighbors' houses to see if anybody was watching. The door to the house opened wider, and he could see the pale shape of Rachel in the hallway—just for a second, a brief moment, a flash—and recognized she was pale and slim, either wearing light skintight clothing or perhaps naked.

What the fuck? Now Truth was giving another look around, looking this way, looking right at Carl sitting and watching him talk to his wife. Then he was stepping into the house. Walking in casually, helmet tucked under an arm, and the front door closed behind them.

“No way,” he said. “No fucking way. Rachel...? Rachel, what are you *doing?*...”

He jacked the door lever, stepped down into the hot sunshine, closed the door softly behind him. He stood there leaning on the Sierra, sun glistening off the black paint, watching his house. Watching the house that he lived in for ten years with that woman. It was blank, faceless, nothing about it showing off the badness that was going to happen inside. Only a friendly, happy looking place where everything he knew that was good had transpired.

He wiped his palms on his suit pants again, crossing the street, going directly across to the Fairway family’s house. A Spanish colonial like his and Rachel’s, hidden mostly by palm trees and low shrubs. He walked to the curb, hands in his pockets, trying not to look suspicious. He was walking in short, slow steps, making his way toward the house, watching the windows to make sure that nobody saw him coming. *But maybe Rachel should see him coming.* She should see her husband on his way, come to her senses and kick Truth out.

And that’s not even what he wanted.

Why do you keep lying to yourself?

He knew what he wanted. Pace quickening, he was passing the Fairway’s and making his way to the Bearman’s house, getting up on the grass and then onto the sidewalk. He was only one house away when Jessica Bearman’s recognizable honeysuckle voice stopped him.

“Carl? You walking home?”

He jumped, faltered, said, “Huh?” stopping in his tracks and looking around. She was on the far side of a bank of shrubs, and he hadn’t seen her. On her knees, pressed into a neon green foam pad while she gardened. She had a trowel in one hand; an attractive middle-aged woman with her hair tied back. She was grubby up to her elbows but she looked happy.

He said, “Walking home?...”

“You’re wearing your suit.”

“Oh yeah,” he said, “No, not walking home. I had to, uh, drop off a vehicle for someone. And then I thought I would just... walk the rest of the way.”

“Wow, owner of the company dropping off a vehicle. Now that’s service.”

“I aim to please,” he said, facing her but his eyes darting up around the windows of his house desperate to get there and witness what was happening inside.

“How’s Jessie?” she asked him.

“Jessie? She’s good. She’s got piano tonight, I gotta pick her up in a bit.”

“How’s her piano coming?”

“She’s good, I don’t know,” he said, not even looking at Jessica anymore, eyes up at the windows. Looking for a curtain to move in the bedroom. Of all the times to run into Jessica...

“You know, Mark was thinking of taking piano... Where does Jessie go?”

“Jessica, look I gotta go, actually... I have to get in the house, gotta change because I have to go pick her up.” And then he realized the gossip his rudeness would produce, adding, “Oh, and she goes to the community center. There’s a guy there, I’ll get you his number. Name is Melodie, and he’s a guy. Young people, you know? Spells it like a girl too. Good kid, talented, He’s a young guy, but he’s a really good teacher. Jessie likes him a lot...” He was still talking but now walking, going backward, hands in his pockets and Jessica watched him, puzzled.

He said, “Why don’t you guys come over on the weekend?” Trying to keep it light. It was so obvious, him walking home, the dealer truck right across the street. Once Jessica saw it, she would know that Carl was home to spy on his wife, and a man that was home spying on his wife suspected her of adultery. *The whole neighborhood would be talking about it, so smarten up, Carl. Don’t be suspicious.*

“This weekend? Yeah, sure, that sounds pretty good. We can make it.”

“Looking forward to it,” he said, brought his hand out of his pocket and pointed at her, said, “I’ll get you that card for the piano teacher, Melodie.”

“Sounds good, Carl, we’ll see you,” she said, smiling and giving him a friendly wave that made him think he got away with it.

“See you,” he said, pivoting and marching toward his house now with purpose because he was being watched. He thrust both hands in his pockets but tucked his chin down to his chest, eyes darting up to the house. Still no movement in there. *What was happening?*

He walked up the driveway, chanced a glance back at the Bearman house to see Jessica hunched over her garden again with her back to him,

elbows up as she dug into a bed of flowers.

He'd considered going to the front door, but now he jerked to the right, headed around the garage and down the side of the house, opening the back gate, slipping inside and closing it behind without a sound. He made his way to the corner of the house, carefully spying to the garden in case Rachel had brought Truth out to have a pitcher of iced tea or something and sit in the sun. Which was fucking stupid because he knew that's not what they were there for. Of course no one was in the garden, and now he was stepping around, moving between the barbecue and brick pizza oven, up the deck steps, pausing at the media room windows and glancing inside. Nobody there. Of course not, what were they going to do, watch Netflix?

He passed across those windows, moving quick in case he was spotted, pausing again, crouching, moving to the two steps that went up onto the second deck that surrounded the back of the kitchen. With his eyes on the kitchen windows, the big bays that look down over the swimming pool, he stepped as quietly as he could in his dress shoes, made his way to the kitchen door. He looked in and saw only the pantry. No sign of them. Were they upstairs already? Was that how long it took? Did Truth just walk in, throw his wife over his shoulder, march her upstairs and throw her on the bed? The mere thought of that got his heart pounding in his chest.

And now he was slipping past the palm set in a big clay planter, getting very near the kitchen window, standing tall like it would make himself thinner, so thin maybe he couldn't be seen by anyone inside. He inched his way closer, getting against the wall, then peeking around and into the kitchen. They were there. The two of them were standing in the kitchen.

Beyond the marble countertops he could see them, both of them from the side, Truth standing by the fridge without his helmet now. He was leaning against the fridge, Mr. Casual. But here was the craziest thing: Rachel was there, and she was only in a pair of pale lavender colored lingerie. Some fancy C cups and lacy string bottom with a thong back that he bought her for Valentine's Day—what was that, three years ago? Seeing her like that, seeing her obvious sexual submission to this dangerous thug got his temples pounding. *What on earth was she thinking?* This was crazy. Crazy, and obvious. She was in her lingerie. *Lingerie you bought her, Carl.* Standing in front of a man who wasn't her husband. This was going to happen.

He watched her shifting, standing there, breasts pushed up in the bra and on display for another man. And not some business partner, not some handsome executive, not some athletic guy from the neighborhood, not some yoga teacher, personal trainer, or local tennis instructor, not even their daughter's young and good-looking piano teacher. A dangerous man. A thug.

With each throb of his heart, he could feel his cock hardening, lengthening, pushing out against his underwear, curling around his testicles; he slipped a hand underneath his belt, straightened it out, pointed it toward his hip and gave it room to grow. And it did, in just seconds turning to steel and feeling hot against his body.

Chapter 37

TRUTH WASN'T the only one who could play it cool. He was leaning on her fridge, doing that narrow almond-eyes thing, and she let him look, wanted him to look, stood there in just her sexy under things, didn't mind his eyes on her. She said, "You got any coke?"

"That's my girl," he said.

"Do you?"

"Rachel likes to party."

"You know I do," she said.

"Told you you was a bad girl."

"So what?"

He inhaled slow, let it out smooth. "What you want coke for?"

She raised a cool eyebrow, said, "What does anyone want coke for?"

He eased off the fridge, thumbs hooked in his waistband. His jacket was zipped open, and she could see a black flash of skin—the skin of his hard stomach she imagined was paneled with muscle—in the gap between shirt and pants. Yes, her eyes were there. This *was* going to happen. And she didn't know why she was being so coy.

He said, "You want to deal for me?"

"Deal coke?"

"Pretty young soccer mom like you probably push a lot of product in a neighborhood full of white folk. I bet you every mom and dad in this whole neighborhood wouldn't say no to a little blow."

She smiled wide enough her eyes narrowed. "You think I could be a drug dealer?"

“I told you you was bad.”

She bit her lower lip, studying this man who looked so out of place in her home. All in leather, all muscle, black and bejeweled, the sexiest thing she’d ever seen, and he had a goddamn torpedo between his legs. One hundred percent this man could *fuck*. “I could probably sell some coke.”

Now he was sauntering to her, hands still tucked in his pockets, eyes even narrower. Sunlight came in from the window in the kitchen, picked up some of the golden colors in his eyes and putting a hint of life in them. It splashed across his face and lit up the tattoos on his neck, on his cheek, on the side of his head. He cocked his head, got closer, but she wouldn’t back away. He stopped right before her, his big sneakers on either side of her bare feet. She didn’t look down, kept her gaze on his. When he dipped his lips toward her, now she stepped back, smiling and smirking, narrowing her own eyes. He took a step forward, and she took another step back, and they did a little dance until her rump pressed against the kitchen cupboards.

He got close, lowered, put a hand out on either side of her and lay them flat on the counter. She curled her back so she could look up in his eyes. He persisted, lowering slowly, his face coming near hers, his lips forming the shape of a kiss, and she turned her face away but put her chin up and cocked her head to the side and he kissed her neck. The seal of his soft lips against her skin turned her nipples into hard bolts that snapped up against the satiny backside of her expensive bra. Her skin went to goosebumps. He kissed her neck, took her ear and earring into his mouth, and she could feel the wetness of his tongue against her. She put her hands on his stomach, felt the muscle underneath the soft cotton T-shirt, and went right to where she wanted. One hand on his hip, her right hand stroked down, over the front of his leather thigh, coming up the inseam, feeling the soft bulge underneath. His huge manhood was down one side. She squeezed it, fondled it, found its shape under the hard leather. Now she turned her face to him, gave him her lips and opened her mouth.

He took her in a soft, passionate kiss, curling her back over the counter top, and she squeezed his huge cock.

Chapter 38

WHAT HIS WIFE was doing in the kitchen inspired a murderous rage inside him, but somehow he was frozen in place. Frazzled, jangled balls of emotion twirled inside him. Rage, hate, murder, love, lust, desire... all spinning together in random trajectories. But his action was submission. Submitting to the inevitable. Submitting in *wonderment*.

There was something spectacular about the sight. And no matter the fire that was roaring inside him, he stayed in place, didn't stop, drop, and roll, didn't fire off every extinguisher in the household, he stood there and let the fire lick at his insides. What was he going to do? This was Rachel. This was who she was. So he submitted to it. Down on his proverbial knees, he watched his wife fall to the lust she had for another man. Falling for his danger, his masculinity, his deep voice, and the size of the thing that she manipulated underneath the leather pants.

That was where his eyes were mostly fixed. He'd already seen it in a grainy video sent by text, seen it as it was poked through a hole in a bathroom in the sticks. And Rachael's small, pale hand squeezed and stroked it under Truth's pants. It grew against the leather, down his pant leg, thickening, Rachel's hand bringing it to life as she kissed him. And Carl's own cock was like a steel bolt in his pants, his knees were shaking, there was a tightness in his chest that made him feel like he was going to implode. His hand went between his legs, grabbed his own balls, stroked up and down the belly of his erection over top of his suit pants.

Now he watched in the kitchen, could see the flexing of Rachel's calves, the movement of her toes against the floor as she lifted up and Truth's

hands snaked around her back and grabbed a hold of each of her ass cheeks, spanked and lifted them. He watched the crisscross scars above her knee as her thighs flexed and she lifted that knee up to his waist. As Truth's hands spread wide over her bottom, she did a little jump, both her legs locked around his hips and Truth supporting her with his hands slung underneath her ass. Rachel snaked her arms around his neck, their mouths still locked on each other's. It was wild.

Carl unzipped his pants, tugged the fly open, dug his middle finger into his boxer shorts and yanked the mouth open so his clock was out. He put his hand on it, could feel it hot and slippery. He stroked while he watched. Truth held his wife against his body, making out with her, turning then and heading down the hall. His slim body clad in leather, two bare woman-legs wrapped around his waist, Rachel's feet hooked together behind him, her arms locked around his neck, he could see the gentle sway of her hair as Truth walked her now and turned at the bottom of the stairs and began to head to the second floor.

Though his heart still thundered in his chest, without them in his vision the spell was broken; he almost collapsed. Stood there with his hands on his knees, hunched over, breathing heavy. Eyes wide, he stared at the sparkling bits of rock in the garden under the window.

Truth and Rachel were heading upstairs, they were heading upstairs, and he wanted to watch. Now he was bent right over, his shaky hands undoing the laces on both shoes, prying them off. He kicked them aside, slipped his hand in the grip of the back door, thumbed the lever gently, opening it without a sound, easing it aside, well-oiled and not making a squeak. He slipped into the house, felt the air conditioning sting cold against his damp sweaty skin. His heartbeat pounded in his ears, but the house was quiet.

In his sock feet, he slipped gently down the hall, following the path that they lead, making his way to the bottom of the stairs and putting his hand along the railing, looking up as he went. No sign of them, no sound. He mounted the steps slowly, keeping his weight to the side where he might not make a squeak, and gently made his way to the second floor landing...

Chapter 39

SHE CLUNG to him while he mounted the steps then walked the hall of the second floor, her eyes closed.

“Where your bedroom?” he asked, their lips coming apart with a wet smack.

“Huh?” she said, a little out of it, her heart racing. She looked around them, saw the painting of the peacock in the hall, knew where they were. She said, “Keep going this way, it’s at the end of the hall,” then took his mouth back with hers, forearms crossed behind his neck. Eyes tightly closed again, she rocked her head against his, sucking on his tongue. She kept them closed till she knew they were past Jessie’s room and into the master bedroom.

When she opened them again, the kiss came apart. They were standing near the foot of the bed, the window shades open and outside it was sunny and blue skies. It was crazy. She knew it was crazy. Right now it was the craziness that was drawing her to this. The craziness and the pure masculine appeal of this dangerous black man. She looked in his eyes, and he looked back at her, dead, no love, no comprehension, just piercing dark eyes that sucked her gaze in like a black hole.

He took a step forward, fingers digging into her bottom as he hefted her, tossed her onto her own bed. She bounced once, fell back on her elbows, and he stood at the foot of the bed. She said, “You’re going to fuck me?”

He didn’t answer, staring down at her with that blank gaze, pulling his jacket off bulging shoulders and letting it fall to the floor. His hands crossed over, and he peeled that tight white T-shirt up his muscular body. He was

covered in tattoos; across his chest and shoulders and down both arms. Over his rib cage, too, and black Gothic letters arced his stomach though she couldn't read what it said, black ink on black skin. His hands went behind him now, moved around, and he pulled out the big nickel-plated handgun, tossed it on the bed next to her. Her eyes went to it, saw it gleaming in the sunlight on her white cotton duvet printed with tropical flora.

When she looked back, she knew what she wanted. Truth did too. She scooted her butt down to the foot of the bed, placed her bare feet on the floor on either side of his. She put her pale white hands on his hard black stomach...

PART VI

Size

Chapter 40

AT THE FOOT of the bed his wife sat and undid Truth's leather pants. Her tongue ran over her lips, she smiled, looked up in his eyes as her fingers worked the zipper. Truth was slim-hipped, the pants rode low, and once the fly was undone, they sagged a little further. Now Rachel's eyes were in the opening, wanting to see what the man had. But she knew. She already knew. His wife had seen it in a glory hole in a bathroom she never should've entered. And that's what brought them here...

In his socks, he'd slipped himself along the polished wood floors, knowing to which room they'd most likely go. He found them where he expected. In his own bedroom. On his own bed. The one he shared with his wife. Who was now about to fuck another man. When he thought he had a chance, both of them occupied with each other's bodies, heads turned, he slipped from the bedroom door and across to the walk-in closet. He was hidden in there now, amongst his wife's clothes, in the dark, peeping out into the light and the truth, finding out who his wife really was.

Now Rachel opened the fly wider and began to tug Truth's pants downward. They were snug and hard to budge, but she got them down to the middle of his thighs. The man was enormous. From where he stood, Carl could see the huge black dong that hung between his legs. So big that even though Rachel had pulled his pants halfway down his thighs, the guys penis was still tucked down one pant leg.

She laughed, moaned, said, "You have the hugest dick ever."

She ran her fingertips over it, down to where it disappeared under the leather, half-circled, tugged it out and let it dangle.

Right before her, Truth's monster swung heavy and idle, impossibly thick, long enough it ended just above his knees. She kissed him at his pubic hair, ran her tongue halfway down its length, one hand moving to his ample black sack, the other stroking the head of his cock.

She lifted, held it out straight toward her face, the thing looking a foot long. She began to stroke it, run her tongue over the shape of his glans. She would look up at the man's eyes once in a while to see if he liked what she did, and he stood with his hands tucked behind his back, hips thrust outward.

He'd grown larger and harder, veins rose up on the surface of it. Rachel couldn't even get it in her mouth. Maybe a third of the way down, but she was really eager, trying hard, sucking and slurping, eyes turned up to Truth as he looked down at her. The other hand stroked while she gripped his hanging sack. She made gagging sounds, withdrew it from her mouth, ran her tongue over it, shoved it back in. Her hand could barely close around the thing.

While she sucked, Truth leaned forward at the hips, the end of his cock in Rachel's mouth, reached behind her and unhooked her bra. Rachel never broke her attention to his massive manhood, taking one arm at a time, bending it, letting the bra's straps fall free, tossing it to the floor, those lovely ladies of hers hanging free, swaying now as her head bobbed.

Now she was slowing her sucking, getting coy, tilting her chin, kissing the tip, tonguing the urethra, popping her lips around it, looking up at him and smiling. She sunk him one more time, drew back again, then let it go. The thing hung down, shining from her saliva, thick and black and so so intimidating. And Rachel was looking at it, alternating from the thing dangling between his legs and then up to Truth's eyes, leaning back on her elbows, topless, putting her heels up on the bed, smiling and luring him to follow her as she worked her way farther toward the pillows.

Truth watched her, and finally she lay her head on a pillow, looking sultry and teasing, tossing her hair around and putting her arms up, showing off her lean, sexy, swim-toned body. Truth followed her up onto the bed, taking his pants off, pulling his feet out, totally naked now, and Rachel was excited to see him coming, practically squirming on the bed as the man walked on his knees, his hanging cock grazing up along the inside of her thigh, walking up past her hips, straddling her waist. He hefted his cock and dropped it on her chest. It made a wet slap and Rachel chewed on her lower

lip. He lifted it again and guided it into her waiting mouth, gathered up Rachel's hair in one hand and began to fuck her face as her chin tucked to touch her chest. She put her hands on his thighs to stop it from going too deep, her nails digging into his skin.

She sucked on him for a long time, one hand slipped down between her thighs, inside her panties, into her pubic patch, and Carl could tell she'd slipped a finger or two fingers inside herself while she jerked and sucked on Truth's cock.

It was almost too much, and he felt himself getting lightheaded. He could never in a million years imagine his wife being so bad. There she was cheating on him, cheating on him not with some affair of the heart, some sweet man she'd fallen for, but the worst kind of person. A dangerous one. Her sole attraction seemed to be his sexual power. She was masturbating, sucking him off, worshiping the enormous size of his manhood. And that's what seemed to make it okay for him, maybe. If it'd been somebody else, some other dad from down the street who looked good in his khaki shorts and she tumbled into his bed after a cocktail party he would be livid. But this (because it made no sense at all, because it was so wild and sexual and crazy) it seemed... what?—safe, maybe... Which was impossible. This was the *least* safe thing she could do. And yet he was so turned on by it, so turned on by her. So turned on by how awful this wonderful young woman was. He had an idea. He had an idea but here it was proven, and he loved it. Loved it hard...

Chapter 41

THE SIZE of Truth's cock hurt her mouth. Her jaw ached, even under her tongue felt like something had cramped in there. The corners of her mouth were stretched and sore, but she loved sucking on him. But now he was backing down, his cock coming out of her mouth and resting heavy on her chest, slipping down and leaving a slippery mark between her breasts. She raised her knees, hoping he would do what she wanted. And he did, getting down on his elbows and knees between her thighs and looking up her body at her.

Those thick plump lips of his kissed at her lavender panties, pressing over her mound and getting her writhing. Fingers working through the panties where they rose over her hips he began to shimmy them down, and she was into it, helping, pushing them down as he pulled. She folded her legs up, bringing her knees high and together, then straightening them so he could pull her panties free and toss them to the floor. Then she made a show of revealing her pussy, caressing her own thighs, rubbing her knees, then opening her thighs real slow, making sure her dangerous lover was watching. And he was, taking her knees and helping to guide her legs apart, eager to see that sexy woman part of her. But instead of diving right in, shoving his pink tongue into her gash, he kissed her knee, working over the knob, going inside, getting higher. It was her scar he was after. Her shark bite. Studying it now, kissing the jagged trail, his tongue slipping out to caress it as his eyes went up to regard her. His attention to her scar made her smile, and she rocked under his mouth, her hands coddling and squeezing

her own breasts, her gaze feeling hazy and far away, a lusty smile parting her lips.

“You a bad girl, and I love it,” Truth said, then working his kisses higher up the inside of her thigh, toward that bristle of pubic hair that showed glimmers of wet excitement; her sex sweat being gathered into droplets that clung to the thatch that protected her opening.

The touch of his tongue against her membranes drove her wild; she sighed and groaned. So wrong, so terrible, but her heart beating just for Truth right now. She let one leg fall over his shoulder, palmed the top of his head as he mouthed over her, his tongue pushing up inside her, his hands came up and grabbed her breasts, thumbs stroking at her nipples. He had her squirming all over the bed, her head rocking in the pillows. She grabbed his arms, felt the muscle. She could see past his head and down his body that perfect round ass of his, and she ached for that thing that she *couldn't* see right now that huge man-cock, that massive thing probably twisted up in their bedsheets, the ones she shared with her husband.

The longer she let him go on, eating her out like she'd never been eaten before, driving pleasure through her, she wanted more than this, she wanted *so* much more. His tongue flicked, his fingers worked on her throbbing clit, and she sat up, head rocking, feeling her eyelashes fluttering.

She cupped a hand over his ear, said, “I need your cock deep inside me...”

Chapter 42

TRUTH ROSE up from between Rachel's legs, rubbing her knees, hands going down to squeeze at her ankles. He moved to the foot of the bed, stood, pulled her to the edge by her ankles until her rump was at the lip of the mattress. "Oh my God," she said, looking at his dick, "we're going to need *so* much lube."

Truth disregarded her—his cock was soaking wet from her mouth anyway—and when he pushed her knees up, her feet bending to points, she made a shocked but coy face, dismayed but also *liking* that they were going to try to get this thing to fit without lube. She hooked her fingers behind her knees, elbows on the bed, chin tucked into her chest and looking down at her own pussy. Truth hefted that monster, dropped it over her sex. He beat on it, tapping up and down, and each time he did Rachel made bright, cheery sounds.

"Yeah," she said yeah, "fuck me with it..."

Truth mushed the big cock head around, then put his hands behind his lower back, eased his hips forward—Carl could see that huge glans smush her labia, and then slowly his wife's pussy swallowed him.

Her feet lifted up and flexed, she made a grimace. "Oh, that's big," she said.

Truth pushed a little deeper, and Rachel's toes wriggled and curled. She said, "Be gentle with it..."

Truth withdrew and then sunk a little deeper; Rachel smiled tentatively and watched his face, her tongue curling out, her clenched teeth holding it

in place. But when Truth pushed too deep, that smile faded quick, her lips pursed and her brow lowered. She said, “Oh, oh wow, oh my God...”

Truth pushed deeper, and Carl couldn’t believe that thing could go inside of her. It was an enormous club with thick veins, the biggest thing he had ever seen. It didn’t even look human, it looked like something that should be on a zoo animal. But it *was* sinking inside her...

“Holy fuck,” she said, “oh, holy, holy fuck,” then pursed her lips inward, clamped them with her teeth. Still he sunk deeper, and now she was wincing, baring her teeth and snarling. “Oh fuck, oh my God...”

Truth pulled out a little, then pushed himself back in again. Rachel drew in a long inhale then exhaled, making almost the exact same sounds she’d done when she was practicing Lamaze when she was expecting Jessie. He drew out, he pushed in again; there was no way he would get all the way inside her. But they were trying, and now Rachel’s breaths were coming faster and faster, pain and pleasure racing her heart.

When Truth started to really fuck her, her sounds changed to strangely passionate and sweet. He thrust in and out, getting quicker and quicker, only giving her half of what he had. But half of what he had had Rachel’s face contorting, morphing in between pain and ecstasy, making a happy face, her head falling back with lust, then snapping forward, teeth clamping down in pain. “Oh, ow,” she panted, “ow, that’s big...”

But Truth kept going, wanting to fuck her, wanting to give her everything he had. Rachel still held her knees back, her legs open, this black man with his huge dick fucking her hard and deep...

Chapter 43

AT FIRST SHE'D thought there was no way. His dick was just too big. Her hand wouldn't even close around it. Almost an inch gap between her thumb and middle finger. But she wanted to try, and at first it hurt far too much. But something about seeing his body, his narrow waist, his stomach muscles, the slabs of muscle on his lean chest and the tattoos that coursed all over his hard body made every bit of her relax and *want* him deep. Will him deep. As deep as he could go.

And now he was fucking her, and she was holding her knees up and away, her legs spread like a butterfly while that huge black cock gored in and out of her. Way too big, but *so* astounding...

“Oh my God,” she chanted, “oh my God,” and now she was mesmerized by looking at the thing entering her body. Her pretty pink petals kissing and sucking on his huge black girth. She could only take him halfway but even that was incredible. Each thrust felt like it was in her stomach. When he would push as deep as she would let it go, it was unexpected pleasure. Unexpected because it brought pain—but the pain was dissipating, leaving ecstasy in its wake...

Chapter 44

WHILE TRUTH FUCKED HER, Rachel took her four middle fingers and began thrumming them back and forth over her clit. Her hand moved faster and faster, blurring, her head falling back, then lurching forward. She drummed them in sticky wet syncopation, mashed her fingers in hard crescents and loose circles, making herself gasp and cry.

Truth fucked her slow, then fast, getting faster, feeding off her cries and the speed at which she beat on her clit. She looked in his eyes, clenching her teeth, chanting, “Oh my God, oh my God,” her hand going faster and faster like she was strumming a guitar. Her thighs started to shake, and Truth grabbed her behind her knee and lifted her leg high. She cried out, it was her bad leg, the one that was braced with metal.

But now her brow wriggled like she fought a sneeze, she bared her teeth and opened her mouth, her eyes growing wide as something unexpected built inside her. It was an orgasm, Carl knew it. Hoped it was, but was also horrified it was, saying in his head, No, Rachel, don’t come. It definitely was though, he could tell. And Rachel’s expression changed: it had started as worry or wonder, even Rachel thinking *I’m not going to come so soon, am I, surely not*, then as her thighs shook and trembled and all the cords and tendons pressed out in her neck, and her face went bright red, she knew it too, then shock and happiness took over, and she brightened, almost looked like she was going to laugh, the corners of her hanging mouth pulling up, and her elastic brows tenting upward with pleasure. Now she welcomed it, saying to Truth, “I’m gonna come, ah, I’m gonna come, oh, oh, Fuck me, ah, mm, big cock...” Nonsensical babbling followed, laced with high happy

shrieks and gasps. And then she did come, crying out, snapping her head back, her stomach muscles bulging out in a long column, her breasts shaking, her legs twitching and trembling like she was seizing. She barked out held-back pleasure, and Carl spewed pre-come all over a lineup of her expensive shoes, crouched over them in the closet, eyes focused on the way that black cock stretched her pink mouth wide, and the way her fingers mashed down on her own pleasure button. The orgasm droned on, her cries thinning to a long draggy croak, her fingers motionless, but he knew they pressed hard still, hard enough for them to bow. Truth kept himself fixed inside her and her stomach muscles undulated, Carl sure she was squeezing and milking that monstrous thing buried inside her.

Truth stood proud with half his huge cock still hidden inside her hole, watching this sweaty white housewife heave and pant, left in an orgasmic jelly on her husband's bed. Rachel's chest rose and fell, her breath coming in a whine, her stomach trembled. She ran her fingers through her hair, eyes wide and staring, making happy moaning sounds.

"Oh, fuck," she panted, "Ho, fuck..." Now she laughed, her stomach bouncing, making Truth's cock slip a little in her pussy's grip which tickled her with pleasure enough to make her laughs turn to moans and she caressed her own thighs.

Truth asked: "You get that nut?"

"Oh fuck," Rachel sighed, "that was huge, oh my God, that was the hugest orgasm..."

"You like that?"

"Oh yeah," she laughed, her laugh getting her moaning again as Truth's huge cock slipped against her grip.

"Think your husband like it?"

Rachel laughed. "Ha ha, no, I don't think he would..."

"We can ask him."

Rachel made a get-serious face and managed to work herself up on to her elbows, still laid out with her legs open and a huge cock stuffed halfway inside her. "We don't need to ask him," she said thinly, "I know he wouldn't like it."

"What if he surprise you?" Truth eased himself out of Rachel, his cock sliding, making Rachel hiss lightly and bare her teeth again until he was free, his heavy cock swinging above his knees. Rachel massaged her pussy and watched Truth with a troubled brow.

Carl's heart pounded blood up his neck, knowing what was next...

Truth looked to the closet, said, "Carl, come on out now, tell your wife what you think..."

PART VII

Truth

Chapter 45

RACHEL'S FACE fell seeing him come out to the closet's doorway. Bottomless terror whirled behind her eyes; regret and shame and pain. He loved it. Then her expression pinched tight like she was going to burst out crying. Instead of tears, anger flowed out of her. Naked on her back, knees up and bare feet flat on the bed, she balled her fists and thumped them into the bedding at her sides. She knew she'd been caught, knew her monster-dick lover set her up for this shame. He felt a small measure of sympathy for her. She spat *Fuck! Fuck! Fuck!* over and over in time with her beating fists, her voice just a hissing whisper coming through clenched teeth. Her naked breasts shook on her chest, those cherry-pit nipples still pushed up and excited. He adjusted his erection tucked back in his pants, came further into the bedroom.

Truth said, "Come right in, Carl, whyn't you sit on that chair..." He pointed to the cushy floral chair that faced the foot of the bed where he usually pulled his socks on in the morning.

Now Rachel covered her face in her palms and he heard her sigh a pained, "Oh God, Carl," his wife knowing how bad it was what he'd seen.

Truth stood confident, moving them around in their own bedroom like he was a conductor; his huge dick was still hard, swaying from side to side, absolutely drenched with Rachel's guts. A long thread of his lubricant shone silver in the sunlight, extending down from the tip of his cock and elongating almost to touch the floor.

"Oh no, Carl," Rachel moaned into her hands.

He moved to the chair Truth had indicated, sat down, hands gripping the curled rests.

Truth said, "What you want to say to your pretty wife?"

He didn't know. What *did* he want to say? That he always knew she was like this and now he had his proof? So what? It didn't even matter anymore. Tell her he still loved her? He did. But instead he ran away from that idea and said, "Look at me."

It took a moment for her to gather the nerve. At last she moved her hands away, face turned up to the spinning ceiling fan, eyes blinking. She got up on her elbows, her breasts swaying on her chest. But she couldn't meet his eyes, instead looking into their en-suite bathroom. He waited. Her eyes slowly made their way to his.

When they met, he said, "You're a pig."

The contortion of her face to pretty and ashamed right into beet-red crying six-year-old was exquisite. Her features scrunched, her lips wriggled and formed an elastic infinity symbol. He wished he could say it again, or had the nerve to say something worse. For now he enjoyed her hollowed out pain.

She crumpled, sitting up but folding over in half and burying her face in her hands. She sobbed a long mournful sound, and he fought the instinct to rush to her. Now her legs were bent over the bed's edge, her pretty calves flattening against the mattress's face and making her knees look thinner, her scar more jagged. "I am," she sobbed, "I'm such a pig."

Truth made a sympathetic sound in his throat, then said, "Ay, you ain't gon' let him say that..."

"It's true," she cried.

He said, "You shamed you want this dick?" hefting his glistening member, giving it one hard stroke from base to choke it, sending out a fresh clear dribble. The blades of muscle in his forearms rippled as he whapped it twice into the opposite palm with wet sounding smacks. It bounced and swung when he dropped it. Rachel didn't notice, still hiding her face.

But she nodded, murmured, "I am," into her palms.

"Jesus Christ," Carl muttered, still thinking about the heft of the guy's cock.

Then Truth said, "Carl want it too. Carl wants you to have this dick much as you want it, you two don't even know you on the same page."

He grunted, shook his head. "No, I don't."

Truth disregarded him, saying to Rachel, "Your man hard as a rock right now watching me fuck you."

"No, I'm not."

Truth cocked his head his way. "You make me tear those pants down, Carl? I'll come over there and show your wife your little white dick pointing up to the ceiling."

He exhaled a disgusted sound. Then: "It doesn't mean anything."

"Sure it do, player." To Rachel: "He want you to have it. Go on and show him how you like it."

Rachel's hands ran up and down her face; she peeked through her fingers, let her hands fall, watching him cautiously as he sat across from her on the chair. He showed her nothing but a stern expression. She sagged, said Sorry with her eyebrows and a wilting of her features. He gave nothing back. But his heart was pounding waiting to see what she would do next.

Lower lip sucked under her teeth, she dared to meet his eyes. Hers were wet, but they seemed to see inside him. They lowered then.

"Don't," he said.

Her eyes moved to the side. Truth's cock dangled down his thighs not far from his knees, and Rachel regarded it now. She gave a quick look up to Truth then back down to his cock. Her hand came up to it, paused, moved closer.

He said, "You're really going to...?"

She regarded him plainly. "Why did you let me get way with everything?..."

"I want you to be happy..."

"You know I'm bad, Jackie told you..."

The flat of her hand lay over the top side of Truth's hanging member, longer than her opened hand and fingers. She caressed it with her slickness, took a gentle grip on it, milked it slowly downward.

Truth said, "Tell him how you like it."

She whispered, "I like it."

"Not me. Tell your man. He want to hear it."

She ran her tongue over her upper lip, building courage, turned her face to his. Their eyes met, and she looked troubled but hopeful. "I like his dick."

He said, "Good for you."

"Tell him to show you his little dick," Truth said.

Her brow grew puzzled, her mouth twisted to the side. She looked at the massive cock in her hand, then back to him. There was that expression again, a knowing sort of look, one light with reverie. She said, "Show me your dick, Carl."

He said, "No. Put your clothes on, Rachel."

Truth said, "Let him know you're gonna see it. No ain't an answer, let him know that."

Hand steadily milking Truth's horse cock, she studied him and he swore he never gave anything away, keeping a steady gaze on her, trying to show her anger. But it was cracking. Deep down a dark sliver of him wanted to do his zipper down and show his wife the thing he had that was a fraction of her lover's. Her chin tilted toward him. Her voice was clearer now: "Show me your little dick, Carl."

The moment went long and tense like an expanding balloon awaiting detonation; the quiet roared in his ears, the click-click-click of the ceiling fan above took on the brash rattle of enemy machine gun fire; his heart whooshed in his ears.

When he moved finally, the fabric sound of his suit seemed deafening. His hands combined in his lap and drew down his zipper. Truth and his wife watched his hand fumble around under the fly and his boxers then pull out his arrow-straight cock. He flattened the flaps of his fly to pronounce what he had better to them, though average, it was nothing compared to Truth's dangling black bludgeon.

Rachel said, "You're hard."

He shrugged, scowled.

Truth said, "No wonder you'll suck a dick comes through a hole in the wall."

Rachel looked up at Truth.

"Ay, no thing. He know. Got it on video. Your man jerk off to it, look how red his little dick is, prob'ly beat that skinny thing raw watching you suck."

"Video?"

Truth said to Carl, "Tell her."

He shook his head, sighed. "He emailed it to me."

Rachel said, "What? What did you see?"

"He see me nut in your mouth."

Rachel's face fell in silent wide-eyed shock. She hissed: "When?"

Truth said, “Yesterday. Told you he want this much as you. He see that video, it got him hiding in the closet wanting more, more, more.”

Chapter 46

RACHEL ASKED, "WHERE WAS THE CAMERA?" Her voice trembled, brows squeezed together in the middle putting narrow lines above the bridge of her nose.

"I put a camera in the washroom," Truth said, "after you come the first time."

Carl said, "There was another time?"

"Your wife just use her hand, but I knew she be back."

"Oh my God," Rachel sighed, buried her face in her palms.

"You went *back*?" Carl couldn't believe it, and yet he could. Somehow he'd suspected that. "You stopped there once, and you went back for more..."

Face still buried in her hands, she nodded. He could hear soft cries in her throat.

"Hey, baby girl," Truth said, cupped the back of her head and caressed her hair. "Don't cry now. Open your eyes and look at your man, he ain't even mad."

"I'm mad as hell," he said.

Truth pushed Rachel's hands away from her face, tilted her chin with an index finger and pointed her to look at her husband. He said, "Look at that dick, look how hard it is. He can say all he want how he mad at you, but this motherfucker love a bad woman." Now he was looking his way. "You love her, don't you?"

"I love her so much," he said.

"Let your girl be who she be."

“She cheated on me.”

Rachel cried, “I did, I did.”

Truth said, “That’s who you married, player. Take the good with the bad, you an all right looking dude probably got a lot of money. You lucky you have this one. And you know you got the one you wanted.”

“I am lucky,” he admitted.

Rachel slumped, looked exasperated, let her hands fall to her thighs. It was like she hated taking a compliment right now. Didn’t feel like she deserved it.

“You are amazing,” he told her. “I really do love you so much.”

“I love you so much, too,” she said. But she stayed seated, the two of them stuck in place while their orchestrator made their decisions for them. Husband and wife who loved each other, both of them dominated now by a frightening man with enormous sexual power. Truth said, “Go on now, go to him. Just half a minute, as we ain’t through.”

Rachel moved like she would come to him, then stopped herself. She said, “Carl...?” His wife looking for acceptance.

“Come to me,” he said.

Rachel stayed seated, asked him: “Do you hate me?”

“I just told you I loved you,” he said, his voice small in their big bedroom.

“I’m so sorry,” she said, easing off the bed and setting her feet on the floor. And then it was like her wounded leg got to her, because she hobbled and collapsed to her knees. Her hands were clasped together at her front like she was going to plead for him. And he hated to see that, pushed himself off his chair, and got to his knees before her. He said, “I love you.”

“I love you too.”

Then the afternoon sunshine coming in from the windows was closed off as Truth stepped between them, his dick dangling before their faces. He ran his fingers through Rachel’s hair, said, “That’s good, that’s good, now go on get up on that bed.”

Truth brought her to stand, gently guiding her by the hair. She did, her hands still together at her front like they were bound or handcuffed. Her eyes were on Carl, pleading to him.

He said, “Go on.”

“I want to,” she said.

“I know you do,” he said. “You need it.”

She gave no reply, instead her face going red again and her lips doing that elastic thing like she would cry.

Truth snatched her away, yanked on her hair and brought her face-to-face with him. Carl watched her calves flex, that squiggly shark bite twist in the sunlight as his wife went on her tiptoes to kiss Truth. Those intertwined hands came apart, went to claws that raked on his muscular black chest. She ran her nails down the ridged muscles of his stomach, looking for that thing they sought. Carl watched both her hands close around his massive dick, squeezing it, unable to circle completely around. Dancing light picked up in the facets of her engagement ring's diamond.

Chapter 47

SHE NEEDED MORE FROM TRUTH. More and more. She gripped that big thing in her hands, squeezing it, feeling the slickness she'd left on him. She grabbed his balls, squeezed those too. She wanted what was inside them.

His tongue slipped over hers, and she loved the feel of his lips. One second she's dying, feeling so ashamed, next she's feeling her truth. Feeling who she *is*. And fuck it, this was who she was. This was right, and this was what she wanted. She said to Truth, "Fuck me again, fuck me harder."

She watched him smile, kissed the point of that ice cream tattoo where it curved over the edge of his jaw. "Fuck me so hard," she said.

"You want to watch?" When her eyes turned up, she saw he was talking to Carl.

It took great effort, but she looked over her shoulder, saw her husband, her provider, on his knees on the bedroom floor. His suit pants were open and the narrow tip of his dick poked out. He looked beaten and hurt but also *ravenous*.

She licked her lower lip, asked him: "You want this?"

He breathed in and out, pulse flitting in a cabled vein that rose on his neck. He said, "Do it," his voice thin and draggy.

Truth said, "You want to watch me fuck her?"

Carl nodded.

Now something was happening inside *her*. Her heart beating not faster but *harder*. *Stronger*. She didn't know where the meanness came from, but she said to Carl: "You sure? Because he's going to fuck me *so* hard..."

It seemed to get him, his eyes fluttered and what little color was in his cheeks drained away. He nodded weakly.

She said, "I'm glad you do. I want someone else to witness this. No one would believe it if I ever told them, I want someone to see how bad I can be."

Truth said, "I get you lots a witnesses. Get you all my riders in here, take they turns with you. Each one of 'em watch the others."

She gave Truth a wary sort of smile, a fearful one, but it slowly grew to wily. She said, "How many?"

"I get you a dozen. Get you a line up outside this bedroom door, take four hours 'fore you stumble out here limping on *both* legs."

She kissed his hard muscular throat, breathed against his skin. "You hear that, Carl? You want to watch that?"

No answer came, and she peeked a sly sort of glance her husband's way. He had his hand on his dick, gripping it and rotating his fist on it.

She asked him: "You like that?"

"You're so bad," he said.

"I'm worse than you think," she told him.

Truth said, "You worse than this?"

"This is nothing," she told Truth while watching her husband's reaction. Carl groaned.

"Hey, stop that now," Truth said, and when she looked down, saw her husband stroking himself. And she caught on...

She said, "Carl, don't do that."

He kept going but slowed.

She said, "Carl, I'm telling you to stop it."

Truth said, "Get your man to stand up."

She said, "Carl, up on your feet for us."

Her husband flicked his tongue along his upper lip, let go of his penis, put his hands on his thighs and raised to stand before them. Now she left Truth, came to him. They were face-to-face, and she was bewildered to see him like this. It was like he'd been hypnotized. One might think it was Truth doing it, she thought, Truth controlling her husband so he could get away with fucking his wife. But it wasn't Truth. It was her. It was her who had this power over Carl. She told him, "This is going to be so hard, Carl."

"Is it?" he said, his voice constricted.

"Are you ready for this?"

“No,” he said.

“Good,” she said now, and put her hands on his chest. She pushed his suit jacket back, and he let his arms come out. It fell to the floor. Now she undid his tie, the whole time he watched her eyes. She unwound it from his collar, told him to turn around.

“Okay,” he said shakily, turned around and faced the bedroom door.

“Put your hands behind your back,” she said.

Carl complied, folding his arms up behind him. She took his tie, looped it in a figure-eight around both wrists, then tied it in a tight knot. She yanked it tighter, making him sway.

She hugged her arms around him, rubbed his stomach, let one hand come down, felt the tip of his erection against the back of her knuckles. She beat against it lightly with her wedding ring, making it bounce. She whispered, “Now you can’t jerk that little thing while your wife gets what she wants.”

“Is this what you want?” he said, sounding defeated, disappointed.

She had the feeling it was an act. The way he *thought* he should act. She flicked the back of her fingers hard against his erection and made it bounce. He winced, and she felt his knees dip. She said, “This and a whole lot more. Does that turn you on?”

“No,” he said.

She batted his dick again, harder, said, “You’re such a liar. Don’t lie to me.”

“I can’t believe you want this...”

Truth said, “Man can’t believe his *luck* you want this.”

“That’s what I’m thinking, too,” she said, going on her tiptoes and nibbling on her husband’s ear. She said, “You can’t believe your luck, can you?”

“No,” he said finally.

Her hands went up his chest, found his nipples hard through his dress shirt. She pinched them and tweaked them. When he groaned, she ran her knee between his legs, came up and pressed the top of her thigh between his butt cheeks. She pulsed her leg against him, pushing against his prostrate.

She said, “You going to be good while Truth fucks me?”

He nodded.

“Turn around then.”

He did, hands behind his back, turning to face them, his dress shirt done all the way up to the neck, one tail hanging out over his belt buckle. His dick stuck out hard and straight.

She said, "You look pathetic, Carl."

"I'm not pathetic."

"No, you're not. But right now you look it. Tell you what," she said. She got real close to him, close enough their faces were touching, and she breathed against his chin. She could hear his breath trembling. Her hands were sandwiched between their bodies, and she unwound his belt, could feel his erection pressing against her bare stomach. "Let's get these pants off," she said, belt buckle undone then unzipping him. She let his pants go and they fell to the floor around his ankles. She jammed her thumbs in his boxer shorts, shoved them roughly as well, pushing his erection straight down. It popped back up again slinging a whip of clear semen.

"I have to be honest, Carl. It really turns me on to see you like this."

His knees dipped again and his eyelashes fluttered. She grabbed the fabric of his shirt, gripped him in case he fell, fainted on her. She said, "Stay up for me, Tiger. Show hasn't even started yet."

Truth said, "Get his ass to shuffle on over to the bed."

She said, "Front row seats, baby."

He nodded, watching her, his eyes wild and stunned.

She said, "Look at you, you're like a zombie. I can get you to do anything right now."

"Amazing, isn't it?" Truth said. "Rachel got that power pussy."

"It's fucking wild," she said. "You want anything? You want him to go down and grab us some drinks? Make him shuffle down the steps with his dick out..."

That got Carl, too, because now she could see his breaths were coming quicker. His cock poked out straight between his white shirt tails and she placed her finger tip on it, pushed it down and let it jump back up like a doorstop. "Fucking wild," she said again, shaking her head to show her husband her disbelief.

"All right, Carl, come on," she said, pointing him to the bedside, "nobody wants drinks, but I want to get fucked..."

Chapter 48

THERE WAS a good chance he wouldn't make it through this. Right now, every fantasy he didn't even know he wanted was coming true. Every dark seam in the fissures of the most insidious part of his mind had Rachel's flashlight shining truth on them. Lighting up all the dust bunnies in his corners. All the awful tangles and webs of lust. For how long had he wanted this? It had teased at him, tickled at him, sometimes conjuring up fantasies like a genie. Showing him glimpses of who his wife *could* be, whether she was or not. The fact that he'd chosen Rachel was proof in itself. That sexy little girl who made him think if he knocked a grand off the price of a new Fiesta, she might get under his desk and suck on him. Right then he knew he had to have her. And from there, it was more of the same. Why's she out late, where is she right now? He could have stopped her at any time from working for Hal Harbor, buy her more toys that would take up her time, more purses, vacations, anything that would take her out of that den of alpha males. But every night he'd surrender her to them. Not knowing what was happening. Fantasizing about what could. Thinking how mad he'd be, holding onto that hate and hurt like it was a basketball and he wasn't going to pass. Clutching it at his chest like Gollum's *Precious*, letting it fester. *Liking* how it festered. But here it was now in glorious light, and as much as it hurt it was ten times better than holding it where no one could see.

With his hands tied behind his back, he shuffled along to the bed, following his wife. His erection stuck out between his legs, a fraction of what she'd just been fucked with, a fraction of what she was going to enjoy right now.

At the foot of the bed, he asked her: "Do you just like him for his dick?" His voice broke.

She smiled, dropped to sit on the bed making her breasts bounce. She said, "What do you think?"

"I think that's all he's got," he said.

Rachel laughed, loud and bright, then covered her mouth quick. She looked at Truth, said, "That all you got? Just that big dick?"

Deep-voiced and confident, Truth said, "I got *everything* you need."

His wife made a sexy growling sound in her throat, said, "I think you do." She caressed his thigh. "But you're right, Carl," she added, reaching out now to hold Truth's dick. She cradled it in the palm of her hand then bounced it lightly, the thing making sticky smacking sounds against her palm. She said, "It's mostly his dick."

That made Truth laugh. Now while she held Truth's, she looked at Carl's. She said, "Bring it here," nodding her chin between his legs. He stepped a little closer, standing beside Truth. Rachel was between them, naked on the bed, legs together, back arched, breasts presented. Now she held a penis in each hand. She said, "How about yours, Carl? You think I like your dick?"

"Do you?"

"Look at it," she said, shaking his stiff, weightless thing closed in her grip. "It's so average, nothing special at all."

Truth said, "Rachel had a thousand of those ones."

His wife sneered, said, "Not quite," then smiled.

"Were you a slut?" he asked her, "before..."

Truth said, "How about now?"

She said, "What do you want to hear, Carl?"

"The truth."

"Everything's about the truth," she said, batting at Truth's huge hanging cock, making it swing back and forth like a pendulum.

"Tell me," he said.

"What do you want to know?"

"Hal Harbor."

Rachel raised her eyebrows, sighed. She said, "Things got a little crazy, didn't they?"

"I was so worried for you."

“You were right to worry.” Her mean and confident expression faded to melancholy. “But you let it go on...”

“I worried...”

“Every day I left for work, I wondered how you let me. Couldn’t you see...?” She shook her head, let it hang.

When she said nothing more, he finally asked outright: “Did you fuck him?”

“The truth, Carl?... Really?...” She breathed deep, prepared herself. “I’ve never cheated on you. Not with my pussy...” She let her legs part, drawing his eyes to that tangled, powerful part of her. “Does that make you feel better?”

“What did you do?”

She disregarded him, said, “Let’s look at these two.” She tugged on his cock, made him arch his back to get his dick closer to her. She studied what was in her hand, hefted Truth’s and brought them near. The head of Truth’s had to be four times larger than the head of his. It was enormous, like a ripe plum. Large, robust, desperate to be inside his wife again. To punish her happy insides with its aggressive flared lip and large size. She ran her thumb in the cleft of Truth’s urethra, and when she squeezed lubricant from him, she ran around it around in shining, slippery circles.

The confident face was back, marred by a certain grimness. She said, “Well, Carl, you ask these questions, you’re going to find out... Do I like Truth’s dick? Yeah, look at it. Did I fuck Hal Harbor? No. Did I blow him?... Yes. A few times.”

He groaned, put a hand on his hip, dug his thumb into his organs, hoping to produce a sharp pain in himself that would subdue the psychic trauma she just delivered.

She whispered, “I thought you like it when I’m bad?”

“He do,” Truth said.

She said, “Carl,” and yanked harder on his dick. It squirted a burst of his pre-come that landed on her leg, leaving a dripping trail from the tip of his penis. She said, “Not just Hal. All those guys. Remi, Marco, you know that guy Alfonse, the one you hated?”

“Yeah?”

“I blew him once, too. Christmas party on the riverboat.”

“Fort Myers, the Caloosahatchee?... I was *at* that party,” he said, his voice a narrow squeeze from his lungs.

“Yes, you were. Those were crazy times, Carl. I blew him open air, up on the third deck riding down that river while you were at the all-you-can-eat. You were right to worry about me. Those guys were bad news...”

“You’re killing me,” he told her. “You sucked off Alphonse?”

“Gross, huh? You should have seen his dick. You wouldn’t believe it.”

Another thin squeeze: “Big?”

“No, that I even put it in my mouth. Two inches of foreskin, looked like a dog’d been chewing on it.” She rolled her eyes up, shaking her head at the memory.

“Oh God...”

“Balls like hard-boiled eggs, Carl, he dumped a quart in my mouth. Only time I ever had to spit out...”

PART VIII

Nut

Chapter 49

ALL RIGHT, Alphonse was a lie, Marco and Remi, too. She'd blown Hal once at a restaurant after he'd bagged a whopper of a deal and the macho energy dripping off him had her powerless. She'd ended up in the men's room at Bern's Steak House, on her knees, Hal's big hands tangled in her hair, slamming her head up and down on his short, fat cock. And the other guys had all shown her their dicks at one time or another, joking around, and she wasn't kidding about Alphonse's weird foreskin and big balls. But blow them?—no. Now she kind of wished she had. If she'd known this about her husband, she would have given them all a go. Remi had a body on him, and lots of chest hair. Nice dick, too. Remi she definitely would have fucked.

If only she'd known.

'Cause look now, Carl was going to watch her fuck Truth.

In one hand she cradled the biggest, most impressive dick that had ever existed on a man, perhaps in the history of mankind. In the other, her husband's run-of-the-mill baby maker, a half-foot long tube of pumped up blood-flesh suitable for depositing genetic material close enough to the vault to ensure success most of the time. A utilitarian penis, one that got the job done—when the job was procreation. But when the job was sexual annihilation, domination, complete stretched-out satisfaction and mind-blowing orgasms, well then, a woman needed a cock like Truth's.

And it looked like her husband agreed. Could it be this whole time Carl knew what she needed but was afraid for it to be realized? Afraid she would

like sex better with a bigger man—and yet deep down *knew* she would and still somehow wanted it?

She said to Carl, “You know his dick’s better, you know it would please a woman more, please *me* more.”

“I know,” he said.

She said, “Is this for real?”

“What?” He looked in her eyes now, puzzled, worried.

“Is this for real, Carl? You want this?”

“I don’t want to...”

Truth’s deep voice making them both flinch with surprise: “But he want to...”

“How humiliating,” she said, narrowing her eyes on Carl’s.

“I know,” he whispered.

“You like it. Like the humiliation.”

He gave no answer, his face gone tight and surly looking, mad that he was submitting to her, but his cock betrayed his real self, his hardness throbbed in her grip, and she could feel the tremble of excitement in him.

“You like it,” she said firmly, making the decision for him. “On my dresser, next to my hairbrush, you’ll see that little dish where I keep my hair ties. Bring it here.”

“Okay,” he said, shuffled with his pants around his ankles to the dresser.

With Carl gone, she looked up at Truth. “This is fucking crazy.”

Truth smiled a mean smile, but an honest sort of one, like he was happy for her. He said, “Ay, Merry Christmas.”

“Just what I always wanted,” she said, looking now as Carl had his back to the dresser, dipped at the knees to retrieve her dish of hair ties. His cock flexed as he lowered and she saw it raise straight up, and a strong rivulet of pre-come pulsed from him, sliding down his shaft, over his balls and a long thread wound down to the floor.

Truth said, “Believe me now? Told you I make it okay.”

“Bring it here, Carl,” she said, and he did, walking awkwardly, trying to keep the dish from tipping behind his back while he returned to the bed. At the bed, he turned his back toward her and she took the hair tie out of the dish, saw a pink satin ribbon with snake-tongue ends she sometimes used back when she was first out of rehab and sitting up in bed to read about maximizing her recovery. It was light, loose, didn’t pinch or give her a

headache. She took that too, relieved Carl of the bowl and set it on the bed, saying, "Bring your dick here, Carl."

Her husband came around to face her, his regulation size dick pointing at her, looking like it might shortly burst. The skin stretched so tight it shone. She pushed the points of four fingers into the opening of a brown ouchless ponytail holder, spread it wide, took Carl's balls in the fingertips of her other hand. But they recoiled, his scrotum tightening.

She said, "You don't trust me?" then laughed, grabbed them more roughly, used the other pronged fingers to ease the cinch of the hair tie around his balls. He groaned.

She caressed the pads of her fingertips over the bunched orb of his testicles, patted them lightly. She said, "You saw Truth's balls, Carl?"

"Uh-huh," he grunted.

"Lotta come. He's going to fuck me, empty those big things inside me."

Carl nodded, bit at his lips and breathed heavy through his nose.

Now she pinched the ends of the pale pink ribbon and held it up so he could see it. "He's going to fuck me now."

She let the ribbon go from one hand, drape to her wrist, then as if performing a magic trick for her husband, lifted her hands so he could see she had nothing up her sleeve. She flashed him her palms, the backs of her hands, wiggled her fingers while the pink ribbon danced. Then with flourish she pinched fingers on her wedding band and engagement ring and drew them up her finger to remove them. Now she presented the rings to to his trembling eyes, held in the circled pinch of three bunched fingers and thumb. The other hand worked the pronged end of the ribbon through the gold bands, threading it through both of them.

Now she held both ends of the ribbon, her beautiful rings sagging in the middle, and she twirled it like a jump rope. Carl was mesmerized. Horrified, but mesmerized. She had all of his attention.

"Closer," she told him, and he moved so his knees touched her knees.

She wound the ribbon around his shaft at about the mid-way point, formed a knot at the underside of his penis, slowly pulled on the ribbon ends to tighten it, the rings stuck out next to the knot, pinched against the belly of it. Fresh pre-come streamed out of him, down his bursting cock and over her ribbon, and working into the seams of the gold bands where they were clutched together. She tightened her knot further, told him, "You're

not allowed to come, I don't care how hot it gets in here. Look at your little sissy dick, so pretty with its pink ribbon."

Truth chuckled, and she laughed too, looking at him. She ran a hand up Truth's thigh, settled the V between her thumb and forefinger under his scrotum and gathered up his testicles. They hung past her wrist-bone. "Look at these balls, Carl," she said, "Do you see these?" She held Truth's scrotum off to the side, his elephant trunk dangling on the other. His balls were as big as eggs, the skin of his scrotum the blackest part of him, as black as charcoal. She leaned close and ran her tongue over them in wide circles, could feel the squirm of each testicle under her slippery pressure. They were too big to both go in her mouth but she took them on one at a time then kissed them.

"Mush them together," she said now, getting into this so bad her own breath was coming in heavy pants. "I want to see your balls against his..."

"Fuck that," Truth said quickly and grabbed her wrist in a tight grip.

"Easy, okay, okay," she said, working her arm out of his hand.

Truth said, "This is some bullshit fucking around, get face down and show me that pussy, I ain't standing around all afternoon watching you two."

"Hear that, Carl, it's time," she said. "Get on your knees at the side of the bed."

Carl nodded, and hands behind his back, got down on one knee, then the other, his face lost and ecstatic.

This was a kind of bad she didn't even know existed...

Chapter 50

HIS EXISTENTIAL CORE RIGHT NOW, the sole dialed-in focus of his being was the ache between his legs, the soaring hurt and joy in his belly, the cliff's edge proximity to a volcanic orgasmic eruption, and his fear of stepping over that edge. The point under his balls ached like a rotten tooth, his cinched balls throbbed and squealed, begged to be emptied; it felt like an iron rod had been run through his genitals, from his anus and up through his shaft. His cock wasn't impressive, but it was straight as a torpedo and hard as a battleship right now. This knife edge of erotic joy and erotic hurt was where he wanted to be; it tightened his chest, made his breath shallow, twisted his brain, wrung it out like a sudsy car wash sponge. Rachel was bad. So, so bad. Worse than he feared, worse than he hoped.

On the bed was the woman he feared his Rachel might be, and while he hurt in his heart to see it, he knew her truth all along and loved its possibility. Down on his knees was where he wanted to be, where his heart told him he needed to be. Above him, on the marital bed, his wife rolled onto all fours, crawled higher up, her sexy ass swaying, her pussy bared to him, bared to her black lover. Her pussy had been punished, and it begged for more. He could see the evidence of its abuse; the furled lips parted in an almond shape, her lips stretched and tugged by Truth's massive girth till they emerged in glistening engorged pillows from the tuck of her vulva. It was what her pussy wanted, maybe *needed*. That yawning pink petal-mouth between his wife's legs had its own feverish hunger and a man like Truth was what could sate it. The thing between Truth's legs would mate with her

fleshy glove, push it to its limits, stretch out every interior fold she had and chase out the pleasure that hid there.

Truth got up on the bed on his knees and walked behind Rachel while she watched for him over her shoulder. His cock was so large, so heavy, it couldn't manage to stick out from between his hips, it merely swung between his legs, looking ridiculous and bloated and oversized. It excited Rachel though, that was for sure, because her eyes peeked down to watch it sway, the tip grazing the bedding as he got himself in place behind her, palming one ass cheek, his skin so black against her palest flesh where the sun rarely kissed.

Rachel quivered at Truth's touch, saying in a breathy whisper, "I need to get fucked so hard, so bad..."

A low groan squeezed from Carl and he dipped his chin. Between his legs his erection stuck straight out, hard and eager. Rachel's pretty pink ribbon tied a tight knot across his middle enough to wrinkle the skin, but he was too hard to be dented. The soft dangling weight of her wedding rings tickled at him as they swayed under his cock. His arms ached, tied behind his back. The knot was weak, the real truth was he could break out of his binding, rip off the little ribbon on his cock, make a grab for the pistol on the bed and maybe get control of the situation. Get this bad man out of his bedroom, throw Rachel's rings in her face and tell her to pack up and get out—but he had his own truth. Rachel wasn't the only one who'd been denying something, letting something powerful inside them stay hidden. So he raised his chin again, happy to watch his wife on the bed...

"Now where were we?" Rachel said with a sly grin, peering over her shoulder, rocking back and forth on her hands and knees, eager to be penetrated. Her opening glistened, sunlight winking off her excited droplets. She bit on her lower lip, pushed her ass back and stayed presented that way.

Truth gripped his cock near the base, squeezing it hard and plumping out the end of it. He pushed the glans into her, and Rachel hissed. He pushed deeper, and Carl watched her toes fold up. Even though they'd fucked already, she'd had an orgasm, and experienced his size, she still wasn't ready. He pushed a little deeper, and now she began to move away from him, easing forward on her knees and putting more weight on her hands. And Truth followed, still trying to get deeper, walking his hands up the bed at her sides. Rachel lay with her arms folded on her chest, almost flat on the bed but with her ass pushed up in the air and Truth's huge cock

pushing into her pussy. He was over her like he was doing a push-up, the muscles of his hips and thighs flexing as he forced that massive thing deeper. Rachel's face twisted, contorted. Pain and pleasure. She kicked her legs, drummed her feet lightly on the bed. Her mouth fell open, and she made soft sounds of complaint.

"Fuck," she sighed, "that's *so* big..."

Now in an acrobatic pose, Truth began to work his hips, his cock going in and out of Rachel. Once he was stroking it in her, her expression changed more to one of pleasure. Just giving her a little of what he had, easing it in and out and making her feel good. Rachel liked it, encouraging him, saying soft things like, *You feel so good, you're so big, God, you're good...*

It wasn't long before both their actions were getting more pronounced, Rachel up on her elbows and tossing her hair around, Truth's body flexing and bouncing, drawing his cock out and pushing deep. They got the bed bouncing. Rachel submitted to him, her ass turned up for extra-large pleasure, squawking and sighing. After ten minutes, Truth worked himself backwards on his hands then gripped Rachel at her hips and brought her onto all fours. Her beautiful breasts hung down but began to shake and bounce as he fucked her doggy like that. His big hands curled at the crease of her hip and thigh, thumbs planted deep in the soft curve of her rump.

From the side, now he could see Rachel was taking Truth very deep. Not every inch, but definitely almost everything he had. Both of their bodies began to gleam with sweat, the headboard began to rattle. Truth gripped her harder, fucked her harder. Rachel's cries grew in volume, and he worried about summoning the neighbors. Pictured them all outside, the Glickmans, the Watsons, Jessica Bearman standing in the driveway with her arms dirty from gardening, looking up at their bedroom and wondering what the heck was making that sound. His cock flexed and jumped between his legs, a continuous crystal bulb rested in the shallow of his urethra, strands and streams pulsing down over the tied ribbon, over his wife's wedding rings, dripping from his tied-off ball sack.

He'd never known pleasure like this. There was his wife getting it better than she could ever get it, and her husband was enjoying it just as much as her. A dark poisonous blade plunged deep into his heart, hearing the sounds she made, seeing that thin ring of her sex being pulled in and out by massive black girth, the thrashing of her hair, the rattle of the headboard... It was all too much, and he fell forward, wrists still tied behind his back,

resting his shoulder against the side of the bed. Now his chin lay over top the mattress and he could see very close his wife's face as she came again. Her bared teeth flashed, her mouth yawned wide, closed shut again, and she let out a creaky groan. Snorts came through her nostrils then, and her lips began shaping vowel sounds. Truth slowed, his hand running a circle on her back.

"Oh fuck," she sighed, "you're so fucking good..." She was out of it, eyes glassy, and Truth gripped her by the upper arm, brought her to sit letting his cock slide out of her. Rachel was bewildered, still being lashed by the trace ends of a powerful orgasm. Truth lay next to her, rolled onto his back. Rachel ran her hair back from her face, looked at Carl, breathed deep, touched her hand to her chest so she could catch her breath. She said, "You like that, Carl?"

Chin still planted on the mattress, he managed to nod.

"You want to watch me ride him?"

He nodded again.

"Oh God," she laughed, as if the idea of accommodating that big thing was a huge endeavor. Truth lay on his back, hands laced behind his head like he was going to do a sit up. The plates of his stomach muscles rippled in the sunlight, and he was smiling. That huge club of his lay glistening, soaked right down to his balls with Rachel's excitement. She gripped it, stroked it, lowered to suck it. It was as big as her forearm, he swore to God. Then she was walking her knees up, straddling Truth's hips, gripping his dick underhand and guiding it into her stretched open slit. She sank back down on it, and feeling him push inside her again got her back arching to accept him.

"Holy shit," she said again as she sunk deeper and deeper, that huge thing disappearing between her legs. She sat down, the soles of her feet scrunching up on the outside of Truth's thighs, the man's hands curled over her bottom, his long fingers pressing into the soft delicate flesh. Soon she was bouncing, that thing working in and out of her, but mostly she liked to take him deep, sitting right down and swinging her hips, swiveling, rocking back and forth. She came again.

If she'd been out of it before, now she was barely comatose. Truth flopped her onto her back like a rag-doll, and she lay prostrate on the bed, panting heavily. "Oh God," she said, "finish, finish inside me..." She patted the V of her hips where they pointed down to her opening.

She repeated: “Finish inside me...”

Truth got between her legs, and she folded her ankles over his hard, round ass. Carl watched her toes bend, watched her expression twist when he entered her. He put himself deep, but now instead of some rampant fucking, he made love to Rachel. Rolling his hips, kissing her, caressing her face, tweaking at her rubbery nipples. Rachel moaned and made passionate sounds, surprised too by his sudden tenderness. She kissed him in return, began panting, breaking her kiss away so she could breathe. “Oh God, you’re so good, you’re so good, so big...”

He would give anything right now to grab his dick and finish himself, maybe even jump up, slip out of this stupid tie-knot, push Truth aside and shove his cock in her instead—if *Rachel would even feel him*. But he basked in the strange and rare pleasure he was experiencing right now. This was like the most complex and rare wine you could find. A connoisseur’s pallet was required. No one could take this. No one could take it, but here he was *taking* it. He was getting pleasure, his beloved wife was getting pleasure. He was getting what he always wanted...

By the time a crescendo loomed, their writhing bodies moving ragged and lusty, and he was sure they were reaching climax, the sun had moved across the room. They were no longer in the bright square of light, it was now slashing across Carl as he watched his wife being made love to like she’d never had before. Her hands caressed every bulging black muscle. Squeezed on his hard edges, their mouths conjoined and twisted, tongues swirling. Their hips worked in unison, riding against each other, working like lovers. Truth’s muscular ass rose and fell slowly and carefully, and the knowledge that the thing pushing in and out of his wife was the largest thing a man could have between his legs was pinching off Carl’s heart valves. His eyes pounded in their sockets and his own meager cock threatened to split in two like a hot dog in the microwave. But at last, Truth began growling and grunting. Rachel cooed. “Yes, yes, inside me...”

He pushed deeper, she squealed. “I feel it, I feel it, I feel you coming,” she sighed.

Truth only roared masculine animal sounds. He was ejaculating inside of Rachel. Hot sheets of wonderful shame fell across Carl’s back. Nausea, heartache, hate, and love. He closed his eyes and felt its embrace. His body shuddered and trembled with complete ecstasy. He loved it.

Truth and Rachel lay joined together, breathing heavy for minutes after he'd come. Finally, Truth began to rise, getting on his elbows, shifting his hips and letting Carl watch as he withdrew that massive sword from inside his wife's scabbard. Rachel's pussy had been bludgeoned. Lips blubbery and slick, that black thing withdrew from her, pulling her insides out as it went. Inch after inch, sliding out until the bulbous knot at the end of it peeled back her lips just a little further. When it was free and fell to the bedding, a long trail of the man's semen pulsed in Rachel's hung-open slit. She sighed, loving the feel of this man's hot wetness seeping from her. She reached down, stroked the apex of her thighs and made odd humming sounds in her throat. Her eyes were closed, but she asked Truth, "Is he watching?"

"He sees it all," Truth said, falling back to sit on the bed and watching Carl, point blank. "You good, man?"

His chin was still planted on the mattress, and he nodded again. He eased back, his neck and shoulders feeling like they were twisted, and he hunched on the floor, looking down to see the mess he'd left below him. Darkened spots on the rug under the bed. "I'm good," he said.

Rachel sighed, cupped her cheeks which were blazing red. She laughed. She looked at Truth now and said, "I've never been fucked like that."

Truth smiled and squeezed her knee. "You gon' be my trap bitch, ain't you?"

She smiled, gathered her hair in one hand where it hung over a shoulder. "Yeah."

"You gon' hold my suburb trap?"

"I am."

"I come by, you spread these pretty legs?" He watched his own finger trace over her shark bite.

Rachel quivered at his touch and giggled.

Truth said in his deep baritone: "I make you right again, you like that? Make you see stars."

She said, "Oh my God, I *saw* fucking stars there..."

She sat up now, and her pussy made a bubbling sound. With her feet still spread out, she brought her knees together. She looked at Carl now and said, "You like how bad I am?"

He puffed his cheeks out, hung his head down and resisted the urge to fall forward again. He straightened. "I do," he said.

“That was pretty bad,” she said to him and laughed again.

She leaned to caress Truth’s muscular shoulder. “I knew you could fuck,” she said. “One look at you...”

Then she turned to Carl again and said, “You have to go, Carl.”

“What do you mean?”

Chapter 51

HER EYES MOVED up to the digital readout on the bedside clock. She said to Carl again, "You better go."

"Go where?" He looked destroyed, obliterated. Not by what he'd seen, but by being asked to leave. She would note that for later. Now she sat up a little better, put her arms around her knees. She rested her chin on them, said, "You want Jessie coming home to find us like this?"

"No," he sighed, looking dejected.

"Go pick her up from the academy. Take her to the pool, I'll meet up with you there."

He still looked defeated, worse than before, and she saw he was upset that he wasn't going to get his, especially after what he'd seen. She wondered what his dick would look like, wondered if he'd burst that ribbon to shreds. She said, "You have to go, Carl. I have to get cleaned up."

Carl looked to the clock; she could see calculations working in his mind. How long it would take him to get to the car, how long it took to drive to the academy, what time did Jessie get out, could he stop her from getting on the bus... How much time could he squeeze in right now...

Then Truth said, "He any kind of man, he ain't gonna let you clean yourself."

She looked to Truth now and said, "He should get in the shower with me?"

Truth scooted toward the edge of the bed, said, "Where your imagination?" Then he leaned back and pushed open her thighs by a knee. The immediate response was for her to close them again, not wanting Carl

to see the mess that Truth left. But the smile on Truth's face clued her in. She said, "Oh, really?... That would be a big help, Carl..."

Truth said, "How about it, player? You gonna let her stay like that?"

She tightened her stomach muscles, pushed seed from inside her and felt its slickness working in her folds. Carl would see. He was looking right there. That lost puppy dog expression went away, and he brightened. He was being brought back in and he liked it.

Carl struggled to his feet, falling forward to rest his chin and shoulder against the bed. Truth said, "Hey, you two on your own, this ain't for me. I'm a get in the shower," he walked a few steps then turned back, said to her, "You catch up with me."

"I will," she said, watching Carl crawl onto the bed, getting on his side and wiggling like a worm to get to her. She squeezed and pinched her own nipples watching him work his way closer to that devastated part of her. "I'll be right there," she said as Truth disappeared into their bathroom.

When Carl was between her legs, she curled the sole of a foot over his shoulder. The shirt collar had popped only on one side and the tab of it stuck up like an arrow toward his chin. She pinched it in her toes and folded it back down. Now she cupped his cheek with the instep of her foot. "Was that bad enough for you, Carl?"

"It's worse than I could even believe," he said.

"It's in me," she told him and made a sort of regretful snarling face.

He said, "I love it."

"You want me to be bad?"

He nodded. She patted his cheek with her foot then tweaked his earlobe between two toes.

"Before you clean me," she said, getting up onto her elbows, "let's play a little." She leaned to the side of the bed now, Carl watching eagerly what she would do. The pump top lube was there, but she picked up her dildo, got back to where she was, Carl waiting between her legs. She put her foot back on his shoulder, worked the vibrator's toggle until it buzzed. It was about five or six inches long, the tip shaped like a flared bullet. Carl's eyes were drawn to it. She raised it high, watched his chin tilt up. Brought it low, watched his eyes follow as she pushed it against her folds. She worked it up and down in circles around her clit, making her own eyes flutter. Its buzz felt amazing, but her husband's wide watching eyes felt even better. She

eased it inside her, feeling herself stretched, her old familiar dildo slipping in without a hitch. She whispered, "I'm loose."

Carl groaned.

"He must've dumped a bucket inside me, Carl, because this thing is just slipping around." She wiggled it, moved the base around in circles, then withdrew it to show Carl. It was slick with Truth's semen. "Get up on your knees," she told him.

She sat up now, crossed her legs. Carl struggled, and she helped him, grabbing the front button placard of his shirt and giving him support to get upright.

Now he was on his knees in front of her, his raging cock thrust outright. Every vein on it squiggled high across its surface. She took the buzzing vibrator, traced those lines. Carl buckled and fell against her. "Easy now," she said and guided him to get more upright. She worked him with the dildo's tip, sometime using its very point, sometimes resting the entire vibrating side along his shaft, letting her tied-up wedding rings rattle against it. The sound was loud, and her husband knew what it was.

She beat lightly against the brain of his bound balls. Worked up to the tip again, got him pulsing out more of his excitement, down his shaft and over that knot of tied-off testicles, down lower...

She watched his face as she sensed by hand as the tip slid over his perineum and slowly worked its way into a weakness back there. Carl's back arched and his eyes rolled up in his head as she inserted it a few inches inside him. Clear pre-come spurted from him and she could see her pink ribbon slacken. "Somebody likes this," she purred.

Carl fell against her again, this time she let him. She caressed his back with her hands and ran her nails up and down him. "I need to be cleaned," she whispered in his ear to remind him. He nodded his chin against her. She lay back onto the bed again and opened her legs. Carl fell between them, the vibrator buzzing behind him. She could see his hands shaking behind his back as he worked his face down her hard stomach, in between her legs.

He ate her out eagerly. He'd never been shy before, and he wasn't shy now, even after the way she'd been left. Split, stretched, made love to like she never had been before... You couldn't get a man better than Truth in your bed, there was no doubt, but something about the love she felt in Carl's tongue now as he sought to pleasure her made her heart flutter.

She whispered, "Carl, baby...?"

He nodded, never stopping the deep penetration and lapping of his tongue.

“I want my mom in Okeechobee...”

He nodded, and it felt so good. She caressed his face.

“You’ll pay to have my mom here?...”

He moaned a yes then took up her leaking folds in his mouth.

“You’ll do that for me?”

Carl was panting from excitement, wanting to be her good boy, nodding and pleasuring her between her legs like a trussed up Thanksgiving turkey, her baster vibrating away, her husband in her complete control. “Fuck Jackie, fuck my sister, I win, I get what I want.”

She watched his brow as his tongue worked through her folds. She raked her fingers through his hair, cupped his ears, caressed his cheeks. And in minutes, though she couldn’t even believe it, he had her orgasming again.

Chapter 52

BY THE TIME he'd made her come—her strong thighs closing around his cheeks as he got her humping that sweet pussy against his tongue—he was done like dinner. That dildo of hers thrummed his core till he was a vacant shell. All Carl Webster's individual thoughts and reason were blanketed by sopping erotic buzz that deafened him, obliterated him. His heart rate was spiking, his breaths came in desperate pants around his wife's devastated pussy, and that male part of him screamed for release; his balls felt too-large, plumped up with need, and swollen like two grapefruits.

As Rachel still cried from the dirty orgasm he'd delivered with his mouth, he collapsed on the bed, falling onto a shoulder with his hands lashed behind him, rolling onto his back then with his bare legs folded awkwardly underneath him. At the small of his back his hands clenched in sweaty, shaking fists. He humped the air, thrusting his aching erection up and down, conjuring up the feeling of it being inside his wife, remembering the slick squeeze of her against his hardness. The trigger of orgasm had fired inside him, but it went off like a dud, his cock just tightening and squeezing, his balls squirming, but nothing produced.

Then Rachel was there to deliver him sweet satisfaction.

She batted his balls with four gathered fingers, spanking his bursting nuts, getting him to cry out like she just had. He twisted and writhed on the bed, and her drumming against that most sensitive part of him became caresses. Through squinted eyes he saw his loving wife smiling, regarding her hand smoothing on his balls, enjoying this torture as much as he was.

"Please," he urged her.

“Beg me, Carl,” she said, sneering, her hand hovering above his aching shaft where a pink ribbon tied her wedding rings to him.

“Please, please, please, please, please,” he yammered in a tight, constricted whisper that made her laugh.

When her hand gently gripped his cock he bucked, felt the flood gates release. Rachel studied him like an evil C.I.A. doctor at a black site, learning what made her subject tick. Every muscle and tendon in his body cabled like steel running hot with electricity. She caressed his cock without committing to stroking and it got him bellowing, out of his mind needing release. She slipped an index finger up his cock’s belly and tried inserting her long fingernail into his urethra. When he squirmed and cried she laughed.

But then he was coming.

The sweet, heavenly, golden glow of release bathed him, and pure liquid pleasure streamed out of his cock. His mind exploded with joy, lit up with happy light.

He moaned out his joy, made bright happy sounds so Rachel would know what she’d done for him. Rachel’s hand circled his cock near the end, and stroked more ecstasy, quick little jerks, then using the pad of her thumb to circle on the under-split of his cock head.

“Ho, oh, oh wow, Carl, look at you go,” she laughed.

He watched down his twisted body, saw his cock in her hand, shining wet, still strung with ribbon and sun winking off her wedding rings. He was spurting thick semen, only it came not in spurts and jags, but a steady, burbling, uninterrupted stream.

“Oh, baby,” Rachel encouraged him, stroking, still showing glee at seeing that wriggling rope of sperm shoot out of him. At last his stomach cramped, and he coughed and jerked, his semen jolting out in short dashes.

Rachel’s hand was strung with strands of his come, and he could see she liked it, sucking her lower lip under her teeth and smiling. She was careful with his cock now, exploring it with her fingertips, watching his eyes, truly blissed out. The vision of her was hazy, too bright, and he feared he might black out. His breaths came in hard pants, his heart drummed in his ears. “That was incredible,” he groaned weakly.

“It sure was,” she said.

Maybe he did go out for a moment, because the next thing Rachel was straddling his thighs and doing something between his legs. He tilted his

chin downward to watch her untie the pink ribbon knot. When it was undone, she brought it up the end of his cock, the rings hanging heavy in its center like a saddle. His semen dripped from the gold. She held the ribbon and rings up, let one end go and collected her wedding rings in the palm of her hand. She let the damp ribbon fall against his bare thigh, soaked with cold semen. Big smile still on her face, she held up her hand and slipped her rings back down the proper finger.

“They certainly went back on easier than they came off.”

“I love you,” he panted.

She was still thinking about the rings. “Guess it was your semen all over them.” Then she was making happy chuckles in her throat and laying herself flat on him, her chest against his, kissing his chin. “I love you too,” she whispered.

“Do you?”

“What makes you think I don’t?”

He groaned and rolled his eyes at her ridiculous question.

Now she shimmied her naked stomach against him, the flood of semen on his belly transferring to hers. “We’ll talk later,” she said.

“Do you really love me?”

“I do, Carl,” she said. “But you have to go get Jessie now before she gets on a bus that’ll take her to our door. And now you need to clean up too...” Her hand slipped between them and squeezed his slippery cock getting his heart racing and making him groan.

She chuckled. “We’re going to have lots of fun together me and you. First things first, go get cleaned up.” Now she gave his cinched balls a rough squeeze and making him jump and grunt.

He said, “In the shower with you?”

She frowned. “No, Carl. I’m in with Truth. You go use one of the guest rooms.” She sat up, eased off him, gathered her hair up on top of her head, sighing as though content. With her arms up, her beautiful breasts swayed. She caught him looking. “Carl, today. Get in the shower...”

“Yes, yes,” he said, sitting up, and clutching his aching balls.

They were side by side now, on the edge of the bed, feet hanging near the floor. She leaned and looked in his lap. “Those little grapes okay?”

“I gotta get this hair-tie off,” he said.

“There’re scissors in the main guest room,” she told him, stood up, tying her hair in a loose knot at the top of her head. She gathered up the

pink ribbon from the bed and tied her hair so it would stay dry when she was in the shower.

“Fuck, you’re sexy,” he told her.

“I know,” she said, then sashayed to their bathroom, not wearing a thing. He stood and followed, coming near their bathroom door that she’d left open. He looked back at the bed where the most erotic thing to ever happen in his life just occurred. The messed up sheets, the silver dildo, the silver handgun. In the crack of the open bathroom door he watched Rachel slide open the glass shower door to join her black thug lover. He turned to receiver her, his cock deflated but still looking huge and swinging between his thighs. They embraced in a kiss under the shower’s spray.

His cock hardened, and he hustled away from the door, headed to the guest room...

Chapter 53

IN THE SHOWER, Truth said, “We gonna have a lot of fun together.”

“Are we?” she said, biting her lower lip and looking sexy for him. He liked that. Truth was a frightening man, a dangerous one no doubt, but now the sharp edges were wearing off, the things that made him tick became clearer in the fog.

His hands went over the wet of her shoulders, then down her sides to cup her ass again. That was his move. He liked her ass, and he liked to heft it in his palms. She hooped her arms around his neck, brought him to stoop so they could kiss. His lips were perfect pillows, strong yet soft; she loved the feel of his tongue against hers.

She sucked his tongue, let it slip free, said, “You gonna use me up?”

“Fuck you till you can’t walk, pick you up and do it again. Make you crawl on all fours.”

She moaned for him, let her hand come down his muscled stomach and lift up his hardening cock.

“You gonna fuck me with this thing again?”

“Turn around,” he said, “put them hands up on the tile, show me that ass...”

She dipped low, sucked his nipple, squeezed his balls, and stroked the huge head of his cock.

“All your riders?” she asked.

“All of ‘em. Four at a time.”

“So fucking hot,” she said, kissed his chest then laughed.

She stepped back, looked at that monster between his legs filling up with blood, looking bloated and heavy, shower water streaming off the flared head of it and spattering on the tiled floor of their shower.

She smiled for him, a fake one, the one he wanted to see. It came clearer now what she wanted. She did a sexy turn around thing, swaying her hips, put both hands spread out on the shower wall, parted her legs, and stuck her pussy up, wanting to get it fucked again.

She groaned loud at the feel of his hands on her. He grabbed a breast, squeezed, slapped her ass hard. She went up on her tip toes, and he shoved that club inside her a few inches. She let out a low howl, wiggled her hips to show him she wanted it.

He gripped her waist and fucked her. She sank back on her heels, turned her ass up higher to make his intrusion less painful. Soon she was relaxing to him, her insides going buttery and liking the feel. She acted again, telling him how big he was, how good he fucked her. She watched her clawed hands on the wall, looked at the rings on her fingers. She slipped a thumb to the inside and felt the extra-slippery feel the water made against Carl's semen. She looked around again, wanting to say something dirty, then feeling disappointed.

It was way better when Carl was watching...

PART IX

Epilog

Chapter 54

JESSIE HAD ASKED when Mom was going to come and he told her soon. But what if that wasn't true?

What if right now, instead of driving the Yukon he'd bought her, coming to join her family at the big Olympic swimming pool at the community center, she was instead rocketing deep into the Everglades on the back of Truth's motorcycle? What if that was what she'd prefer? And why wouldn't she? Truth had fucked her in a way *he* never could. He'd never be that kind of man for her. If she preferred a man like Truth, there was no way he could win her over. He would lose her. But Rachel loved her daughter. And damn it, he was offering Truth up to her. A perk in their marriage. Love and a cherishing husband, and a lover who would leave her a sweating wreck in the sheets. She couldn't possibly want to give up her family...

But it was late. *So* late.

Jessie was out in the pool all on her lonesome, doing laps and missing her mother, and completely oblivious to the real truth discovered today.

The image of his wife clung to Truth's back—liberated from her responsibilities, doing a hundred down the highway with a man who would devastate her sexually, maybe both fists thrust up overhead in joyous triumph—was unshakeable. He'd lost her.

He could have stopped this from happening. Could have stopped it before too.

He'd never stopped her from getting too involved at the real estate office. Sat on the sidelines and let his suspicions mount. He let them mount because he enjoyed it. And where did it get them? Rachel in the hospital—

though the cops laid no blame on her at all—and Hal Harbor ended up divorced and all those guys in his office quitting, fighting with each other, suing Hal, suing each other. And Rachel had been in that man-cave, sucking them all off, making things worse. She was *truly* bad.

But, wait... Now from the woman's washroom a brunette emerged in a one-piece Speedo. Limping along the concrete decking, waving to some people she knew in the pool already. She had a confident strut despite the damage left by her shark bite. And now, from his right, a bright chirping young girl voice from the pool shouting: "Mommy!" Each step closer the woman came brought strength to his heartbeat. A smile grew on his face as she made eye contact with him and kept it as she closed the distance between them.

Jessie paddled to the side of the pool and rested her arms on the lip. He got up from the stadium seating, stepped down on the deck and went to her. They met and embraced. Her body was warm and familiar. She smelled like soap, and he knew what badness that smell covered.

"I was worried you wouldn't come," he said, hugged her harder.

"I came again and again, Carl," she whispered near his ear.

"In the shower?"

"Shower and the bed again, too."

"I'm glad you're here."

She broke their embrace, waved to Jessie, approached the edge of the pool and squatted down. She asked their daughter: "How many laps you do?"

"I think twelve now," Jessie said, pushing back and bobbing, squeezing water from her nose.

Rachel said, "You gonna slow down now so I can catch up?"

Jessie smiled, said, "Not on your life, Mom, you gotta *earn* it," and then kicked away, lashing into a breaststroke.

"That's my girl," she said, watching Jessie admiringly.

His heart pounded for her. Love and excitement and submission. She had a power over him he only now realized, and both of them knew it was growing. He hoped it excited her enough to continue.

She turned to face him, looking so fucking hot in her metallic swimsuit that showed off her hard, toned body. She folded her arms, cocked a hip out. "Chinese again tonight?"

“I’d love it,” he said, moving to her. She took up his hands and looked in his eyes.

He said, “I was so worried you wouldn’t show up.”

“Think I was going to run off with Truth?”

“Would you do that?”

“No, Carl. I think you said something that was right.”

“What was that?”

“He doesn’t have everything I need.”

“You need more than that big dick?”

“It’s how he uses it too, Carl. He’s not just hung.”

That sunk his stomach.

But she said, “I need my Carl to give my badness context. Put it in a scale that I can appreciate.”

“You’re so fucking bad, Rachel.”

“I know. I can be badder. But I need *you* watching...”

His knees went weak for a moment, but he hung in there. “I’ll watch. I’ll watch, Rachel... I’ll do anything for you.”

She smiled crooked, said, “Anything to get more of what I offer?” She darted a look around to make sure no one watched them, their daughter face down and thrashing fast through the water. She grabbed his penis and balls through his pants and squeezed them hard.

He grunted and went up on his toes, keeping his eyes connected to hers, showing her his resilience. He had his own demands. Balls clutched in her grip, he said, “Truth can’t come by the house. At least not when Jessie might be around.”

She loosened her grip, but didn’t release him. She nodded. “I’m not dealing drugs for Truth, Carl. I’m not doing anything that would jeopardize our daughter, our home, my freedom. But our marriage...?” She smiled. Not mean, not unkind. Somehow warm. She released his balls and then patted them. “You want it. You want me to be bad, and that’s something I can do. It’s something I missed. If you want it, and I want it, we’re fucking perfect for each other.” She slipped a hand around the back of his neck, pulled him in for a kiss.

He moaned, worked his tongue against hers, breathed her in. They came apart with a wet smack.

She said, “I’m going to fuck Truth a lot, some of his friends, too. I’m going to party with them and they’re going to fall in love with me. I’m

going to ride on the backs of all their bikes, give them all blow jobs until his squad is exploding with testosterone. When you walk in a room with men like that, you can smell it coming out of them. All of them want you, and you've got them in your palm because you've got all their dicks doing the thinking. You turn them into cavemen. You know what it's like to make a man crazy, Carl? That's power. One of them is going to kill another one some day over me. That's power."

"You're so fucking bad. So fucking bad, baby."

"And you're coming along for the ride, baby. You're going to witness all of it."

"That's what I want."

She brushed his hair back from his face, studying him, but smiling happily. She said, "So Chinese for dinner?"

"Just you and me," he said. "Jessie's going to Meadow's. I said it would be okay."

"You'll be on your own tonight, I'm going to see my mom."

"Going down that way?"

She just smiled wider.

"Maybe I could go with you," he said.

"You want to come?"

"We can tell your mom the good news, tell her she's coming to Okeechobee."

"You'll honor that?"

He nodded. She patted his cheek and laughed. Then she kissed him again.

She moved away, looking to catch up on laps with their daughter but he stopped her.

"Maybe we can take the long way..."

She turned to face him again, liking his suggestion. "The scenic route, Carl? I guess, but you know, I think we're a little low on gas..."

He bit his lip. Told her, "We can risk it."

Afterword

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